

HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT

Open Elective | Question Bank - Descriptive Answer Key

HRD (OE) - Complete Answer Key

Model answers for all **60 questions** of the prescribed question bank, written in a structured, exam-ready and easy-to-understand form.

60 QUESTIONS	8 MARKS EACH	480 TOTAL MARKS	3 UNITS
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Unit	Topic area	Questions	Marks
Unit 1	HRD concept and objectives, evolution, HRD vs HRM, HRD climate and culture, role of HRD professional, HRD framework	Q1 - Q20	160
Unit 2	HRD system and subsystems: performance appraisal, potential appraisal, training, career planning, feedback and counselling; design principles; strategy alignment	Q21 - Q40	160
Unit 3	Training Needs Assessment, training design and delivery, on-the-job / off-the-job / e-learning methods, Kirkpatrick evaluation model	Q41 - Q60	160

Key point: Every answer follows the same pattern so that it is easy to revise: **meaning and definition -> explanation in points -> table / diagram / example -> conclusion.**
Application-type questions also carry a step-wise **action plan**.

Compiled for examination preparation from the prescribed question bank and class notes

How to use this answer key

This document contains a complete, self-contained answer for each of the 60 questions of the prescribed HRD (Open Elective) question bank. Each question carries 8 marks, and each answer is written as a full-length 8-mark response covering the definition, the theoretical explanation, suitable examples and a concluding remark. Short 'state any two' questions are also answered in full so that you have enough material even if the examiner asks the question in a longer form.

Element of every answer	Why it is written this way
Definition / meaning	Earns the first 1-2 marks. Examiners look for a precise opening statement and, where relevant, a scholar's definition (Nadler, T. V. Rao, Kirkpatrick).
Structured points	Body of the answer. Each point has a bold heading so that the breadth of the answer is visible at a glance.
Table / diagram	Compares, contrasts or sequences information. One diagram can replace a page of text during revision.
Example	Connects theory to a workplace situation - this is what separates an average answer from a good one.
Conclusion	A two-line closing remark that directly answers the question and gives the answer a finished look.
Action plan	Appears in application / case-based questions (Q9, Q10, Q20, Q29, Q30, Q39, Q40, Q49, Q50, Q59, Q60). Write it in numbered steps.

Exam tip: Strategy for 8-mark answers: spend about 8-9 minutes per answer. Write the definition, then 5-7 numbered points with underlined headings, then one example or a small diagram, and finish with a two-line conclusion. Neat presentation earns marks even when the content is standard.

Note: The answers are aligned with the prescribed notes (Unit 1 - HRD concepts and climate; Unit 2 - HRD strategies and systems; Unit 3 - Training and Development) and with standard HRD literature (Leonard Nadler, T. V. Rao, Udai Pareek, Donald Kirkpatrick, Raymond Noe).

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UNIT 1

HRD Concepts, HRD Climate and the HRD Professional

This unit builds the foundation: what Human Resource Development means, how it grew from simple job training into a strategic function, how it differs from and relates to HRM, what an HRD climate is, and what an HRD professional actually does in an organisation.

Key point: Names to remember for this unit: **Leonard Nadler** (coined the term HRD in 1969), **T. V. Rao and Udai Pareek** (fathers of HRD in India, L&T 1975), **Rao and Abraham** (HRD climate survey and the **OCTAPACE** culture), **M. M. Khan** (definition of HRD).

Questions 1 to 20 | 160 marks

Q1**Explain the concept of Human Resource Development (HRD) and state its major objectives.**

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of HRD

Human Resource Development (HRD) is the part of human resource management that deals specifically with the **training, learning and development of people** in an organisation. It is a planned and continuous effort to help employees acquire the knowledge, skills, attitudes and capabilities that they need for their present job, their future roles and their overall growth as individuals.

Unlike money, machines or material, human beings have almost **unlimited potential**. HRD is the process of creating an environment in which this potential is continuously identified, brought to the surface, nurtured and used for the benefit of both the individual and the organisation.

2. Definitions

- **Leonard Nadler (1969)**, who first used the term HRD at a conference in the USA, defined it as "a series of organised activities, conducted within a specified time and designed to produce behavioural change."
- **Prof. T. V. Rao** defined HRD as "a process by which the employees of an organisation are helped, in a continuous and planned way, to (i) acquire or sharpen capabilities required to perform various functions associated with their present or expected future roles; (ii) develop their general capabilities as individuals and discover and exploit their own inner potential; and (iii) develop an organisational culture in which superior-subordinate relationships, teamwork and collaboration among sub-units are strong."
- **M. M. Khan** described HRD as "the process of increasing knowledge, capabilities and positive work attitudes of all people working at all levels in a business undertaking."

3. The concept explained

The concept of HRD rests on three ideas that appear in Rao's definition:

Dimension	What HRD does	Example
Present and future roles	Sharpens the competencies needed for the current job and prepares people for the next role	A sales executive is trained in negotiation now and in team leadership for a future manager role
Individual potential	Helps a person discover and use hidden talent, not only job skills	A technician who shows an aptitude for teaching becomes an internal trainer
Organisational culture	Builds openness, trust, teamwork and collaboration between departments	Cross-functional projects, open feedback and mentoring

HRD is therefore not a one-time event. Its key features are that it is **systematic** (planned at individual and organisational level), **continuous** (from joining till retirement), **multi-disciplinary** (draws from psychology, management, economics and sociology), **all-pervasive** (needed in every type of organisation) and works through **specific mechanisms** such as performance appraisal, training, career planning, counselling, potential appraisal and organisation development.

PEOPLE + PLANNED LEARNING + SUPPORTIVE CLIMATE

|
v

Competent individuals --> Effective teams --> High-performing organisation

4. Major objectives of HRD

1. **Equity** - to treat every employee at par irrespective of caste, creed, religion, gender or language, and to give equal opportunity in training, promotion, career planning and quality of work life.
2. **Employability** - to improve the skills and competencies of employees so that they remain capable of gainful employment anywhere, which in turn motivates them to work effectively.
3. **Adaptability** - to develop, through continuous training, the ability of employees to adjust to technological, structural and market changes.
4. **Competence building** - to develop the technical, managerial, behavioural and conceptual skills required for present and future roles.
5. **Developing a healthy culture** - to create a climate of openness, trust, collaboration and pro-activity (OCTAPACE) in which people enjoy working.
6. **Motivation and commitment** - to satisfy the higher-order needs of employees (recognition, growth, self-actualisation) so that they feel committed to the organisation.
7. **Team spirit and collaboration** - to strengthen superior-subordinate relationships and inter-departmental cooperation.
8. **Organisational effectiveness** - to improve productivity, quality, problem-solving capability and readiness for change, thereby achieving organisational goals.
9. **Future readiness** - to identify and prepare people for succession so that the organisation never faces a leadership vacuum.

5. Conclusion

HRD is the planned, continuous and people-centred process of building capability and a development-oriented culture. Its objectives - equity, employability, adaptability, competence, commitment and organisational effectiveness - make it the engine that converts human potential into organisational performance.

Q2

Describe the evolution of Human Resource Development from traditional employee training to a strategic organizational function.

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

HRD did not appear suddenly. It grew, over about two centuries, from informal skill-passing between a master and an apprentice to a boardroom-level function that shapes business strategy. Each stage of this evolution added a new layer of purpose to the earlier one.

2. Stages in the evolution of HRD

Stage 1 - Apprenticeship and craft training (before the 18th century)

Skills were transferred informally from a master craftsman to an apprentice in guilds. Learning was slow, individual and limited to manual trades. There was no concept of an organisation "developing" its people.

Stage 2 - Vocational and factory training (Industrial Revolution, 1800s)

Factories needed large numbers of semi-skilled workers quickly. Vocational schools and "factory schools" (for example Hoe and Company, 1872) were set up to teach specific machine operations. Training was **task-focused and reactive**, meant only to make workers productive on a machine.

Stage 3 - Human relations movement (1920s-1940s)

The Hawthorne studies showed that attitudes, morale and social relationships affect productivity. Training expanded from pure skills to **supervisory and human-relations training**. During World War II the "Training Within Industry" (TWI) programme produced systematic job-instruction methods that are still used today.

Stage 4 - Emergence of the training and development profession (1940s-1960s)

Professional bodies like ASTD (1944) were formed. Training departments appeared in large companies, programmed instruction and management development programmes became common, and training began to be evaluated (Kirkpatrick, 1959).

Stage 5 - Birth of HRD as a concept (1969 onwards)

Leonard Nadler coined the term "Human Resource Development" in 1969, defining it as organised learning experiences designed to bring about behavioural change. HRD widened the scope from "training for the job" to **training, education and development** of the whole person.

Stage 6 - HRD in India and the systems view (1975 onwards)

At Larsen & Toubro in 1975, **Udai Pareek and T. V. Rao** designed the first integrated HRD system in India and recommended that HRD be separated from the personnel department. HRD came to mean a set of inter-linked subsystems - performance appraisal, potential appraisal, feedback and counselling, career planning, training, rewards and OD - working on a shared philosophy of trust and openness. Separate HRD departments became common in the 1980s and 1990s.

Stage 7 - Strategic HRD (1990s to the present)

With globalisation, technology and knowledge-based competition, people became the main source of competitive advantage. HRD moved to the strategic level: aligning learning with business strategy, building competencies and a learning organisation, managing talent and succession, acting as a change agent, and measuring return on investment. Today e-learning, learning analytics and continuous digital learning have made HRD a real-time, strategic function.

3. Summary of the shift

Aspect	Traditional training	Strategic HRD
Purpose	Fix an immediate skill deficiency	Build long-term capability and competitive advantage
Scope	Job skills of operatives	Skills, attitudes, careers, culture and organisation

Aspect	Traditional training	Strategic HRD
Time frame	Short-term, one-off events	Continuous, planned, life-long
Responsibility	Training officer	Top management, line managers and HRD professionals
Linkage	Isolated from business plans	Derived from and feeding into business strategy
Measurement	Number of programmes conducted	Performance improvement, retention, business results

4. Conclusion

HRD has evolved from the narrow, reactive activity of teaching a worker to operate a machine into a proactive, integrated and strategic function that develops individuals, teams and the organisation's culture. The journey - apprenticeship, vocational training, human relations, professional T&D, Nadler's HRD, the Indian systems approach and finally strategic HRD - shows a steady widening of scope from the job to the whole organisation.

Q3

Explain the relationship between Human Resource Development and Human Resource Management.

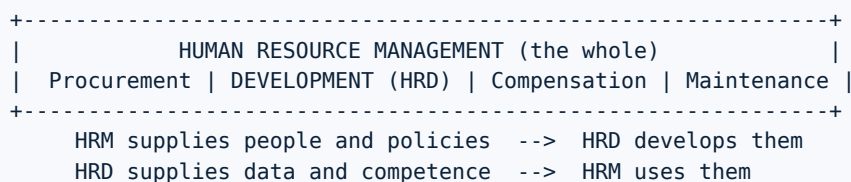
Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of the two terms

Human Resource Management (HRM) is the overall function of procuring, developing, compensating, maintaining and utilising the human resources of an organisation. It covers manpower planning, recruitment, selection, placement, compensation, welfare, industrial relations, discipline and records.

Human Resource Development (HRD) is the developmental part of HRM. It is a continuous and planned process that helps employees acquire and sharpen capabilities, discover their potential and build a collaborative organisational culture through mechanisms such as training, performance appraisal, potential appraisal, career planning, counselling and organisation development.

2. Nature of the relationship



- Part and whole** - HRD is a sub-system of HRM. HRM is the umbrella; HRD is its development wing. Without HRM there is nobody to develop; without HRD, HRM would only maintain people without improving them.
- HRM provides the inputs for HRD** - recruitment and selection bring in the "raw material"; job analysis defines the competencies needed; HR planning shows future skill requirements. HRD uses all of these to plan development.

3. **HRD strengthens HRM decisions** - performance and potential appraisal data generated by HRD are used by HRM for promotion, transfer, compensation and succession decisions.
4. **Shared objective** - both aim at the effective utilisation of people to achieve organisational goals while satisfying employee needs.
5. **Complementary orientation** - HRM keeps the organisation running (maintenance); HRD keeps it growing (development). Together they create a competent and committed workforce.
6. **Common philosophy** - both assume that people are valuable assets and not costs; HRD carries this philosophy further into a culture of trust, openness and collaboration.

3. Differences between HRM and HRD

Basis	HRM	HRD
Orientation	Maintenance-oriented	Development-oriented
Structure	An independent function	An inter-dependent, inter-related set of sub-systems
Aim	Improve efficiency of employees	Develop the employee and the organisation as a whole
Responsibility	Personnel / HR department and personnel manager	All managers at all levels, with HRD department as facilitator
Motivation	Mainly monetary incentives and rewards	Satisfaction of higher-order needs - growth, recognition, autonomy
Nature	Routine, reactive, procedural	Continuous, proactive, process-oriented
Time focus	Present requirements	Present and future roles

4. Example

When a company recruits 50 graduate trainees (an HRM activity), HRD designs their induction, technical training, mentoring and career path. Two years later, the potential appraisal conducted by HRD tells HRM which trainees should be promoted and how they should be compensated. The two functions are thus two sides of the same coin.

5. Conclusion

HRM and HRD are not rivals; they are inseparable partners. HRM acquires and maintains human resources, HRD develops them, and each feeds the other with people, information and policies. An organisation that wants both stability and growth needs strong HRM supported by an equally strong HRD.

Q4

Discuss the importance of HRD in improving individual and organizational performance.

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

Organisations today compete on the knowledge, skills and commitment of their people rather than on machines or capital alone. HRD is the process that converts human potential into performance. Its importance can be seen at two levels - the individual employee and the

organisation as a whole - and the two are closely connected: competent and motivated individuals produce a high-performing organisation.

2. Importance of HRD for individual performance

1. **Competence** - training and development give employees the knowledge, skills and attitudes needed to perform their present job correctly and their future job confidently.
2. **Clarity of role and expectations** - performance appraisal and feedback tell the employee what is expected and how he or she is doing, which removes confusion and reduces errors.
3. **Motivation and commitment** - when the organisation invests in a person's growth, the person feels valued and works with greater involvement.
4. **Career growth and employability** - career planning, potential appraisal and job rotation prepare employees for higher responsibilities and keep their skills marketable.
5. **Problem-solving ability** - HRD develops analytical, creative and decision-making capabilities so that employees solve problems on their own rather than waiting for instructions.
6. **Adaptability and confidence** - continuous learning helps employees accept new technology and change without fear.
7. **Job satisfaction and self-esteem** - counselling, recognition and rewards make employees feel a sense of pride and achievement.

3. Importance of HRD for organisational performance

1. **Higher productivity and quality** - competent people produce more with fewer mistakes, less wastage and less supervision.
2. **Culture of trust and openness** - HRD builds an OCTAPACE culture in which communication is open, collaboration is natural and conflicts are confronted constructively.
3. **Team spirit** - inter-departmental cooperation improves, which is essential for project-based and cross-functional work.
4. **Readiness for change** - an organisation whose people are used to continuous learning can adopt new technology, restructure or enter new markets faster than competitors.
5. **Retention and lower cost** - development opportunities reduce turnover and absenteeism, saving recruitment and training costs.
6. **Better HR planning** - HRD generates objective data on skills, performance and potential, which improves manpower planning, succession planning and placement.
7. **Efficiency culture and goal attainment** - resources are used properly and goals are achieved in a better way, leading to greater organisational effectiveness and profitability.
8. **Employer brand and competitive advantage** - organisations known for developing people attract better talent and enjoy a reputation that competitors cannot easily copy.

4. The linkage between the two levels

HRD mechanisms	HRD processes / climate	Outcomes
(appraisal, training, counselling, career planning, rewards, OD)	(openness, trust, teamwork, -> pro-activity, learning orientation)	Individual: competent, committed, satisfied Organisation: productive, adaptive, profitable

Example: Indian IT companies such as Infosys and TCS invest heavily in induction academies, continuous re-skilling and internal certification. The result is visible at both levels - individual

employees move quickly from fresher to project leader, and the organisation can redeploy thousands of people to new technologies within months.

5. Conclusion

HRD is important because it works on both blades of the scissors at the same time. It makes individuals more competent, confident and committed, and it makes the organisation more productive, adaptive and effective. Any organisation that neglects HRD will soon find that its people - and therefore its performance - have stopped growing.

Q5

Explain the concept of HRD climate and identify the major characteristics of a supportive HRD climate.

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of HRD climate

The word **climate** refers to the quality of the internal environment of an organisation as perceived by its members - the atmosphere in which people help, judge, reward, constrain and learn about each other. It influences morale and the attitude of individuals towards their work.

HRD climate is that part of the organisational climate which relates to the development of people. It is the general environment and set of circumstances within the organisation that **encourage and support human resource development**. According to Rao and Abraham, HRD climate is the perception of employees about the extent to which the organisation, its top management, its line managers and its personnel policies genuinely value and support the development of employees.

The HRD climate is both a **means to an end** (it makes HRD mechanisms work) and an **end in itself** (a good climate is a sign that HRD has succeeded).

2. Components of HRD climate

Rao and Abraham measure HRD climate through three components:

Component	What it covers	Sample indicator
General climate	Importance given to human resources by top management and line managers	Top management believes people are the most important resource
OCTAPACE culture	Openness, Confrontation, Trust, Autonomy, Pro-activity, Authenticity, Collaboration, Experimentation	Employees freely express ideas and disagreements
HRD mechanisms	How seriously appraisal, training, feedback, counselling, career planning and rewards are implemented	Training needs are identified and people apply what they learn

3. Characteristics of a supportive HRD climate

1. **Top management commitment** - leaders believe in developing people, spend time and money on it and participate in HRD activities personally.
2. **People treated as the most important resource** - the organisation is genuinely concerned about employee well-being and treats development as an investment, not a cost.
3. **Strong learning culture** - continuous learning, knowledge sharing and skill up-gradation are valued; mistakes are seen as learning opportunities.

4. **Openness and free communication** - employees can express ideas, problems and disagreements without fear; information flows upward as well as downward.
5. **Trust and authenticity** - people keep their word, do not misuse information and superiors are seen as helpful rather than punishing.
6. **Autonomy and pro-activity** - employees have freedom to plan their work, take initiative and anticipate problems.
7. **Collaboration and team spirit** - cross-functional cooperation is encouraged and success is shared.
8. **Experimentation and risk-taking** - trying out new methods is encouraged and failures are not punished.
9. **Effective HRD mechanisms** - appraisal is developmental, feedback is regular, career paths are clear, and training is based on genuine needs.
10. **Recognition and rewards** - good performance and development efforts are noticed, appreciated and rewarded.
11. **Supportive line managers** - supervisors coach, guide and counsel their subordinates and help them apply new learning on the job.
12. **Clear objectives and work-life balance** - employees know what is expected of them and the organisation cares for their well-being.

4. Example

In an organisation with a supportive HRD climate, a young engineer who proposes a new process improvement is encouraged to pilot it (experimentation), is given resources (autonomy), receives honest feedback when it partially fails (openness and confrontation), and is still appreciated for the initiative (trust and recognition). In a weak climate the same engineer would be told to "stick to the job."

5. Conclusion

HRD climate is the developmental atmosphere of an organisation. A supportive climate - marked by top management commitment, an OCTAPACE culture and well-implemented HRD mechanisms - is the soil in which training, appraisal and career planning can actually bear fruit. Without it, even the best HRD programmes remain paper exercises.

Q6**Differentiate between HRD climate and organizational culture with suitable examples.**

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of the two concepts

Organisational culture is the pattern of shared basic assumptions, values, beliefs and norms that a group has developed over time while learning to cope with its external environment and internal integration. It tells members "the way things are done here." Culture is deep-rooted, largely unwritten and passed on to new members through stories, symbols, rituals and role models. Edgar Schein describes it in three layers - artefacts, espoused values and basic underlying assumptions.

HRD climate is the perception of employees about the extent to which the organisation's environment supports their learning and development. It is measured through the general climate (importance given to people), the OCTAPACE values and the effectiveness of HRD

mechanisms such as appraisal, training, feedback and career planning. Climate is the **surface-level, felt atmosphere**; culture is the **deep-level, shared belief system**.

2. Points of difference

Basis	HRD climate	Organisational culture
Nature	Perception of the developmental atmosphere at a point of time	Shared values, beliefs and assumptions built over years
Depth	Surface level - what employees experience and feel	Deep level - why the organisation behaves the way it does
Scope	Specific to the development of human resources	Covers every aspect of organisational life - strategy, customers, ethics, dress, decision making
Stability	Relatively dynamic; can change within months with new leadership or new HRD practices	Highly stable; changes slowly over years
Measurability	Measured through questionnaires (for example the Rao-Abraham HRD Climate Survey, 38 items)	Studied qualitatively through observation, stories, rituals, symbols
Origin	Created by top management support, line manager behaviour and HRD mechanisms	Created by founders' philosophy, history, critical incidents and shared learning
Unit of analysis	Individual perceptions aggregated	The collective group
Level of awareness	Employees are conscious of it and can describe it	Often taken for granted and not consciously noticed
Relationship	Is an outcome or reflection of the culture in the area of HRD	Is the foundation from which climate emerges

3. Examples

- **Example of culture:** In a family-managed manufacturing firm the deep assumption is "seniors know best." Decisions flow from the top and loyalty is valued above initiative. This assumption is rarely stated but everyone follows it.
- **Example of climate:** In the same firm, a new HR head introduces monthly feedback meetings, sponsors employees for external courses and rewards suggestions. Within a year employees report that "the company now cares about our growth" - the HRD climate has improved even though the underlying culture of respect for seniority is still present.
- **Example of interaction:** In a start-up whose culture values experimentation, the HRD climate naturally scores high on autonomy and risk-taking. In a bureaucratic public utility whose culture values rule-following, the HRD climate usually scores low on experimentation unless management makes special efforts.

4. Relationship between the two

Culture and climate are related as **root and fruit**. Culture provides the values; climate is how those values are experienced in day-to-day HRD practice. A supportive culture makes it easy to build a good HRD climate, and a sustained good HRD climate, over time, can gradually reshape the culture itself. That is why HRD professionals must diagnose culture before designing

climate-building interventions.

5. Conclusion

HRD climate is the visible, measurable, development-related atmosphere of an organisation, while organisational culture is the invisible, stable system of shared assumptions that underlies all behaviour. Climate can be improved comparatively quickly through HRD mechanisms; culture changes slowly and shapes how those mechanisms are received.

Q7**Explain the role and responsibilities of an HRD professional in an organization.**

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

An HRD professional is the person (or team) who designs, facilitates and manages the learning and development system of an organisation. Earlier this person was simply a "training officer" who arranged classes. Today the HRD professional is expected to be a strategist, consultant, change agent and counsellor. Pareek and Rao, and later Patricia McLagan's "Models for HRD Practice", describe the multiple roles listed below.

2. Major roles of an HRD professional

Role	What the role involves
HR strategic advisor	Advises top management on the people implications of business strategy; links HRD plans to organisational goals
HRD systems designer	Designs performance appraisal, potential appraisal, career planning, feedback, counselling and reward systems and links them into one integrated system
Learning programme specialist / instructional designer	Identifies training needs, sets objectives, chooses methods, prepares content and materials
Trainer / facilitator	Delivers programmes, facilitates group learning, workshops and experiential exercises
Individual development and career counsellor	Helps employees assess their strengths, set career goals and plan development; provides performance counselling
Performance consultant	Diagnoses performance problems, identifies whether the cause is skill, motivation or system, and recommends the right (training or non-training) solution
Organisation change agent	Facilitates change management, team building, culture-building and OD interventions
Organisation design consultant	Advises on structure, roles, job design and work systems that support learning
Researcher and evaluator	Conducts HRD climate surveys, HRD audits, evaluates training (Kirkpatrick levels) and reports return on investment
Administrator	Manages budgets, records, training calendars, vendors, learning management systems and compliance

3. Key responsibilities

1. **Developing HRD philosophy and policy** - drafting statements of belief in people and getting top management commitment.
2. **Training needs assessment** at organisation, task and person level, and preparing the annual training plan.
3. **Designing and delivering** induction, technical, behavioural and management development programmes.
4. **Running the appraisal cycle** - ensuring that performance appraisal is used for development, not just for control, and that feedback and counselling follow.
5. **Career and succession planning** - identifying high-potential employees and preparing them for key positions.
6. **Building the HRD climate** - promoting openness, trust, collaboration and experimentation, and coaching line managers to develop their teams.
7. **Facilitating organisation development** - surveys, team building, change initiatives, quality circles and employee participation.
8. **Evaluation and audit** - measuring the effectiveness of every HRD activity and correcting the system.
9. **Keeping knowledge current** - staying updated on e-learning, learning analytics, competency frameworks and legal requirements.

4. Competencies required

An HRD professional needs **business competence** (understanding the industry, strategy and finance), **technical competence** (adult learning, instructional design, appraisal methods, evaluation), **interpersonal competence** (communication, coaching, counselling, influencing, empathy) and **intellectual competence** (diagnosis, data analysis, systems thinking, creativity). Personal credibility and integrity are essential because employees share confidential career and performance issues with the HRD professional.

5. Working with line managers

The HRD professional does not develop people alone. Line managers are directly responsible for coaching, feedback and on-the-job development of their teams; the HRD professional supports them with systems, tools, expertise and facilitation. HRD is therefore a **shared responsibility** in which the HRD professional acts as designer, catalyst and partner.

6. Conclusion

The HRD professional wears many hats - strategist, system designer, trainer, counsellor, change agent, evaluator and administrator. Their central responsibility is to build a competent, committed and continuously learning workforce and a supportive climate, in partnership with top management and line managers, so that both the employees and the organisation grow together.

Q8**Discuss the significance of HRD for achieving organizational effectiveness and long-term employee development.**

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

Organisational effectiveness is the degree to which an organisation achieves its goals - profitability, growth, quality, customer satisfaction, innovation and adaptability - while keeping its members satisfied and committed. **Long-term employee development** means the continuous growth of employees over their entire career, not just training for today's job. HRD is significant because it is the only management function whose direct purpose is to build both at the same time.

2. The HRD-effectiveness linkage (Rao's model)

HRD MECHANISMS	-->	HRD PROCESSES / CLIMATE	-->	HRD OUTCOMES	-->	ORGANISATIONAL EFFECTIVENESS
Appraisal, feedback, counselling, training, career planning, rewards, OD		Role clarity, openness, trust, teamwork, pro-activity, learning orientation, risk-taking		More competent, committed, satisfied people; better teams; healthy culture		Higher productivity, quality, growth, adaptability, profit

The model shows that HRD mechanisms first improve the processes and climate of the organisation, these create developmental outcomes in people, and those outcomes are what finally produce organisational effectiveness.

3. Significance for organisational effectiveness

1. **Competent workforce** - HRD ensures that every role is filled by a person with the required knowledge and skills, which raises productivity and reduces errors, rework and supervision cost.
2. **Efficiency culture** - resources are used properly and goals are achieved in a better way because people understand what is expected and how their work contributes.
3. **Adaptability to change** - continuous learning makes the organisation capable of adopting new technology, entering new markets and restructuring without major disruption.
4. **Problem-solving and innovation** - HRD develops diagnostic and creative capabilities so that problems are solved at the source and new ideas emerge from every level.
5. **Teamwork and collaboration** - OD interventions and an OCTAPACE culture reduce inter-departmental conflict and make cross-functional projects successful.
6. **Better HR decisions** - objective appraisal and potential data lead to correct placement, promotion and succession, so the right people are in the right jobs.
7. **Retention and cost saving** - development opportunities reduce turnover, absenteeism and the cost of hiring replacements.
8. **Competitive advantage** - skills, culture and knowledge built through HRD cannot be copied quickly by competitors.

4. Significance for long-term employee development

1. **Career progression** - career planning and succession planning give employees a visible growth path from entry to retirement.

2. **Continuous skill renewal** - regular training keeps skills current so that employees never become obsolete.
3. **Discovery of potential** - potential appraisal and assessment centres reveal talents that the present job does not use.
4. **Personal growth** - counselling, mentoring and behavioural training develop confidence, emotional maturity and leadership.
5. **Employability and security** - developed employees are valuable inside and outside the organisation, which gives them psychological security.
6. **Motivation through higher-order needs** - growth, recognition and autonomy satisfy needs that salary alone cannot.

5. Example

A public sector bank that introduced a structured HRD system - role-based training, mentoring for new officers, annual potential appraisal and a leadership pipeline - found within five years that branch productivity rose, customer complaints fell and most senior positions were filled internally. Employees, on their part, had clear career paths and continuous learning, which improved morale and reduced attrition of young officers.

6. Conclusion

HRD is significant because it serves two masters at once. By building competence, a healthy climate and effective HR systems it makes the organisation productive, adaptive and effective; by providing continuous learning, career paths and personal growth it develops employees for the long term. The two reinforce each other - developed employees make the organisation effective, and an effective organisation can invest more in its people.

Q9

A growing organization is facing skill gaps and declining employee performance. Suggest an HRD-oriented approach to address these issues.

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Understanding the situation

A growing organisation typically hires fast, promotes people quickly into supervisory roles, adopts new technology and expands into new work. In this rush, employees are often placed in roles for which they are not fully prepared, supervisors are not trained to coach, and performance standards become unclear. The result is exactly what the case describes - **skill gaps** (the difference between the competencies required and those possessed) and **declining performance**. An HRD-oriented approach treats this as a development problem to be diagnosed and solved systematically, not as a disciplinary problem.

2. Recommended HRD-oriented approach

Step 1 - Diagnose before prescribing (Training Needs Assessment)

- **Organisation analysis:** review business goals, growth plans and the competencies the new strategy demands.
- **Task analysis:** identify the key tasks and the knowledge, skills and attitudes (KSAs) each role requires.

- **Person analysis:** compare each employee's actual competence with the required standard using appraisal data, tests, observation and interviews. Training need = Standard performance - Actual performance.
- **Performance analysis:** separate causes that training can solve (lack of skill or knowledge) from causes it cannot (poor tools, unclear goals, low motivation, overload). Non-training causes need system corrections.

Step 2 - Strengthen the HRD subsystems

Subsystem	Action for the growing organisation
Performance appraisal	Set clear, measurable KRAs for every role; appraise every six months; use results for development plans, not only for increments
Feedback and counselling	Train supervisors to give regular, specific and constructive feedback; hold performance counselling sessions for low performers
Training	Design role-based programmes - technical training for skill gaps, supervisory training for newly promoted managers; blend on-the-job (coaching, job rotation) with off-the-job (workshops, e-learning)
Potential appraisal and career planning	Identify high-potential employees, give them individual development plans and clear career paths so that growth is planned rather than accidental
Mentoring and coaching	Pair experienced employees with new ones; make each manager a coach for his or her team
Rewards and recognition	Link rewards to performance improvement and to learning achievements (certifications, skills acquired)
Organisation development	Team-building, clear communication of goals, participative problem-solving to rebuild morale

Step 3 - Build a supportive HRD climate

Top management must visibly commit time and budget, line managers must own development of their teams, and the OCTAPACE values - openness, trust, autonomy, experimentation - should be encouraged so that employees are not afraid to admit skill gaps and ask for help.

Step 4 - Deliver, transfer and evaluate

- Deliver training in short, spaced modules so that work is not disrupted.
- Ensure **transfer of learning:** supervisors assign projects that use the new skill, and employees prepare action plans after each programme.
- Evaluate using the Kirkpatrick model - reaction, learning, behaviour change on the job and business results (error rates, productivity, customer complaints) - and revise the plan every quarter.

3. Action plan at a glance

Month 1-2	TNA, performance analysis, competency mapping, quick fixes to systems
Month 2-4	Appraisal and feedback system redesigned; supervisors trained as coaches
Month 3-8	Role-based technical and behavioural training; mentoring launched
Month 6-12	Potential appraisal, career paths, individual development plans, rewards linked
Ongoing	Kirkpatrick evaluation, HRD climate survey, quarterly review and correction

4. Expected outcomes

Skill gaps close because training is targeted; performance rises because expectations are clear and feedback is regular; newly promoted managers become effective coaches; high-potential employees stay because they see a future; and the organisation gains a development culture that supports further growth.

5. Conclusion

The HRD-oriented approach begins with diagnosis, corrects the systems that caused the decline, builds competence through integrated HRD subsystems, and sustains the gains through a supportive climate and continuous evaluation. This turns a crisis of skill gaps into an opportunity to institutionalise development in the growing organisation.

Q10

Apply the concept of HRD climate to suggest measures for creating a learning-oriented work environment.

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. The concept applied

HRD climate is the perception of employees that the organisation genuinely supports their development. It has three components - the **general climate** (importance given to people by top management and line managers), the **OCTAPACE culture** (Openness, Confrontation, Trust, Autonomy, Pro-activity, Authenticity, Collaboration, Experimentation) and the **HRD mechanisms** (appraisal, feedback, training, career planning, rewards). A learning-oriented work environment is simply an organisation in which all three components score high. The measures below are therefore organised under these three heads.

2. Measures to strengthen the general climate

- Visible top management commitment** - leaders should state a development philosophy, allocate a fixed percentage of payroll to learning, attend programmes and personally mentor young managers.
- Make line managers accountable for development** - include "development of subordinates" as a key result area in every manager's appraisal and reward managers whose team members grow.
- Treat people as the most important resource** - communicate business plans and their people implications openly so that employees see why learning matters.
- Provide time and resources for learning** - protected learning hours, a library or digital learning platform, and budgets for external courses and certifications.

3. Measures to build an OCTAPACE culture

Value	Practical measure
Openness	Open-door practice, regular town-hall meetings, suggestion schemes, upward feedback
Confrontation	Train people to discuss problems and disagreements face-to-face with facts, not by avoiding or complaining
Trust	Keep commitments, maintain confidentiality of counselling, avoid blame for honest mistakes

Value	Practical measure
Autonomy	Delegate authority, allow employees to plan their own work and learning
Pro-activity	Encourage anticipation of problems, reward initiative, use "what if" planning
Authenticity	Leaders behave consistently with stated values; feedback is honest
Collaboration	Cross-functional teams, knowledge-sharing sessions, communities of practice
Experimentation	Pilot projects, innovation days, tolerance for failure, "lessons learnt" reviews

4. Measures to strengthen HRD mechanisms

1. **Developmental performance appraisal** - self-appraisal, joint goal setting and a separate development review that is not linked to salary discussion.
2. **Regular feedback and counselling** - quarterly one-to-one conversations; managers trained in coaching and performance counselling.
3. **Need-based training** - a proper training needs assessment every year; programmes followed by action plans and on-the-job application.
4. **Career planning and potential appraisal** - transparent career paths, individual development plans and assessment centres for high-potential employees.
5. **Job rotation and stretch assignments** - learning by doing in new roles, projects and task forces.
6. **Knowledge management** - document lessons from projects, create expert directories, encourage internal trainers and peer teaching.
7. **Reward learning** - recognise certifications, skill acquisition, knowledge sharing and innovation, not only output.
8. **Measure the climate** - conduct an HRD climate survey (for example the 38-item Rao-Abraham instrument) every year, share the results and act on them.

5. Example

A mid-sized software firm introduced "Learning Fridays" (two protected hours per week), made every project manager a coach with a target of two developmental conversations per month, launched an internal certification programme linked to rewards, and published the results of its annual HRD climate survey. Within eighteen months, its scores on openness, experimentation and training effectiveness rose sharply, attrition fell and internal promotions increased.

6. Conclusion

A learning-oriented environment is created not by one training programme but by raising the whole HRD climate - committed leadership and line managers, OCTAPACE values practised daily, and HRD mechanisms that are genuinely developmental. When all three move together, learning becomes a habit of the organisation rather than an occasional event.

Q11**State any two objectives of Human Resource Development.**

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of HRD objectives

The objectives of HRD are the results that the organisation wants to achieve by investing in the planned and continuous development of its people. The prime objective is to create an organisational environment in which **people come first**. From this prime objective flow several specific objectives, of which the three most frequently cited are **equity, employability and adaptability**. Any two of these can be stated, but the complete list is given below so that the answer is not incomplete.

2. Two major objectives explained in detail

Objective 1 - Equity

- **Meaning:** Recognising every employee at par, irrespective of caste, creed, religion, gender, region or language.
- **What HRD does:** ensures that the organisation provides equal opportunity to all employees in career planning, promotion, training and development, and quality of work life. Selection for training is based on genuine need, not favouritism; appraisal is objective; career paths are transparent.
- **Why it matters:** Equity builds trust. When employees believe the system is fair, they participate willingly in development activities, accept feedback and stay committed. Inequity, on the other hand, breeds resentment, politics and turnover.
- **Example:** A company that publishes clear eligibility criteria for its management development programme and selects participants through an assessment centre is practising equity.

Objective 2 - Employability

- **Meaning:** Employability is the ability, skills and competencies of an individual to seek and hold gainful employment anywhere - inside or outside the present organisation.
- **What HRD does:** continuously improves the skills of employees through training, multi-skilling, job rotation and certification so that they remain valuable in the labour market.
- **Why it matters:** In a fast-changing economy, jobs and technologies become obsolete quickly. An employee whose skills are kept current feels secure and motivated to work with effectiveness, while the organisation gains a flexible, redeployable workforce.
- **Example:** An IT firm that re-skills its mainframe programmers in cloud technologies improves both their employability and its own capability.

3. Other objectives of HRD (for completeness)

Objective	Brief meaning
Adaptability	Continuous training that helps employees adjust to technological and organisational change
Competence development	Building technical, managerial, behavioural and conceptual capabilities for present and future roles
Healthy culture	Creating openness, trust, collaboration and pro-activity (OCTAPACE)

Objective	Brief meaning
Motivation and commitment	Satisfying higher-order needs such as recognition, growth and autonomy
Team spirit	Strengthening superior-subordinate and inter-departmental relationships
Organisational effectiveness	Improving productivity, quality, problem-solving and goal achievement
Succession readiness	Preparing people in advance for key future positions

4. Conclusion

Equity and employability are two central objectives of HRD: the first ensures that development opportunities are distributed fairly, and the second ensures that development keeps every employee capable and secure. Together with adaptability, competence building and culture development, they express the basic HRD belief that when people grow, the organisation grows.

Q12
State any two ways in which HRD and HRM are related.

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

Human Resource Management (HRM) is the total function of procuring, developing, compensating, maintaining and utilising people, whereas Human Resource Development (HRD) is its developmental sub-system - the planned, continuous process of building employee capability through training, appraisal, career planning, counselling and organisation development. Because HRD sits inside HRM, the two are related in several ways. Two important relationships are explained below, followed by a summary of the others.

2. Relationship 1 - HRD is an integral sub-system (part) of HRM

- HRM is the whole; HRD is a part. The "development" function of HRM - training, management development, career development and OD - is exactly what HRD covers.
- HRM sets the policy framework (HR philosophy, manpower plan, job descriptions, compensation structure) within which HRD operates. For instance, the manpower plan tells HRD how many people will need what competencies in three years, and job analysis tells HRD what a role requires.
- Without HRM there would be nobody to develop and no framework for development; without HRD, HRM would merely maintain people without improving them.

HRM = Procurement + DEVELOPMENT (HRD) + Compensation + Maintenance + Utilisation

3. Relationship 2 - The two functions exchange inputs and outputs (they are complementary)

- **HRM supplies HRD with people and information.** Recruitment and selection bring in employees who become the "raw material" for development. Induction hands them over to HRD. HR records supply data on qualifications, experience and performance history.
- **HRD supplies HRM with competence and decision data.** Performance appraisal, potential appraisal and assessment centre results produced by HRD are used by HRM for promotion, transfer, placement, succession and compensation decisions. Trained employees

produced by HRD are the "output" that HRM deploys and rewards.

- The relationship is therefore a two-way flow: HRM acquires and maintains, HRD develops, and each depends on the quality of the other's work.

Example: When a bank recruits probationary officers (HRM), HRD designs their induction, credit training and mentoring. Two years later HRD's potential appraisal tells HRM which officers should be fast-tracked and how they should be rewarded.

4. Other ways in which HRD and HRM are related

Relationship	Explanation
Common goal	Both aim at effective use of human resources to achieve organisational goals while satisfying employee needs
Common philosophy	Both regard people as valuable assets; HRD extends the philosophy into a culture of trust and openness
Complementary orientation	HRM is maintenance-oriented (keeps the organisation running); HRD is development-oriented (keeps it growing)
Shared responsibility	HRM is mainly the HR department's job; HRD is every manager's job - but both work through the same line managers
Strategic linkage	Strategic HRM cannot succeed without HRD delivering the competencies the strategy requires

5. Conclusion

HRD is related to HRM first as a part is related to the whole, and second as a partner that receives people and policies from HRM and gives back competence and decision data. The two are interdependent: strong HRM without HRD produces a stable but stagnant organisation, while HRD without HRM has nothing to build on.

Q13

Analyze how a weak HRD climate can affect employee behaviour and organizational performance.

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. What a weak HRD climate means

HRD climate is the perception of employees that the organisation supports their development. It is weak when top management shows little real interest in people, line managers do not coach or give feedback, the OCTAPACE values (openness, confrontation, trust, autonomy, pro-activity, authenticity, collaboration, experimentation) are absent, and HRD mechanisms such as appraisal, training and career planning exist only on paper. The analysis below traces how such a climate shapes individual behaviour and then how that behaviour damages organisational performance.

2. Effects on employee behaviour

1. **Low motivation and involvement** - when development is not valued, employees do only what is required to avoid trouble. Discretionary effort disappears.
2. **Defensive and closed communication** - lack of openness and trust makes people hide problems, avoid honest feedback and communicate only through formal channels. Mistakes are concealed rather than corrected.

3. **Fear of experimentation** - if failures are punished, employees stop taking initiative and stick rigidly to instructions. Innovation dries up.
4. **Dependence and lack of autonomy** - without delegation and pro-activity, employees wait for orders and push every decision upward.
5. **Poor teamwork and politics** - low collaboration and authenticity lead to inter-departmental rivalry, blame games and informal power groups.
6. **Cynicism towards HRD activities** - appraisal is seen as a ritual for increments, training as a holiday, and counselling as a warning session. Employees do not apply what they learn.
7. **Skill stagnation** - without need-based training and job rotation, competencies become obsolete and employees lose confidence.
8. **Withdrawal behaviour** - absenteeism, late-coming, lack of punctuality and, finally, resignation of the best performers who find better development elsewhere.

3. Effects on organisational performance

Behavioural symptom	Organisational consequence
Low motivation and skill stagnation	Falling productivity, poor quality, higher rework and customer complaints
Concealment of problems	Small issues grow into crises; decisions are taken on wrong information
No experimentation	Loss of innovation and competitiveness; slow adoption of technology
Dependence on superiors	Slow decision making, overloaded managers, poor responsiveness to customers
Politics and poor teamwork	Delays in cross-functional projects, duplication of effort, high conflict cost
Cynicism about HRD	Training budgets wasted; appraisal data unreliable, leading to wrong promotions
Exit of talent	High recruitment cost, loss of knowledge, weak succession pipeline

4. The chain reaction

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Weak HRD climate --> Fear, distrust, low motivation --> Poor performance and no learning
      ^
      |
      |_____ Management blames employees, tightens control _____|
  
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A weak climate creates a vicious circle. Poor performance leads management to tighten control instead of building capability, which further weakens the climate. Talented people leave first, so the average competence level keeps falling.

5. Example

A manufacturing unit where the appraisal was used only for confirming increments, feedback was given only when something went wrong and no training needs were ever assessed found that its rejection rate climbed steadily, its young engineers left within two years, and supervisors refused to try a new quality system because "nobody wants to be blamed if it fails."

6. Conclusion

A weak HRD climate first changes behaviour - employees become passive, defensive, un-cooperative and disengaged - and this behaviour then shows up in the organisation's results as low productivity, poor quality, weak innovation, high attrition and slow decision making. Strengthening the climate is therefore not a soft, optional activity but a direct lever on organisational performance.

Q14

Analyze the changing role of an HRD professional as organizations move from traditional personnel administration toward strategic human resource development.

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

The role of the HRD professional has changed along with the way organisations think about people. In the era of **personnel administration** (roughly up to the 1970s), people were a cost to be controlled and the personnel officer's job was to keep records, ensure discipline and arrange occasional training. In the era of **strategic HRD**, people are the main source of competitive advantage, and the HRD professional is expected to help shape and execute business strategy through capability building. The analysis below compares the two roles and explains why the shift happened.

2. The traditional personnel-administration role

- **Focus on maintenance:** attendance, leave, payroll, welfare, statutory compliance, discipline and grievances.
- **Training as an event:** a training officer organised programmes from a standard calendar; needs were rarely analysed and results were rarely evaluated.
- **Reactive and rule-bound:** the personnel department responded to problems after they arose and enforced rules made by others.
- **Low status:** the function reported at a middle level and was not consulted on business decisions.
- **Control orientation:** appraisal was used for increments and control, not development; counselling meant warnings.

3. The strategic HRD role

Dimension	Traditional personnel administrator	Strategic HRD professional
View of people	A cost to be controlled	An asset and a source of competitive advantage
Main task	Record keeping, compliance, discipline	Building competencies, culture and leadership pipeline
Position	Middle-level staff function	Senior level; partner of the CEO and business heads
Time horizon	Present; short term	Present and future; long term
Approach	Reactive, procedural	Proactive, diagnostic, consultative

Dimension	Traditional personnel administrator	Strategic HRD professional
Training	Ad hoc programmes, activity counted	Need-based learning aligned with strategy, results measured
Appraisal	For control and increments	For development, potential identification and career planning
Relationship with line managers	Enforcer of rules	Coach, consultant and partner who makes line managers developers of people
Measurement	Number of programmes, training days	Behaviour change, performance improvement, retention, ROI, HRD audit
Technology	Manual files	HRIS, e-learning, learning analytics

4. New roles that the HRD professional now performs

1. **Strategic advisor** - translates business strategy into competency requirements and learning strategy.
2. **HRD systems designer** - integrates appraisal, potential appraisal, career planning, feedback, training and rewards into one system.
3. **Performance consultant** - diagnoses performance gaps and recommends training or non-training solutions.
4. **Change agent and OD facilitator** - leads culture change, restructuring and team building.
5. **Talent and succession manager** - identifies high-potential employees and builds a leadership pipeline.
6. **Learning architect** - blends on-the-job, classroom and digital learning; creates a learning organisation.
7. **Evaluator and researcher** - measures HRD climate, evaluates programmes and demonstrates business impact.
8. **Employee advocate and counsellor** - balances organisational needs with employee well-being and career aspirations.

5. Why the role changed

- **Competition and globalisation** made speed, quality and innovation - all people-dependent - the basis of survival.
- **Technology** made skills obsolete faster and demanded continuous learning.
- **Knowledge work** shifted value from machines to people's ideas.
- **Research evidence** (Hawthorne studies onwards, and the HRD models of Nadler, Pareek and Rao) showed that development-oriented practices improve performance.
- **Rising employee expectations** for growth, autonomy and meaningful work.

6. Challenges in the new role

The strategic HRD professional must earn credibility with business leaders, learn the language of finance and strategy, manage the tension between short-term results and long-term development, and avoid being pulled back into administrative fire-fighting. Competence in business, technology, data analysis and consulting is now as important as knowledge of training

methods.

7. Conclusion

The HRD professional has moved from being a record-keeper and organiser of classes to being a strategic partner who designs systems, builds culture, develops leaders and measures impact. The shift reflects the movement of organisations themselves - from controlling people as a cost to developing people as their most valuable and least imitable resource.

Q15

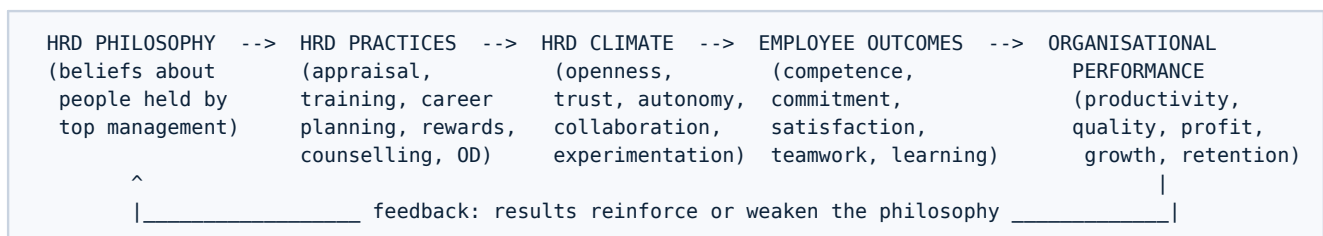
Analyze the relationship among HRD philosophy, HRD climate, and organizational performance.

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. The three concepts

- **HRD philosophy** is the set of basic beliefs and values that top management holds about people - for example, that people are the most important resource, that every person has unlimited potential, that people can be trusted, that development is a shared responsibility and that a healthy culture is worth investing in. The philosophy is the "why" of HRD.
- **HRD climate** is how those beliefs are actually experienced by employees in daily life - the perceived support for development, measured through the general climate, the OCTAPACE values and the working of HRD mechanisms. The climate is the "felt reality" of HRD.
- **Organisational performance** is the achievement of goals - productivity, quality, profitability, growth, innovation, customer satisfaction and employee retention. It is the "result."

2. How the three are related



Relationship 1 - Philosophy shapes climate

The philosophy of top management determines which HRD practices are introduced and, more importantly, how sincerely they are implemented. If leaders genuinely believe that people can be trusted and developed, they delegate, share information, invest in training and treat appraisal as a development tool. Employees perceive this sincerity, and the HRD climate becomes strong. If the philosophy is control-oriented, the same practices are implemented mechanically and the climate remains weak, however impressive the HR manual looks. In short, **climate is philosophy in action**.

Relationship 2 - Climate drives performance

A strong climate produces developmental outcomes - competent, committed, satisfied employees, clear roles, effective teams and a habit of learning. These outcomes translate into higher productivity, better quality, faster problem-solving, innovation, lower attrition and hence better organisational performance. Research by Rao and Abraham and later studies in Indian organisations show a positive relationship between HRD climate scores and measures of performance and commitment.

Relationship 3 - Performance feeds back into philosophy

When development-oriented practices visibly produce results, top management's belief in HRD is reinforced and further investment follows - a virtuous circle. When performance is poor, management may either deepen the development effort (if the philosophy is strong) or abandon it and return to control (if the philosophy was shallow).

3. Analysis of possible combinations

Philosophy	Climate	Likely performance
Strong, development-oriented and practised	Strong	High and sustainable; organisation adapts and grows
Development-oriented on paper but not practised	Weak or cynical	Short-term results may be acceptable, but attrition and stagnation follow
Control-oriented	Weak	Compliance without commitment; low innovation; talent leaves
Changing towards development (new leadership)	Improving	Performance improves gradually as trust is rebuilt

4. Example

Two similar engineering firms adopted the same appraisal format. In Firm A the managing director personally reviewed development plans, managers were rewarded for growing their people and training followed the appraisal - the climate scored high and productivity and retention improved. In Firm B the format was filled in once a year for increments only - employees called it a "formality," the climate remained weak, and the best engineers left. Same practice, different philosophy, different climate, different performance.

5. Conclusion

HRD philosophy, HRD climate and organisational performance form a causal chain with a feedback loop. Philosophy is the root, climate is the visible plant and performance is the fruit. An organisation cannot buy a good climate by copying practices; it has to hold and practise the underlying belief in people. When it does, the climate improves and performance follows, which in turn strengthens the philosophy.

Q16

Evaluate whether HRD should be treated as a strategic function rather than only as an employee training activity.

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. The issue

Many organisations still equate HRD with "training" - a calendar of programmes run by a training department. The question is whether this narrow view is adequate, or whether HRD deserves to be treated as a **strategic function** - one that is derived from business strategy, integrated with all people systems and represented at the top-management level. The evaluation below considers both sides and reaches a judgement.

2. Arguments for treating HRD as a strategic function

1. **People are the source of competitive advantage.** Capital and technology can be bought; a competent, committed and learning workforce cannot. Building such a workforce is a strategic task, not a clerical one.
2. **Strategy needs competencies.** Every strategy - diversification, digitalisation, quality leadership, global expansion - requires specific skills and behaviours. Only a strategic HRD function can anticipate and build them in time.
3. **HRD is a system, not an event.** Training alone cannot improve performance if appraisal, feedback, career planning, rewards and culture pull in other directions. Integration of these subsystems requires strategic authority.
4. **Culture and change.** Organisational change, mergers and new technology succeed or fail on people's readiness. HRD as change agent and culture builder must sit at the strategy table.
5. **Long-term leadership pipeline.** Succession planning and leadership development take years; they must be linked to the long-term plan of the business.
6. **Return on investment.** When HRD is aligned with strategy, training investment produces measurable business results; unaligned training is often wasted (D'Souza's finding that training is treated as a "fringe benefit").
7. **Evidence.** Studies of high-performance organisations - from Indian IT firms to global manufacturers - show that strategic integration of HRD correlates with productivity, innovation and retention.

3. Arguments for a narrower, training-only view (and their limitations)

Argument	Evaluation
Training is concrete and easy to manage and budget	True, but managing activity is not the same as producing results; number of training days says nothing about performance
Small organisations cannot afford elaborate HRD systems	Strategic HRD is about alignment and integration, not size; even a small firm can link learning to its goals
Line managers, not HRD, are responsible for performance	Correct - which is exactly why HRD must strategically equip line managers as developers of people rather than merely run classes
Strategy is the domain of top management	People implications are part of every strategic decision; excluding HRD produces plans that cannot be implemented

4. Risks of confining HRD to training

- Training becomes an isolated, reactive activity chosen from vendors' catalogues.
- No linkage with appraisal or career planning, so learning is not applied and motivation stays low.
- HRD loses credibility and budget in downturns because its value cannot be shown.
- The organisation faces skill shortages and leadership gaps at the moment of strategic change.

5. Balanced view

Treating HRD as strategic does not mean neglecting training. Training remains the most visible and widely used HRD mechanism. The point is that training should be **one instrument within an integrated, strategy-driven HRD system**, with the HRD head participating in strategic

planning, HRD goals derived from business goals, all subsystems linked, line managers accountable for development, and outcomes measured in business terms.

6. Conclusion

On evaluation, the case for HRD as a strategic function is stronger. Training alone addresses today's skill deficiencies; strategic HRD builds the competencies, culture and leadership that tomorrow's strategy will need. Organisations that keep HRD at the level of a training activity get programmes; organisations that treat it strategically get performance and sustainable competitive advantage.

Q17**Identify any two indicators of a supportive HRD climate.**

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of an HRD climate indicator

An **indicator** is an observable sign that tells us whether the developmental climate of an organisation is supportive or weak. Because climate is a perception, indicators are usually measured through survey statements (for example the 38-item HRD Climate Survey of Rao and Abraham) that employees rate on a five-point scale, supported by objective evidence such as training data and attrition figures. Two of the most important indicators are explained in detail, followed by a list of others.

2. Indicator 1 - Top management's belief in people and commitment to their development

- **What it shows:** The extent to which senior management treats human resources as the most important asset, spends time and money on development and participates personally in HRD activities.
- **How it is observed:**
 - A stated HRD philosophy and an adequate, protected training budget even in difficult years.
 - Senior managers attend and address development programmes, mentor young employees and review development plans.
 - Development of subordinates is a key result area in every manager's appraisal.
 - HRD is headed by a senior person who takes part in strategic planning.
- **Why it is a strong indicator:** Employees judge the climate by what leaders do, not by what policies say. Visible commitment at the top signals that learning is genuinely valued and encourages line managers to coach their teams.

3. Indicator 2 - Openness, trust and free flow of feedback (the OCTAPACE values in practice)

- **What it shows:** Whether employees can express ideas and disagreements freely, whether superiors are seen as helpful rather than punishing, and whether performance feedback and counselling are given regularly and constructively.
- **How it is observed:**
 - Employees discuss problems openly with superiors without fear; upward feedback exists.
 - Mistakes are treated as learning opportunities, so people admit weaknesses and seek help.
 - Appraisal is followed by a feedback and counselling discussion focused on development, not only on ratings.

- Employees are encouraged to experiment, take initiative and collaborate across departments.
- **Why it is a strong indicator:** Without openness and trust, no HRD mechanism works - appraisal becomes defensive, counselling becomes a warning and training is never applied. Trust and open feedback are the foundation on which all other development processes rest.

4. Other indicators of a supportive HRD climate

Indicator	Sign of a supportive climate
Need-based training and its use	Training needs are assessed; employees are sponsored on genuine needs and get opportunities to apply learning
Developmental appraisal	Appraisal identifies strengths and weaknesses and leads to development plans
Career planning and potential appraisal	Employees know their career paths; potential is assessed systematically
Rewards and recognition	Good performance and learning are recognised, appreciated and rewarded
Line manager involvement	Supervisors coach, delegate and prepare subordinates for higher responsibilities
Team spirit and collaboration	Departments help each other; team goals are shared
Employee well-being	Organisation shows concern for welfare and work-life balance
Objective evidence	Low attrition of good performers, high internal promotion, active suggestion schemes

5. Conclusion

Two clear indicators of a supportive HRD climate are (1) visible top-management belief in and commitment to developing people and (2) openness and trust reflected in free, constructive feedback. Where these two are present, the other indicators - need-based training, developmental appraisal, career planning, recognition and collaboration - usually follow, and employees describe the organisation as a place where they can grow.

Q18

State any two reasons why an HRD professional needs to understand organizational culture.

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

Organisational culture is the pattern of shared assumptions, values and norms that a group has learnt over time - "the way things are done here." It is deep, stable and largely unwritten. An HRD professional works on people's capabilities, behaviour and the developmental climate; all of these are shaped by culture. Understanding culture is therefore not optional background knowledge for the HRD professional but a precondition for effective work. Two principal reasons are analysed below, followed by other supporting reasons.

2. Reason 1 - HRD systems must be designed to fit (and gradually shape) the culture

- One of the principles of designing an HRD system is that **HRD systems must be designed differently for different organisations**; the basic principles may be common, but the components, their phasing and their processes must suit the organisation's culture, tradition, size, technology and level of skills.
- A practice that works in one culture may fail in another. Example: an open, multi-rater 360-degree feedback system suits a culture that values openness and confrontation; imposed on a hierarchical culture where subordinates fear seniors, it produces dishonest ratings and resentment. Self-appraisal fails where employees believe that admitting weakness will be punished.
- At the same time, HRD's role is not only to adapt to culture but to **balance adaptation and change** - to move the culture towards openness, trust and collaboration (OCTAPACE). To do this the HRD professional must first know accurately what the present culture is, where it supports development and where it blocks it.
- Understanding culture therefore allows the HRD professional to sequence interventions realistically - building trust before introducing peer feedback, for instance - and to avoid mechanical copying of "best practices."

3. Reason 2 - Culture determines whether learning is accepted, transferred and sustained

- Employees interpret every HRD activity through cultural lenses. In a culture where training is seen as a reward or a holiday, participants will not take programmes seriously; in a culture where mistakes are punished, people will not experiment with new skills on the job.
- **Transfer of training** depends on supervisors, peers and norms. If the cultural norm is "do it the way we have always done it," newly trained employees quietly revert to old methods. Rao and Abraham's studies found that employees in many Indian organisations reported little opportunity to try out what they had learnt - a cultural, not a technical, problem.
- Culture also decides which **learning methods** work. Highly collectivist cultures respond to group-based, mentoring and team learning; cultures that value individual achievement respond to competitive assessments and self-paced e-learning.
- An HRD professional who understands these cultural signals can design programmes that are accepted, involve line managers in reinforcing new behaviour and create the conditions in which learning actually changes performance.

4. Other reasons

Reason	Explanation
Diagnosing performance problems correctly	Many "training problems" are really cultural problems (fear, politics, unclear norms); culture knowledge prevents wrong prescriptions
Acting as a change agent	Change management and OD are impossible without understanding the values and resistance points of the culture
Building HRD climate	Climate emerges from culture; improving it requires working with cultural roots
Credibility with line managers and employees	Proposals that respect cultural realities are accepted; culturally blind proposals are resisted

Reason	Explanation
Managing sub-cultures and diversity	Different departments, regions and generations may have different cultures needing different approaches
Linking HRD to strategy	Strategy execution depends on culture; the HRD professional must align culture, capability and strategy

5. Conclusion

An HRD professional needs to understand organisational culture, first, because HRD systems must be designed to fit the culture and to gradually move it in a developmental direction, and second, because culture decides whether learning is accepted, applied on the job and sustained. Culture is the soil in which HRD practices are planted; without knowing the soil, even the best seeds fail to grow.

Q19

Evaluate the likely consequences of implementing HRD practices without considering the existing organizational culture and climate.

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. The issue

Organisations often import HRD practices - 360-degree feedback, assessment centres, forced-ranking appraisal, self-managed teams, e-learning platforms - because they are fashionable or worked elsewhere. The principle of **attention to contextual factors** in HRD system design warns that what is included in the system and how it is introduced must depend on the organisation's culture, tradition, size, technology and existing skills. Ignoring the culture (deep shared assumptions) and the climate (present perceptions about support for development) leads to predictable consequences, evaluated below.

2. Likely consequences

(a) Resistance and rejection

Practices that clash with cultural assumptions are resisted openly or passively. Example: a hierarchical, seniority-respecting culture asked to give upward feedback to bosses will either refuse or give meaningless positive ratings. The practice survives on paper but dies in practice.

(b) Ritualisation - form without substance

When a practice is imposed on an unreceptive climate, people comply mechanically. Appraisal forms are filled at the last minute, training attendance is marked but nothing is learnt, and development plans are copied from previous years. HRD becomes a bureaucratic ritual, which further deepens cynicism.

(c) Loss of trust and damage to the existing climate

Half-hearted or mishandled practices can make the climate worse than before. A "developmental" appraisal that is suddenly used to justify lay-offs destroys trust for years. Confidential counselling data leaking into promotion decisions teaches employees never to be open again.

(d) Distorted data and wrong decisions

Potential appraisal, ratings and surveys collected in a low-trust climate are inaccurate. Decisions on promotion, succession and training built on this data are wrong, which affects performance and fairness.

(e) Failure of transfer of learning

Even good training fails when the culture on the job does not support new behaviour. Employees return from a programme on participative management to a boss who tolerates no questions; the learning is abandoned within weeks.

(f) Wasted resources and loss of credibility of HRD

Budgets, time and consultant fees produce no visible result. Top management concludes that "HRD does not work," and future investment is cut. The HRD function itself loses respectability, which is one of the key principles it must protect.

(g) Conflict, stress and turnover

Sudden cultural mismatch - for example, forced ranking in a collaborative culture - breeds competition, politics and stress; good performers who value the old culture leave.

(h) Sub-culture clashes

Multi-location or merged organisations may have different sub-cultures; a uniform practice may succeed in one plant and fail in another, creating perceptions of inequity.

3. Evaluation - is the outcome always negative?

Situation	Likely result
Practice contradicts core cultural assumptions and is imposed without preparation	Rejection, ritualisation, damage to trust - clearly negative
Practice is culturally neutral (for example, a better training-needs form)	Minor problems; may succeed with limited adaptation
Practice deliberately challenges the culture but is introduced with top-management commitment, communication, pilot testing and support	Can succeed and even shift the culture - HRD's legitimate role is to balance adaptation and change

So the consequences depend on **how far the practice departs from the culture and how it is introduced**. Ignoring culture is the problem; challenging it thoughtfully is not.

4. How to avoid the negative consequences

1. Diagnose culture and measure HRD climate (for example with the Rao-Abraham survey) before designing.
2. Adapt the practice - modify its form, sequence and pace to fit the context.
3. Prepare the ground - build trust and openness, train line managers, communicate the purpose.
4. Pilot in a receptive unit, learn, then scale.

5. Secure visible top-management commitment and align rewards with the new behaviour.
6. Evaluate and revise continuously.

5. Conclusion

Implementing HRD practices without regard to culture and climate usually produces resistance, empty rituals, distorted data, wasted resources, loss of trust and eventually loss of credibility for HRD itself. The lesson is not that culture should never be challenged - HRD exists partly to move culture towards openness and development - but that every practice must be introduced with an accurate understanding of the cultural ground and the climate on which it will land.

Q20

Design a basic HRD framework for an organization that wants to improve employee capability while aligning development efforts with organizational goals.

Unit 1 | 8 Marks

1. Design principles behind the framework

A good HRD framework should (i) be **aligned with organisational strategy**, (ii) be **needs-driven**, (iii) be **integrated** so that its subsystems reinforce one another, (iv) **involve line managers** as developers of people, (v) be **scalable and flexible**, (vi) build **enabling capabilities** - not only skills but also problem-solving ability and a healthy culture - and (vii) be **evaluated** and continuously improved. The framework below is organised as a cycle so that development always starts from goals and ends with measured results that feed back into the next cycle.

2. The framework

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+-----+
| LAYER 1  STRATEGIC DIRECTION |
| Vision, business goals --> HRD philosophy and policy --> HRD goals |
+-----+
| LAYER 2  CAPABILITY REQUIREMENTS |
| Competency mapping for each role --> Training Needs Assessment |
| (organisation / task / person analysis) --> Capability gaps |
+-----+
| LAYER 3  INTEGRATED HRD SUBSYSTEMS |
| Performance appraisal <-> Feedback and counselling <-> Training and |
| development <-> Potential appraisal <-> Career and succession planning |
| <-> Rewards and recognition <-> Organisation development |
+-----+
| LAYER 4  ENABLERS |
| Top-management commitment | Line managers as coaches | HRD department |
| as facilitator | Budget and technology (LMS, HRIS) | OCTAPACE climate |
+-----+
| LAYER 5  EVALUATION AND RENEWAL |
| Kirkpatrick levels 1-4 | HRD climate survey | HRD audit | KPIs --> |
| feedback to Layer 1 | | | |
+-----+

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3. Components explained

Component	Purpose	Key activities
HRD philosophy and goals	Ensure alignment	Top management states beliefs about people; HRD goals are derived from business goals (for example "reduce defect rate by 30% through multi-skilling")
Competency mapping	Define what capability means	For each role, list the knowledge, skills and attitudes required at "meets" and "exceeds" levels
Training Needs Assessment	Find the gaps	Organisation, task and person analysis; performance data; surveys; supervisor inputs
Performance appraisal	Set expectations and measure	Joint goal setting (KRAs linked to business goals), self-appraisal, mid-year review, annual review
Feedback and counselling	Convert appraisal into development	Structured feedback discussion; individual development plan (IDP) agreed for every employee
Training and development	Close the gaps	Blend of on-the-job (coaching, job rotation, projects), off-the-job (workshops, case studies) and e-learning; induction, technical, behavioural and leadership tracks
Potential appraisal	Identify future capability	Assessment centres, psychometric tests, potential ratings separate from performance ratings
Career and succession planning	Retain and prepare talent	Career paths, talent pools for key positions, fast-track development for high potentials
Rewards and recognition	Reinforce learning and performance	Link increments and recognition to performance and to acquired competencies
Organisation development	Build culture and teams	Team building, survey feedback, quality circles, participative problem solving
Evaluation	Prove and improve	Reaction, learning, behaviour and results for training; annual HRD climate survey; HRD audit; dashboard of KPIs

4. Roles and responsibilities

- **Top management:** approves philosophy, provides budget, reviews HRD dashboard quarterly, models learning behaviour.
- **Line managers:** set goals, coach, give feedback, identify needs, support transfer of learning; development of subordinates is a KRA in their appraisal.
- **HRD department:** designs and integrates the subsystems, facilitates programmes, maintains data and evaluates.

- **Employees:** own their development plan, seek feedback and apply learning.

5. Implementation road map

1. **Months 1-3:** Philosophy and policy, competency mapping for critical roles, baseline HRD climate survey.
2. **Months 3-6:** Redesign appraisal with goal alignment; train managers in feedback and coaching; first TNA.
3. **Months 6-12:** Roll out training tracks and e-learning; introduce IDPs; pilot potential appraisal for one level.
4. **Year 2:** Career paths and succession plans for key positions; link rewards; full evaluation cycle.
5. **Ongoing:** annual review of HRD goals against business goals; refresh competency maps as strategy changes.

6. Measures of success

Closure of identified skill gaps; improvement in performance KPIs tied to HRD goals; percentage of key positions with ready successors; internal promotion rate; retention of high performers; improved HRD climate scores; training evaluated at behaviour and results levels.

7. Conclusion

This basic HRD framework starts from organisational goals, translates them into competency requirements, closes the gaps through an integrated set of subsystems supported by committed leaders and coaching line managers, and closes the loop through evaluation. It improves employee capability precisely because every development effort is anchored in what the organisation is trying to achieve.

UNIT 2

HRD Systems, Subsystems and Strategic Integration

This unit looks at HRD as a system: its structure and components, the individual subsystems (performance appraisal, potential appraisal, training, career planning, feedback and counselling, rewards, OD), the principles for designing effective HRD practices, how the subsystems depend on one another and why the whole system must be aligned with organisational strategy.

Key point: Names and models to remember: **Pareek and Rao** (integrated HRD system, L&T 1975), **Werner and DeSimone** (four-step HRD process: needs assessment - design - implementation - evaluation), **Kirkpatrick** (four levels of evaluation), **OCTAPACE** (HRD culture), **Standard performance - Actual performance = Gap**.

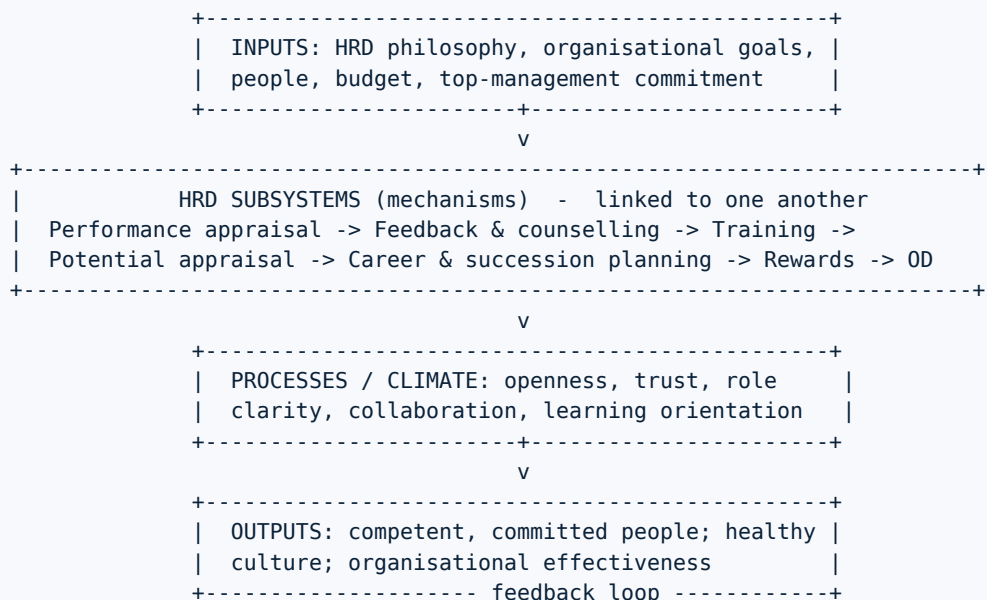
Questions 21 to 40 | 160 marks

Q21**Explain the structure of an HRD system and describe its major components.**

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of an HRD system

A **system** is a set of inter-related parts working together for a common purpose. An **HRD system** is the set of inter-linked mechanisms (subsystems), processes and structural arrangements through which an organisation continuously develops the competencies of its people, builds a development-oriented culture and thereby achieves its goals. Pareek and Rao, who designed the first integrated HRD system at Larsen & Toubro in 1975, emphasised that the strength of HRD lies not in any single mechanism but in the way all the mechanisms are **integrated** and supported by a common philosophy.

2. Structure of an HRD system

Structurally, the system has five arrangements (as given in the prescribed notes):

- Acknowledging the existence of HRD** - HRD must be recognised as a distinct function with an HRD manager who has access to the CEO, so that development is not buried under routine personnel work.
- Establishing priorities and status for the function** - HRD should be placed at a high level and given identity as a major function; its head should be a senior manager. Credibility and usefulness depend on this respectability.
- Balancing differentiation and integration** - the HRD department usually covers training and development, personnel administration and industrial relations. These have distinct identities and should be differentiated (different people for OD, training, appraisal), yet integrated through regular coordination so that, for example, the training officer's inputs reach the appraisal process.
- Linkage between internal and external systems** - HRD must link with other internal functions (corporate planning, finance, production, marketing) and with external resources (consultants, institutes, professional bodies).

5. **Controlling and monitoring mechanisms** - reviews, feedback and evaluation of every HRD activity so that inputs are available for designing the next cycle.

3. Major components (subsystems) of an HRD system

Component	Purpose	Key features
Performance appraisal	Assess performance against agreed goals and identify development needs	Joint goal setting, self-appraisal, review discussion, development plan
Feedback and performance counselling	Help the employee understand strengths and weaknesses and plan improvement	Regular, specific, supportive dialogue between superior and subordinate
Potential appraisal	Judge capability for higher or different roles	Assessment centres, psychometric tests, potential ratings separate from performance
Career planning and development	Match individual aspirations with organisational opportunities	Career paths, individual development plans, job rotation
Training and development	Build knowledge, skills and attitudes for present and future roles	TNA, design, delivery, evaluation; on-the-job, off-the-job, e-learning
Succession planning	Ensure ready replacements for key positions	Talent pools, fast-track development
Rewards and recognition	Reinforce performance and learning	Monetary and non-monetary rewards linked to performance and competence
Employee welfare and quality of work life	Sustain motivation and well-being	Welfare measures, work-life balance, participation
Organisation development	Improve processes, teams and culture	Survey feedback, team building, quality circles, change management
HRD department and data system	Coordinate, record and analyse	HR information system, training records, HRD audit

4. Supporting elements

Along with the subsystems, an HRD system needs an **HRD philosophy** owned by top management, **line managers** who take responsibility for developing their people, a **supportive climate** (OCTAPACE values) and a **phased implementation** - geographically (unit by unit), vertically (level by level) or functionally (function by function) - so that each part is introduced with proper preparation.

5. Conclusion

The structure of an HRD system consists of recognised and senior placement of the function, differentiated yet integrated subsystems, linkages with internal and external systems and built-in monitoring. Its major components - appraisal, feedback and counselling, potential appraisal, career planning, training, succession planning, rewards and OD - work like the organs of one body; each supplies inputs to the others, and together they produce competent people and an effective organisation.

Q22**Explain performance appraisal as an HRD subsystem and state its importance for employee development.**

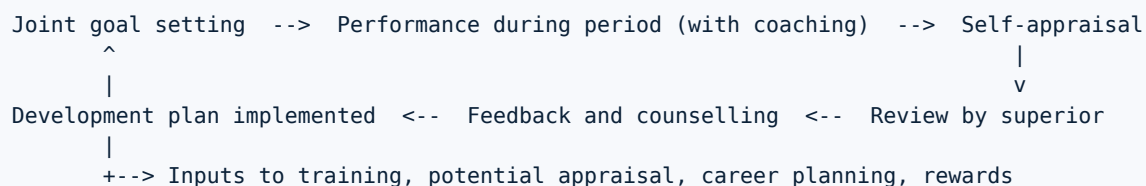
Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning

Performance appraisal is the systematic and periodic assessment of an employee's performance against agreed standards or objectives, followed by a discussion of the results with the employee. As a traditional personnel activity it was used mainly for control decisions - confirmation, increments, promotion and discipline. As an **HRD subsystem**, its primary purpose is different: it is a tool for **understanding and developing the employee**, identifying strengths and weaknesses, planning improvement and feeding information to other subsystems such as training, counselling, potential appraisal and career planning.

2. Performance appraisal as an HRD subsystem - key features

1. **Development is the main objective.** Rao and Abraham found that only about 27 per cent of the organisations they surveyed had development as the main objective of appraisal; an HRD-oriented appraisal changes this priority.
2. **Joint goal setting.** At the beginning of the period the superior and subordinate agree on key result areas (KRAs) and performance standards that are linked to departmental and organisational goals, so that the employee knows exactly what is expected.
3. **Self-appraisal.** The employee first assesses his or her own performance and the factors that helped or hindered it; this makes the process participative and reduces defensiveness.
4. **Performance analysis.** The discussion focuses not only on "how much" but on "why" - which capabilities, resources, systems or behaviours affected results.
5. **Review discussion and feedback.** The appraisal ends in a face-to-face dialogue in which feedback is given, and it leads naturally into performance counselling.
6. **Identification of development needs.** Training needs, job rotation requirements, coaching needs and career aspirations are recorded and passed to the training and career planning subsystems.
7. **Separation from salary decisions.** The developmental discussion is held separately from the reward discussion so that the employee can talk about weaknesses openly.
8. **Multiple inputs.** Modern methods such as 360-degree feedback, behaviourally anchored rating scales, critical incidents and management by objectives are used along with the traditional ranking and grading methods.

3. The appraisal cycle**4. Importance for employee development**

Importance	Explanation
Role clarity	Goal setting removes ambiguity about what the job requires and how success is measured
Self-awareness	Self-appraisal and feedback help the employee recognise strengths and weaknesses
Identification of training needs	Weaknesses become the basis for need-based training rather than random programmes
Motivation	Recognition of good performance and clear improvement targets satisfy needs for achievement and growth
Better superior-subordinate relationship	Regular dialogue builds trust, openness and a coaching relationship
Foundation for potential appraisal and career planning	Consistent performance data help judge readiness for higher roles and plan careers
Fair reward and promotion decisions	Objective data make HR decisions equitable, which strengthens the HRD climate
Organisational learning	Aggregated appraisal data reveal systemic problems - poor tools, unclear policies - that need OD interventions

5. Conditions for effectiveness

The appraisal must be based on clear, agreed standards; appraisers must be trained to observe, rate and give feedback; the process must be seen as fair and confidential; and the outcomes must actually be used - if development plans are never acted upon, employees quickly treat the appraisal as a ritual.

6. Conclusion

As an HRD subsystem, performance appraisal is not a report card but a developmental conversation supported by data. Through joint goal setting, self-appraisal, feedback and development planning, it gives the employee role clarity, self-awareness and direction, and it supplies the information on which training, counselling, potential appraisal, career planning and rewards depend. That is why it is often called the backbone of the HRD system.

Q23

Describe training as an HRD subsystem and explain how it contributes to employee development.

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of training

Training is a planned effort by the organisation to facilitate employees' learning of job-related knowledge, skills and attitudes (Noe). It aims at improving performance in the present job, while **development** prepares people for future roles and **education** builds general understanding. Together, training, education and development are the three learning activities that Nadler identified as the core of HRD.

Training is the **most widely used HRD mechanism**; in some organisations "HRD" and "training" are even used as synonyms. But within an HRD system training is a subsystem that receives inputs from other subsystems (appraisal, potential appraisal, counselling) and delivers

outputs to them (developed employees).

2. Training as an HRD subsystem

(a) Inputs to training

- **Performance appraisal and performance analysis** identify what the employee cannot do well.
- **Potential appraisal and career planning** identify what the employee must learn for the next role.
- **Counselling** reveals attitudinal and behavioural needs.
- **Organisational strategy and technology changes** create new competency requirements.

(b) The training cycle

STAGE 1	Training Needs Assessment	(organisation, task and person analysis)
STAGE 2	Planning and design	(objectives, content, methods, trainers, budget)
STAGE 3	Implementation / delivery	(on-the-job, off-the-job, e-learning)
STAGE 4	Evaluation	(reaction, learning, behaviour, results)

(c) Outputs of training

Competent employees, improved performance data for the next appraisal, evidence of learning for potential appraisal and career decisions, and a stronger learning culture.

3. Types of training within the subsystem

Type	Purpose	Example
Induction / orientation	Familiarise new employees with the organisation, job and culture	Company history, policies, safety, team introductions
Job / technical training	Build specific skills for the present job	Machine operation, software, accounting standards
Behavioural training	Improve attitudes, communication and interpersonal skills	Team work, customer handling, conflict management
Supervisory and management development	Prepare people for leadership roles	Delegation, decision making, performance counselling
Refresher and re-skilling	Update obsolete skills	New technology, new regulations
Cross-functional / multi-skilling	Build flexibility and understanding of the whole system	Job rotation, cross-training

4. How training contributes to employee development

1. **Removes skill deficiencies** and raises current job performance, which builds confidence and self-esteem.
2. **Prepares for future roles** - management development and multi-skilling make promotions and transfers possible.
3. **Develops attitudes and behaviour** - behavioural training improves teamwork, communication and customer orientation.

4. **Improves employability and adaptability** - updated skills protect the employee from obsolescence and make change less frightening.
5. **Increases motivation and satisfaction** - investment in training shows that the organisation values the person; it satisfies growth needs and reduces turnover.
6. **Supports career planning** - each training input is a step on the individual development plan.
7. **Builds a learning habit** - regular training creates a culture in which continuous learning is normal.
8. **Generates organisational benefits** that come back to employees - higher productivity, fewer accidents, better quality, a stronger company image and more opportunities.

5. Conditions for training to actually develop people

Studies of Indian organisations (Rao and Abraham; Jain; D'Souza) found that training often gives a poor return because employees are sent as a "fringe benefit," needs are not analysed, and there is little opportunity to try out what was learnt. For training to contribute to development, therefore, it must be **need-based**, linked to appraisal and career plans, supported by supervisors who allow application of the new skills (transfer of training), and **evaluated** at the levels of behaviour and results, not just reaction.

6. Conclusion

Training is the action arm of the HRD system: it converts the needs identified by appraisal, potential appraisal and counselling into actual capability. When it is need-based, integrated with the other subsystems and followed by application and evaluation, training develops employees in skills, attitudes and confidence, and prepares them for both present and future roles.

Q24**Explain career planning and potential appraisal as HRD subsystems.**

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

Two HRD subsystems look explicitly at the **future** of the employee. **Potential appraisal** asks "What could this person do in the future?" and **career planning** asks "Where should this person go, and how do we get there?" The two are closely linked: a meaningful career planning system must be based on potential appraisal, because past performance alone is not a reliable indicator of future potential.

2. Potential appraisal

Meaning

Potential appraisal is the systematic assessment of an employee's **capability to perform higher-level or different roles** in the future - roles that may require competencies not fully used in the present job. It is different from performance appraisal, which looks at results already achieved in the current role.

Features

- Focuses on latent abilities - conceptual thinking, leadership, decision making, initiative, learning ability - rather than on current output.

- Uses multiple methods: assessment centres (in-basket exercises, group discussions, business simulations, role plays), psychometric and aptitude tests, structured interviews, supervisor ratings on potential attributes and a review of performance history.
- Is conducted against defined **role requirements** of the target positions, so the organisation must first describe the competencies needed at higher levels.
- Results are shared with the employee and used for development, placement and succession decisions.

Steps

1. Identify the roles and the competencies required for them.
2. Choose assessment mechanisms for each competency.
3. Assess the employee through the chosen mechanisms and multiple assessors.
4. Communicate the results and prepare a development plan.
5. Link the results to career planning, succession planning and training.

Status in India

Pareek and Rao observed that most Indian organisations collect potential data on the performance appraisal form, which mixes the two purposes. Systematic potential appraisal is still limited to larger companies, though the use of assessment centres is growing.

3. Career planning

Meaning

Career planning is the systematic process by which an individual selects career goals and the path to those goals, and by which the organisation helps employees plan their careers in line with its own future needs. A career plan is a blueprint mapping the employee's growth from entry to retirement.

Characteristics

- It is a **process**, not an event; it is continuous because both the person and the environment keep changing.
- It is primarily the **individual's responsibility**, but the organisation must provide guidance, information and counselling.
- Its basic aim is the **integration of individual and organisational needs**.

Process

Identify individual needs and aspirations --> Analyse career opportunities in the organisation
--> Identify match and mismatch --> Formulate and implement strategies
(training, rotation, mentoring, projects) --> Review career plans periodically

Objectives

To attract and retain the right people; to map careers suited to ability and willingness to be developed; to ensure better use of human resources through satisfied and productive employees; to build a stable workforce with lower turnover; and to improve morale by helping employees fulfil their potential.

4. How the two subsystems work together

Aspect	Potential appraisal	Career planning
Question answered	How far and in what direction can the person grow?	What path should the person follow to grow?
Time focus	Future capability	Future movement
Input from	Performance appraisal, assessment centres, tests	Potential appraisal, individual aspirations, manpower plan
Output to	Career planning, succession planning, training	Training, job rotation, succession planning, rewards
Benefit to employee	Knows strengths and development areas	Sees a clear, realistic growth path
Benefit to organisation	Identifies talent pool early	Retains talent and fills positions internally

Potential appraisal supplies the objective assessment on which realistic career plans are built; career planning gives the potential appraisal results a practical direction. Together they feed **succession planning**, which ensures that key positions always have ready replacements.

5. Example

A bank assesses its young officers through an assessment centre and identifies those with high potential for branch leadership. For each, a career plan is prepared - credit exposure in year 2, a rural branch posting in year 3, a leadership programme in year 4 and a deputy branch manager role in year 5 - with mentoring and reviews along the way.

6. Conclusion

Potential appraisal identifies what a person could become; career planning charts how the person will get there. As HRD subsystems they turn the organisation's attention from yesterday's results to tomorrow's capability, motivate employees with a visible future and give the organisation a dependable internal supply of talent.

Q25
Explain the role of feedback and counselling in an HRD system.

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning

Feedback is information given to an employee about his or her performance and behaviour - what was done well, what fell short and what effect it had. **Performance counselling** is the purposeful, confidential conversation between a superior (or a trained counsellor) and an employee in which feedback is discussed, causes are explored and the employee is helped to plan improvement and development. Counselling may also address emotional and personal problems - job dissatisfaction, stress, conflict, resistance to change - that affect work.

In an HRD system, feedback and counselling form the **bridge between appraisal and development**. Appraisal produces data; feedback communicates it; counselling converts it into insight and an action plan; training, career planning and rewards then act on the plan.

2. Purposes of feedback and counselling in HRD

1. **To help employees know where they stand** - reducing ambiguity and anxiety about performance.
2. **To recognise strengths and weaknesses** so that development is targeted.
3. **To identify causes of performance problems** - skill, knowledge, attitude, resources or systems - and choose the right remedy.
4. **To build commitment to improvement** through joint problem solving rather than instructions.
5. **To strengthen the superior-subordinate relationship** on the basis of trust, openness and mutual respect.
6. **To release emotional tension**, reassure, clarify thinking and reorient the employee (the classic counselling functions of advice, reassurance, communication, release of tension, clarified thinking and reorientation).
7. **To support career development** - discussing aspirations and realistic paths.
8. **To reinforce the HRD climate** - regular, supportive feedback is one of the strongest signals that the organisation cares about development.

3. The counselling process

- Step 1 Describe the observed behaviour or performance (specific facts, not personality)
 Step 2 Invite the employee's view and explore reasons (listen, empathise)
 Step 3 Agree on a solution and development actions (emphasise confidentiality)
 Step 4 Summarise and obtain commitment to change
 Step 5 Follow up and review progress

Eisenberg and Delaney list the aims of counselling as helping people understand themselves, make sound decisions, set achievable growth goals, plan the future, solve personal and interpersonal problems, cope with difficult situations, control self-defeating emotions and acquire positive self-regard.

4. Characteristics of effective feedback

Effective feedback is...	Ineffective feedback is...
Specific and descriptive - based on observed behaviour and data	Vague and evaluative - "you have a bad attitude"
Timely - given soon after the event and regularly	Saved up and delivered once a year
Balanced - covers strengths as well as areas for improvement	Only negative, given when something goes wrong
Focused on things the person can change	Focused on personality or things beyond control
Two-way - invites the employee's perspective	One-way lecture
Followed by support - training, coaching, resources	Followed by nothing

5. Role within the HRD system

- **From appraisal:** feedback and counselling are the natural conclusion of the appraisal cycle.
- **To training:** counselling identifies genuine training needs and motivates the employee to learn.
- **To potential appraisal and career planning:** discussion of aspirations and capabilities feeds career plans.
- **To rewards:** recognition given during feedback is itself a non-monetary reward.
- **To OD:** patterns emerging across many counselling sessions reveal systemic issues - work overload, unclear roles, poor tools - that need organisational intervention.

6. Practice in Indian organisations

Rao and Abraham found that about 80 per cent of surveyed companies required executives to counsel subordinates, but in most cases feedback was given in a threatening way or as a warning rather than as development. Giving warnings and enforcing norms are part of a manager's job, but counselling in the HRD sense helps the employee recognise potential and prepares him or her for self-development. Training managers in counselling skills is therefore essential.

7. Conclusion

Feedback and counselling are the human, dialogic core of the HRD system. They convert appraisal data into self-awareness, commitment and action plans, strengthen the relationship between superiors and subordinates, and feed every other subsystem. Without them, appraisal becomes a form, training becomes a guess and career planning becomes wishful thinking.

Q26**Describe the major principles for designing effective HRD practices.**

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

HRD systems must be designed differently for different organisations. The basic principles remain the same, but the specific components, their relationships, phasing and processes vary with the organisation's culture, size, technology and existing practices. Designing an integrated HRD system therefore requires a thorough understanding of the principles of HRD and a diagnosis of the organisation's culture, existing practices, employee perceptions and developmental climate. The principles below are drawn from the classic work of Pareek and Rao and from the prescribed notes on HRD system design.

2. Principles relating to focus

1. **Focus on enabling capabilities.** The primary purpose of HRD is to increase the organisation's "enabling" capabilities - development of human resources, organisational health, problem-solving capability, diagnostic ability and employee productivity and commitment - not merely to run programmes.
2. **Organisational strategy alignment.** The HRD system should be tightly aligned with the strategic aims of the organisation and should build the talents, knowledge and abilities that those aims require.
3. **Needs-driven approach.** A thorough analysis of the present and future needs of the organisation, teams and individuals should be the basis of design; needs decide priorities and

objectives.

4. **Balancing adaptation and change in the culture.** HRD systems should suit the culture, yet HRD's role is also to modify the culture to increase effectiveness. The design should anticipate change and take the organisation forward.
5. **Attention to contextual factors.** What is included, how it is sub-divided and even the titles used should depend on culture, tradition, size, technology, existing skill levels and available support.

3. Principles relating to structure

6. **Building linkages with other functions.** HRD should strengthen corporate planning, budgeting, finance, marketing and production; these linkages are extremely important.
7. **Balancing specialisation and diffusion of the function.** HRD involves specialised skills, but line people must be involved; action is the responsibility of line managers, and HRD should strengthen their roles.
8. **Ensuring respectability for the function.** HRD should be instituted at a high level, with a senior manager as head, because its credibility and usefulness depend on this.
9. **Balancing differentiation and integration.** Personnel administration, HRD/training and industrial relations have distinct identities and should be differentiated within the department, yet integrated through coordination so that inputs flow between them.
10. **Establishing linkage mechanisms.** Formal mechanisms - task forces, committees, regular reviews - should connect HRD with line managers and with other HR functions.

4. Principles relating to functioning

11. **Integration and coherence.** The subsystems - appraisal, training, career planning, counselling, rewards, OD - must support and reinforce one another rather than run as separate activities.
12. **Developing monitoring mechanisms and reviews.** Feedback on each programme, matching qualitative and quantitative judgements, and periodic HRD audit keep the system healthy.
13. **Balancing internal and external resources.** Develop internal experts for cost-effectiveness and continuity, and use external experts where special knowledge is required.
14. **Planning the growth of the function (phasing).** Introduce the system in phases - geographical (unit by unit), vertical (level by level) or functional (function by function) - with proper preparation rather than rushing.
15. **Customisation and stakeholder involvement.** Involve employees, managers and leaders in the design, and personalise learning so that it is relevant and owned.
16. **Scalability and flexibility.** The system should grow or shrink with the organisation and respond to changes in strategy.
17. **Continuous learning and improvement, integration of technology, accountability and measurement, and sustainability** - a culture of ongoing learning, use of technology (LMS, HRIS, e-learning), KPIs to measure results and return on investment, and resources planned for the long term.

5. Summary table

Group	Principles
Focus	Enabling capabilities; strategy alignment; needs-driven; balance adaptation and change; contextual factors
Structure	Linkages with other functions; specialisation vs diffusion; respectability; differentiation vs integration; linkage mechanisms
Functioning	Integration; monitoring and review; internal-external balance; phased growth; stakeholder involvement; flexibility; technology; measurement; sustainability

6. Conclusion

Effective HRD practices are designed on principles rather than copied from other organisations. They focus on enabling capabilities aligned with strategy and based on real needs; they are structured so that HRD is respected, differentiated yet integrated and linked with line functions; and they function as a coherent, monitored, phased and continuously improving system. Applying these principles is what turns a collection of HR activities into a genuine HRD system.

Q27

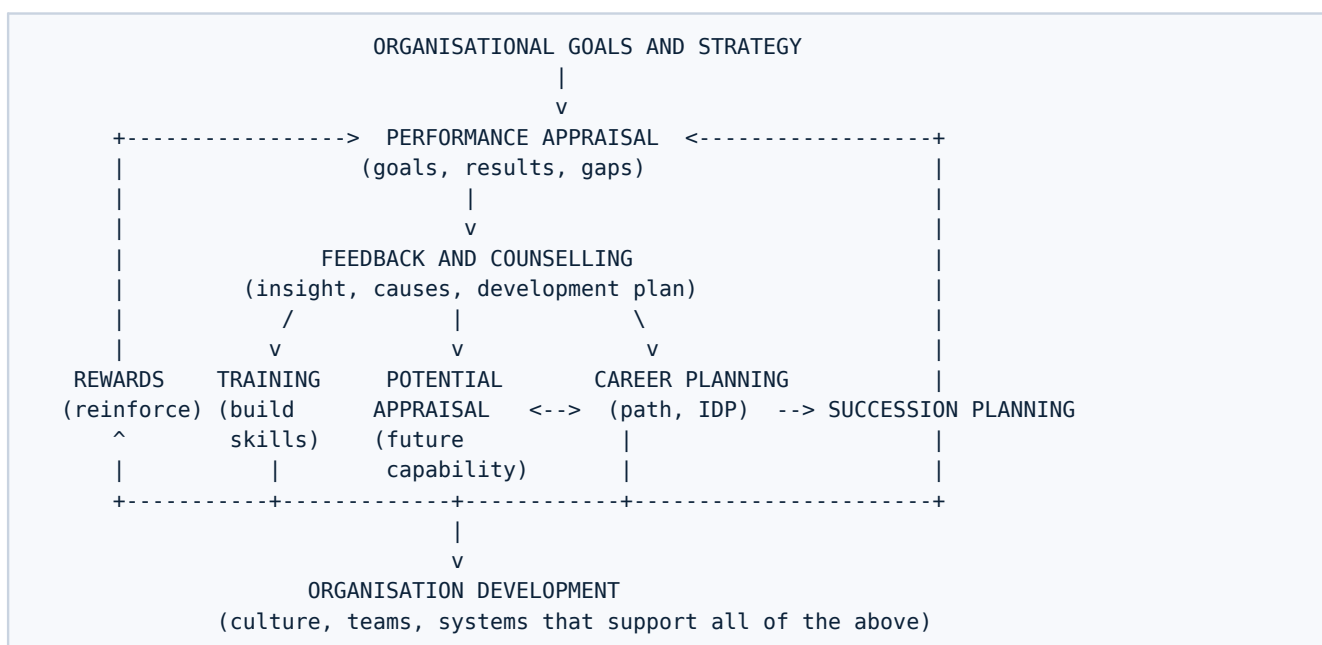
Explain how the major HRD subsystems are interrelated within an organization.

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

The subsystems of HRD - performance appraisal, feedback and counselling, potential appraisal, career planning, rewards and organisation development - are not independent activities. Each one produces information or capability that the others need, and each depends on the others to make its own output useful. Pareek and Rao described this as an **integrated HRD system** in which the mechanisms reinforce one another; when one is missing or weak, the effectiveness of all the others falls.

2. The web of interrelationships



3. Specific linkages explained

Linkage	How the subsystems depend on each other
Appraisal -> Feedback and counselling	Appraisal produces data on performance; counselling communicates it and turns it into a development plan. Without counselling, appraisal is a report card; without appraisal, counselling has no facts
Appraisal and counselling -> Training	Training needs are identified from appraisal, performance analysis and counselling. Training that is not based on these becomes a "fringe benefit" with poor return
Training -> Appraisal	The next appraisal measures whether training changed performance; this evaluates the training and identifies further needs
Appraisal -> Potential appraisal	Consistent performance data are one input for judging potential, though potential also needs separate assessment of future-oriented competencies
Potential appraisal -> Career planning	Career plans are realistic only when based on assessed potential; otherwise they become wish lists
Career planning -> Training and job rotation	The individual development plan prescribes the training, projects and rotations needed to move along the career path
Potential appraisal and career planning -> Succession planning	High-potential employees with defined career paths form the talent pool for key positions
Appraisal -> Rewards	Rewards linked to appraised performance and demonstrated competence reinforce the right behaviour and make appraisal credible
Rewards -> Motivation to learn	Recognition of learning and improvement motivates employees to use training and act on feedback
All subsystems -> Organisation development	Aggregated appraisal, counselling and survey data reveal systemic problems; OD interventions (team building, role clarification, culture change) create the climate in which the other subsystems can work
OD and HRD climate -> All subsystems	Openness and trust are preconditions for honest self-appraisal, candid counselling and willingness to experiment with new skills

4. Example of the chain in action

An engineer's appraisal shows excellent technical results but weak coordination with other departments. In the counselling session the cause emerges - lack of exposure to project management. Training in project management is arranged, and a cross-functional project is assigned (job rotation). The potential appraisal a year later shows leadership promise, so the career plan marks her for a project-lead role, the succession plan lists her as a future department head, and the reward system recognises her improved coordination. Each subsystem used the output of the previous one.

5. Consequences of breaking the links

If appraisal is not followed by counselling, employees do not know what to improve. If training is chosen without appraisal data, it is irrelevant. If potential appraisal results do not lead to career plans, high-potential people leave. If rewards ignore appraisal, the appraisal loses credibility. Poor coordination among subsystems is therefore one of the main reasons why HRD investments fail to improve performance.

6. Conclusion

The HRD subsystems are interrelated like links in a chain and like organs in a body: appraisal generates data, counselling creates insight, training builds capability, potential appraisal and career planning give direction, succession planning secures the future, rewards reinforce and OD provides the healthy environment. Their strength lies in their integration - designed together, sequenced sensibly and continuously exchanging information.

Q28**Explain the need for integrating HRD practices with organizational strategy.**

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of integration with strategy

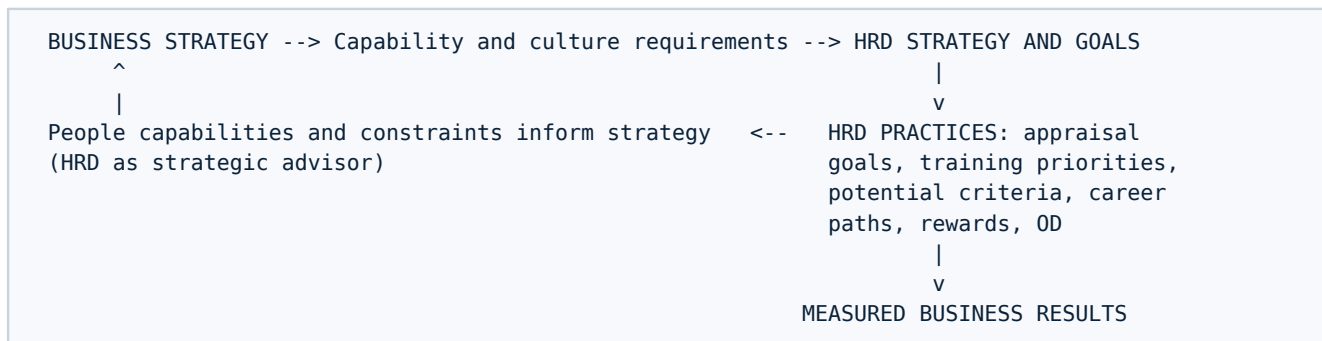
Organisational strategy is the long-term plan by which an organisation intends to achieve its goals - for example cost leadership, quality differentiation, innovation, diversification, digital transformation or geographic expansion. **Integrating HRD with strategy** means deriving HRD goals from the strategy, building the specific competencies and culture that the strategy requires, and involving HRD in the formulation of strategy so that people considerations shape the plan. The first principle of HRD system design in the prescribed notes is precisely **organisational strategy alignment**.

2. Why integration is necessary

1. **Strategy is executed by people.** A strategy is only a document until employees have the knowledge, skills and attitudes to implement it. A quality strategy needs statistical and problem-solving skills; a customer-intimacy strategy needs service and relationship skills; a digital strategy needs technology skills. HRD is the function that builds these.
2. **Competency building takes time.** Skills, leadership and culture cannot be bought overnight. Only HRD that knows the strategy in advance can develop, say, forty plant managers for expansion three years ahead.
3. **Avoiding wasted investment.** Training that is not linked to strategy produces programmes nobody needs; Indian studies (D'Souza; Rao and Abraham) found training treated as a "fringe benefit" with poor return. Alignment ensures that every rupee spent on development contributes to a business goal.
4. **Coherence of HRD subsystems.** Strategy provides the common reference point that aligns appraisal goals, training priorities, potential criteria, career paths and rewards. Without it, the subsystems pull in different directions.
5. **Culture as strategic capability.** Strategies such as innovation or customer focus require corresponding cultures - experimentation, openness, collaboration. HRD's OD role shapes culture, and it must know which culture the strategy demands.
6. **Managing change.** Strategic shifts - mergers, new technology, restructuring - succeed only when people are prepared; HRD integrated with strategy plans this preparation instead of reacting to resistance later.
7. **Competitive advantage and sustainability.** People-based capabilities are hard for competitors to imitate. HRD aligned with strategy converts human potential into a lasting advantage.
8. **Credibility and resources for HRD.** When HRD can show its contribution to strategic goals in business terms, it earns a seat at the top table and stable budgets.

9. **Stage of organisational life cycle.** The HRD goals of an embryonic, high-growth, mature or ageing company differ; strategy tells HRD which stage the organisation is in and what it therefore needs - strong managers, intellectual capital, disciplined execution or revitalisation.

3. How the linkage works



4. Illustration

Strategy	What HRD must build
Cost leadership	Multi-skilling, process discipline, waste-reduction skills, productivity-linked rewards
Differentiation through quality	Quality tools, problem solving, quality circles, customer-complaint analysis
Innovation	Creativity techniques, experimentation culture, cross-functional teams, tolerance for failure
Rapid expansion	Leadership pipeline, fast-track development, standardised induction
Digital transformation	Technology re-skilling, e-learning platforms, change management

5. Consequences of non-integration

Skill shortages at critical moments, training budgets spent on irrelevant programmes, appraisal goals disconnected from business priorities, high-potential employees developed for roles that no longer exist, cultural resistance to strategic change and, finally, loss of credibility for the HRD function.

6. Conclusion

HRD practices must be integrated with organisational strategy because strategy is executed through people, capability takes time to build, resources must not be wasted and the HRD subsystems need a common direction. When HRD is derived from and feeds into strategy, it stops being a support activity and becomes the mechanism through which the organisation's plans become reality.

Q29

An organization has an appraisal system but employees report that it does not help their development. Apply HRD principles to improve the appraisal process.

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Diagnosis of the problem

An appraisal that "does not help development" usually shows some of these symptoms: it is used only to decide increments and promotions; goals were never agreed at the start; the employee is rated once a year without discussion; ratings are subjective and appraisers are untrained; there is no self-appraisal; no feedback or counselling follows; identified needs are never converted into training or career action; and results are kept secret or used punitively. In HRD terms, the appraisal exists as a **control mechanism**, not as a **development subsystem**, and it is not integrated with the other subsystems.

2. HRD principles to be applied

HRD principle	Application to the appraisal process
Development as primary objective	Redefine the purpose: appraisal is first a tool for understanding and developing the employee; reward decisions are a secondary use
Needs-driven and enabling capabilities	Use appraisal to identify capability gaps and development needs, not merely to rank people
Participation and openness (OCTAPACE)	Introduce joint goal setting and self-appraisal; make the process a dialogue
Integration and coherence	Link appraisal outputs to counselling, training, potential appraisal, career planning and rewards
Line manager involvement	Make appraisers responsible and competent for developing subordinates; train them
Strategy alignment	Derive individual KRAs from departmental and organisational goals
Monitoring and review	Audit the quality of appraisals and act on employee feedback about the system
Trust and confidentiality	Keep developmental discussions confidential and separate from salary discussions

3. Recommended redesign of the appraisal process

Step 1 - Clarify purpose and gain commitment

Top management should state that the appraisal is primarily developmental, and managers' own appraisals should include "development of subordinates" as a KRA.

Step 2 - Joint goal setting at the beginning of the period

Superior and subordinate agree on 4-6 KRAs with measurable standards derived from the unit's goals. The employee knows what is expected and how it will be measured.

Step 3 - Continuous coaching and a mid-year review

Feedback should not wait for the year end. A mid-year review corrects course while there is still time.

Step 4 - Self-appraisal

The employee first records achievements, difficulties, facilitating and hindering factors, and development needs. This reduces defensiveness and gives the appraiser the employee's perspective.

Step 5 - Performance analysis, not just rating

Discuss the reasons for results - skill, knowledge, attitude, resources, systems - so that the right remedy (training or non-training) is chosen.

Step 6 - Feedback and performance counselling session

A structured conversation: describe behaviour with facts, listen to the employee, agree on solutions, obtain commitment, plan follow-up. Train all appraisers in feedback and counselling skills.

Step 7 - Individual development plan (IDP)

Every appraisal ends with a written IDP - training, job rotation, projects, mentoring, reading - with time lines and responsibilities. The HRD department consolidates IDPs into the training plan.

Step 8 - Separate the development review from the reward review

Hold the developmental discussion first and the increment/promotion discussion later, so that employees can speak openly about weaknesses.

Step 9 - Improve the instrument and reduce bias

Use behaviourally anchored scales, critical incidents and, where the climate permits, multi-source (360-degree) inputs. Calibrate ratings across appraisers to ensure fairness.

Step 10 - Link to other subsystems and review the system

Feed appraisal data into potential appraisal and career planning; recognise improvement through rewards; conduct an annual survey of employees on appraisal usefulness and audit a sample of forms for quality.

4. Expected results

Employees gain role clarity and self-awareness; training becomes need-based; superiors become coaches; high performers see development leading somewhere; trust in the system rises; and the organisation obtains reliable data for HR decisions.

5. Conclusion

Applying HRD principles converts the appraisal from a yearly rating exercise into a developmental cycle of goal setting, coaching, self-appraisal, analysis, counselling and action planning that is integrated with training, career planning and rewards. When employees experience these changes, they will report that the appraisal helps their development - which is the real test of an HRD-oriented appraisal.

Q30

Apply the concept of HRD subsystems to propose a development path for an employee identified as having future leadership potential.

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. The situation

An employee - say a senior engineer or assistant manager with four to five years of experience - has been identified through potential appraisal as having leadership potential. The task is to design a development path that converts potential into demonstrated leadership capability, using the HRD subsystems in an integrated manner. The path should be planned over roughly three years and reviewed regularly.

2. Subsystems and their contribution to the path

HRD subsystem	Contribution to the leadership development path
Potential appraisal	Confirms the strengths and gaps through an assessment centre (in-basket, group discussion, case analysis, presentation) and psychometric tests; produces a competency profile against the leadership role
Performance appraisal	Sets stretch goals in the current role that exercise leadership behaviours (leading a project team, mentoring juniors); tracks progress every six months
Feedback and counselling	Development-focused feedback after the assessment centre and each review; a career counselling session to align the person's aspirations with the organisation's plans
Career planning	Prepares a written individual development plan and a career path with milestones - team lead, section head, department head
Training and development	A blended programme: management development course, leadership workshops, finance for non-finance managers, communication and conflict management, e-learning modules
Job rotation and stretch assignments	Cross-functional postings (for example a stint in customer service or a new plant), leading a cross-functional improvement project, deputising for the boss
Mentoring and coaching	A senior leader as mentor; the immediate superior as coach; periodic executive coaching if available
Succession planning	The employee is placed in the talent pool for a specific key position with a target readiness date
Rewards and recognition	Recognition of milestones, exposure to top management, and, on readiness, promotion
Organisation development	Participation in change initiatives and task forces builds systems thinking and influence skills

3. Proposed three-year development path

YEAR 1 - BUILD FOUNDATIONS

Assessment centre and competency profile -> IDP and career counselling
Lead a small project team; mentor two juniors
Training: supervisory skills, communication, finance basics; e-learning on people management
Mentor assigned; quarterly coaching conversations; mid-year and annual review

YEAR 2 - BROADEN AND STRETCH

Job rotation to a different function or location for 6-9 months
Lead a cross-functional improvement project reporting to a senior manager
Management development programme (internal or external institute)
360-degree feedback; second potential review; IDP revised

YEAR 3 - PREPARE FOR THE ROLE

Act as deputy to the target role holder; handle budget and people decisions
Participate in a strategic task force / change initiative
Leadership programme, strategic thinking, coaching skills
Final assessment of readiness -> promotion to the target role; succession plan updated

4. Roles and safeguards

- **Top management** sponsors the programme and meets the talent pool periodically.
- **The immediate superior** coaches, gives stretch work and honest feedback; developing the individual is part of the superior's own KRAs.
- **HRD department** designs the path, coordinates rotations and training, tracks progress and evaluates outcomes.
- **The employee** owns the IDP, seeks feedback and reflects on learning.
- **Safeguards:** keep the process fair and transparent to avoid resentment among peers; do not promise promotion unconditionally - readiness must be demonstrated; review the plan when business needs change; retain the employee through recognition and meaningful work rather than only money.

5. Evaluation of the path

Progress is measured through appraisal ratings on leadership behaviours, 360-degree feedback trends, success of projects led, performance of the team and mentees, readiness ratings in the succession plan and, ultimately, performance in the new role.

6. Conclusion

A development path for a high-potential employee uses every HRD subsystem in sequence and in combination: potential appraisal diagnoses, career planning charts the route, training, rotation and mentoring build capability, appraisal and feedback track progress, succession planning fixes the destination and rewards reinforce the journey. Integrated in this way, the subsystems convert identified potential into a ready leader while keeping the employee motivated and committed to the organisation.

Q31**State any two HRD subsystems.**

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of an HRD subsystem

An HRD system is made up of several inter-related mechanisms, each of which performs a specific developmental function and supplies inputs to the others. These mechanisms are called **HRD subsystems** (or HRD mechanisms / instruments). Pareek and Rao listed the main subsystems practised in Indian organisations as performance appraisal, potential appraisal, feedback and performance counselling, career planning and development, training, rewards, employee welfare and quality of work life, and organisation development. Any two can be stated; two are explained in detail below and the rest are summarised.

2. Subsystem 1 - Performance appraisal

- **Meaning:** The systematic, periodic assessment of an employee's performance against agreed goals and standards, followed by a discussion of the results with the employee.
- **Developmental purpose:** As an HRD subsystem it is used mainly to help the employee understand strengths and weaknesses, plan improvement and identify training and career needs - not merely to decide increments.
- **Key features:** joint goal setting (KRAs linked to organisational goals), self-appraisal, performance analysis of helping and hindering factors, review discussion, and a development plan.
- **Links with other subsystems:** its output goes to feedback and counselling, training, potential appraisal, career planning and rewards; it is therefore called the backbone of the HRD system.
- **Example:** A sales officer and her manager agree on targets and development goals in April, review progress in October, and in March discuss results and agree that she will attend a key-account management programme.

3. Subsystem 2 - Training and development

- **Meaning:** A planned effort by the organisation to help employees learn job-related knowledge, skills and attitudes (training) and to prepare them for future roles (development).
- **Developmental purpose:** It removes skill deficiencies, prepares people for higher responsibilities, improves attitudes and behaviour, and keeps competencies current in the face of technological change.
- **Key features:** it follows a four-stage cycle - training needs assessment, design, implementation and evaluation - and uses on-the-job methods (coaching, job rotation, apprenticeship), off-the-job methods (lectures, case studies, role plays, simulations) and e-learning.
- **Links with other subsystems:** training needs come from appraisal, counselling and potential appraisal; trained employees perform better in the next appraisal and progress along their career paths.
- **Example:** Appraisals across a plant reveal weak knowledge of a new quality standard; the HRD department designs a two-day workshop followed by on-the-job coaching and evaluates the reduction in defects three months later.

4. Other HRD subsystems (for completeness)

Subsystem	Purpose in one line
Potential appraisal	Assess capability for higher or different future roles
Feedback and performance counselling	Communicate appraisal results and help the employee plan improvement
Career planning and development	Match individual aspirations with organisational opportunities through defined career paths
Succession planning	Prepare ready replacements for key positions
Rewards and recognition	Reinforce good performance and learning through monetary and non-monetary rewards
Employee welfare and quality of work life	Sustain well-being and motivation
Organisation development	Improve culture, teams and processes through planned interventions
HRD department / information system	Coordinate the subsystems and maintain data

5. Conclusion

Performance appraisal and training are two of the most important HRD subsystems - the first diagnoses and directs development, the second builds the required capability. Like the other subsystems, they are most effective when they are integrated, so that the output of one becomes the input of the next.

Q32
State any two purposes of feedback in HRD practices.

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of feedback in HRD

Feedback is information given to an employee about his or her performance and behaviour - what was done well, what fell short of expectations and what impact it had - with the intention of helping the person learn and improve. In HRD practice feedback is the link between assessment (appraisal, potential appraisal, training evaluation) and action (counselling, training, career planning). Two principal purposes are explained below, followed by other purposes.

2. Purpose 1 - To help the employee know where he or she stands and to identify development needs

- Employees cannot improve what they do not know is wrong, nor build on strengths they are unaware of. Feedback provides an accurate picture of performance against expectations and thereby **reduces ambiguity and anxiety**.
- By pointing out specific strengths and specific gaps, feedback converts a general appraisal rating into **concrete development needs** - a skill to learn, a behaviour to change, an exposure to seek.
- This purpose makes feedback the foundation for need-based training and for the individual development plan; without it, training is chosen by guesswork.

- **Example:** Feedback that "your reports are technically correct but arrive two days late and are hard to read" tells the employee exactly what to develop - time management and written communication - whereas a rating of "3 out of 5" tells nothing.

3. Purpose 2 - To motivate, reinforce desired behaviour and build commitment to improvement

- Positive feedback recognises effort and achievement; recognition is one of the strongest non-monetary motivators and satisfies higher-order needs for esteem and growth.
- Constructive feedback, given supportively, shows that the superior cares about the employee's growth and invites joint problem solving; this creates **commitment** to the improvement plan rather than mere compliance.
- Regular feedback **reinforces the behaviour the organisation wants** - customer focus, teamwork, safety - and discourages what it does not want, before small problems become large.
- **Example:** A supervisor who notices and appreciates a technician's new safety practice in front of the team makes it more likely that the practice continues and spreads.

4. Other purposes of feedback in HRD practices

Purpose	Explanation
Improve superior-subordinate relationship	Regular, honest dialogue builds trust and openness (OCTAPACE values)
Support performance counselling	Feedback is the first step of the counselling process - describe the behaviour, then explore reasons and agree on solutions
Aid career planning	Feedback on potential and aspirations helps set realistic career goals
Evaluate training	Feedback from trainees and from supervisors tells whether learning was transferred to the job
Correct performance in time	Mid-year and continuous feedback allow course correction before the annual review
Reduce grievances and surprises	Employees who receive feedback throughout the year are not shocked by year-end ratings
Build a learning culture	An organisation where feedback flows freely - downward, upward and across - learns faster

5. Characteristics that make feedback serve these purposes

Feedback should be specific and descriptive, timely, balanced between strengths and improvement areas, focused on behaviour the person can change, delivered privately and with respect, two-way, and followed by support such as coaching or training.

6. Conclusion

Two central purposes of feedback in HRD are to help employees know where they stand and what to develop, and to motivate them by reinforcing desired behaviour and building commitment to improvement. Because it connects appraisal with counselling, training and career planning, feedback is indispensable to every HRD practice.

Q33**Analyze how poor coordination among HRD subsystems can reduce the effectiveness of employee development.**

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

The HRD subsystems - performance appraisal, feedback and counselling, potential appraisal, career planning, training, succession planning, rewards and OD - are designed to work as an integrated whole; the principle of **integration and coherence** requires that they support and reinforce one another. Poor coordination occurs when these subsystems are designed by different people at different times, run on different calendars, use different criteria and do not exchange information. The analysis below traces how such fragmentation weakens employee development at each link of the chain.

2. Where coordination breaks down and what happens

Broken link	Consequence for employee development
Appraisal not followed by feedback and counselling	Employees receive a rating but no explanation; they do not know what to improve; appraisal becomes a ritual and resentment grows
Training not based on appraisal or needs analysis	Programmes are chosen from catalogues or given as rewards; content is irrelevant; employees learn little and apply less; training budgets are wasted (the "fringe benefit" problem noted by D'Souza and by Rao and Abraham)
Training not reinforced by supervisors and appraisal	Even good learning is not transferred to the job because nobody expects or measures the new behaviour
Potential appraisal mixed with performance appraisal	Good performers are assumed to have potential; genuinely high-potential people in ordinary jobs are missed; wrong people are promoted
Potential appraisal results not used in career planning	High-potential employees see no future and leave; the talent pool is wasted
Career plans not linked to training and job rotation	Career paths remain paper promises; employees are not prepared for the next role when it opens
Succession planning disconnected from potential and career data	Key positions are filled by outsiders or by seniority; internal development loses credibility
Rewards not linked to appraised performance and learning	Employees see no benefit in improving; appraisal and training lose motivational power; cynicism spreads
OD and climate-building ignored	Low trust and fear undermine honest self-appraisal, candid counselling and willingness to experiment with new skills
Different criteria across subsystems	An employee is rated "excellent" in appraisal, "average" in potential, receives no training and no increment - contradictory signals destroy faith in the system

3. Cumulative effects on development effectiveness

1. **Learning without application** - skills are acquired in training but never used, so they decay.
2. **Development without direction** - employees attend programmes but do not know how they connect to their career.
3. **Assessment without action** - data are collected in appraisal and potential reviews but nothing happens, which teaches employees that the system is a formality.
4. **Motivation without means** - employees who want to grow do not get the training, rotation or mentoring they need.
5. **Duplication and gaps** - some competencies are trained repeatedly while others are never addressed.
6. **Inequity** - inconsistent decisions across subsystems are perceived as unfair, damaging the HRD climate.
7. **Attrition of talent** - the best people, who value development most, leave first.
8. **Loss of credibility and resources for HRD** - management sees no results and cuts budgets, starting a downward spiral.

4. Illustration

A company sends its managers to an expensive leadership programme (training) but its appraisal still measures only sales volume, its rewards pay only for volume and its succession plan is decided informally by the chairman. The managers return, find that leadership behaviour is neither expected nor rewarded, and go back to old habits within a month. The training was good; the coordination was absent.

5. How to restore coordination

Design the subsystems together on a common competency framework; run them on one annual calendar (goal setting - mid-year review - appraisal - counselling - IDP - training plan - potential review - career and succession review - rewards); maintain one HR information system; make the HRD department the integrator and line managers the owners; and audit the linkages every year.

6. Conclusion

Poor coordination among HRD subsystems breaks the chain that converts assessment into insight, insight into learning, learning into performance and performance into career growth. Each subsystem may look adequate on its own, yet employee development suffers because the outputs of one never become the inputs of the next. Effectiveness comes from integration, not from the excellence of isolated parts.

Q34

Analyze how HRD practices can be aligned with organizational strategy in a rapidly changing organization.

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. The challenge

A rapidly changing organisation - one facing new technology, new markets, mergers, fast growth or regulatory change - has a strategy that itself keeps evolving. Aligning HRD with strategy in such a context is harder than in a stable firm because the competency requirements shift, time

to build capability is short, and people are under stress from continuous change. Alignment therefore has to be **dynamic**: not a one-time match but a continuous process of sensing strategic direction, translating it into capability requirements and adjusting HRD practices quickly. The design principles of **strategy alignment, scalability and flexibility, needs-driven approach, technology integration and continuous improvement** are directly relevant.

2. Mechanisms of alignment

(a) Put HRD at the strategy table

The HRD head should participate in strategic planning so that the people implications of every strategic option are considered and HRD hears about changes early. HRD acts as strategic advisor, not as a downstream service.

(b) Translate strategy into a living competency framework

For each strategic thrust, identify the critical roles and the competencies they require. In a changing organisation, review the framework every six to twelve months rather than every five years. Example: a shift to digital sales creates needs for data analysis, online customer engagement and rapid experimentation.

(c) Continuous, fast needs assessment

Replace the annual training-needs survey with continuous inputs - performance dashboards, project reviews, pulse surveys and manager conversations - and short diagnostic cycles for each new initiative.

(d) Align every subsystem to the strategic priorities

Subsystem	Alignment action in a changing organisation
Performance appraisal	Set shorter goal cycles (quarterly) linked to current strategic priorities; include change-related behaviours (learning agility, collaboration) in KRAs
Training and development	Modular, just-in-time learning; heavy use of e-learning and micro-learning; re-skilling programmes tied to strategic projects; action learning on real business problems
Potential appraisal	Assess learning agility, adaptability and change leadership, not only current competence
Career planning	Flexible, lateral and project-based career paths instead of rigid ladders; emphasise employability and multi-skilling
Succession planning	Talent pools for emerging roles, not only existing positions; scenario-based planning
Feedback and counselling	Frequent, informal feedback; counselling to manage stress, uncertainty and resistance to change
Rewards	Recognise learning, innovation and successful change efforts; team-based rewards for cross-functional projects
Organisation development	Change management, communication, team building across new structures; build a culture of experimentation (OCTAPACE)

(e) Build the organisation's capacity to learn

Develop internal trainers, communities of practice and knowledge management so that learning spreads faster than any central training department can deliver. Make line managers coaches;

development of people should be part of their goals.

(f) Use technology

Learning management systems, mobile learning, virtual classrooms and analytics allow rapid deployment of new content across locations and real-time tracking of skill inventories against strategic needs.

(g) Measure alignment and adjust

Track strategic-capability indicators - percentage of critical roles filled with ready people, time to competence in new skills, project outcomes - and review HRD plans quarterly with business leaders. Feed results back into strategy (for example, if capability cannot be built in time, the strategy may need to buy, partner or re-phase).

3. Analysis of tensions to be managed

- **Speed versus depth:** rapid modular learning must be balanced with deeper development of leaders.
- **Stability versus flexibility:** people need some predictability of careers even as roles change; transparent communication is essential.
- **Short-term performance versus long-term capability:** pressure to deliver today can crowd out development; protected learning time and leadership commitment are required.
- **Standardisation versus customisation:** common frameworks keep coherence, while local units need freedom to adapt.

4. Example

A retail bank moving rapidly to digital channels reviewed its competency framework every six months, created "digital academies" with e-learning modules, ran quarterly goal setting, redefined branch manager careers around customer advisory roles, assessed potential on adaptability, rewarded staff who moved customers to digital services and ran change-management workshops in every region. Within two years most branch staff were competent in the new model and attrition during the transition stayed low.

5. Conclusion

In a rapidly changing organisation, HRD is aligned with strategy by sitting at the strategy table, translating strategy into a continuously updated competency framework, sensing needs in real time, tuning every subsystem to current priorities, building the organisation's own learning capacity, using technology and measuring results quarterly. Alignment becomes a continuous loop rather than an annual exercise - which is exactly what the principles of flexibility and continuous improvement demand.

Q35

Evaluate the effectiveness of using potential appraisal together with performance appraisal for employee development.

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. The two appraisals

Performance appraisal assesses what an employee has actually achieved in the present role during a past period. **Potential appraisal** assesses what the employee is capable of achieving in higher or different roles in the future. Pareek and Rao observed that most Indian organisations collect potential data on the performance appraisal form, which mixes the two; they also warned

that past performance is not necessarily an indication of future potential. The question is whether using the two together - as distinct but linked subsystems - is more effective for development than using either alone.

2. Arguments supporting the combined use

1. **Complete picture of the employee.** Performance shows current competence and results; potential shows capacity for growth. Together they answer both "How is the person doing?" and "How far can the person go?"
2. **Avoids the promotion trap.** Promoting purely on performance can place an excellent technician in a management role he cannot handle (the Peter Principle). Potential appraisal checks readiness for the new competencies.
3. **Discovers hidden talent.** An average performer in an unsuitable job may have high potential elsewhere; potential appraisal identifies such people whom performance data would overlook.
4. **Targets development precisely.** Performance appraisal identifies present skill gaps; potential appraisal identifies competencies needed for the future role. The individual development plan can then address both.
5. **Enables the nine-box talent grid.** Plotting performance against potential classifies employees - for example high-performance/high-potential (future leaders: accelerate), high-performance/low-potential (valued specialists: retain and reward), low-performance/high-potential (misfit or new: coach and re-place), low/low (counsel and correct) - and prescribes a distinct development strategy for each.
6. **Strengthens career and succession planning.** Career plans based on both are realistic; succession pools contain people who both perform and can grow.
7. **Motivates through fairness.** Employees see that both present contribution and future capability are recognised; high performers who lack leadership potential can be given expert career tracks instead of being frustrated.

3. Limitations and risks

Limitation	Evaluation
Potential is harder to measure; assessments may be subjective	Mitigated by defined competencies, multiple methods (assessment centres, tests) and multiple assessors
Halo effect - high performers rated high on potential automatically	Requires separate forms, separate timing and trained assessors
Labelling - "low potential" ratings can demotivate	Ratings should be developmental, confidential and revisable; potential can grow
Cost and time of assessment centres	Focus potential appraisal on critical roles and levels; use simpler methods for others
Raised expectations of promotion	Communicate that potential identification leads to development opportunities, not guaranteed promotion
Cultural readiness	In low-trust climates, potential ratings may be politicised; build openness first

4. Conditions for effectiveness

The two appraisals should be conceptually and procedurally separate but jointly used; competencies for future roles must be defined; assessors must be trained; results must lead to development plans, career moves and succession decisions; and the process must be transparent and fair.

5. Illustration

A pharmaceutical company that introduced a separate potential review found that 20 per cent of its top performers were unsuitable for people-management roles and created a technical specialist ladder for them, while several mid-level performers with high potential were given rotations and later became successful managers. Both groups reported higher satisfaction, and the failure rate of new managers fell.

6. Conclusion

On evaluation, using potential appraisal together with performance appraisal is significantly more effective for employee development than using performance appraisal alone. The combination gives a complete picture, prevents wrong promotions, discovers hidden talent, targets development for present and future and supports career and succession planning. Its limitations - subjectivity, halo, cost and labelling - are real but manageable through sound design. The key is to keep the two assessments distinct in method while integrating their results in development planning.

Q36

Analyze how an HRD system can become ineffective when its practices are designed without organizational strategy alignment.

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

The first principle of HRD system design is **organisational strategy alignment**: HRD should build the talents, knowledge and abilities that the organisation's strategic aims require. When HRD practices are designed in isolation - by copying other companies, by following fashion, by responding to individual requests or simply by repeating last year's plan - the system may look busy and well-organised but fails to produce what the organisation needs. The analysis below shows how misalignment makes each part of the HRD system ineffective and how the effects compound.

2. How misalignment makes each practice ineffective

HRD practice	Effect of designing it without strategy alignment
Training needs assessment	Needs are identified from individual wish-lists or generic surveys, not from strategic capability gaps; the organisation trains for yesterday's business
Training programmes	Catalogue-driven, generic courses; heavy spending on popular topics while strategic skills (for example digital, quality, new markets) remain undeveloped
Performance appraisal	KRAs reflect routine tasks rather than strategic priorities; employees are rewarded for activities that do not move the strategy

HRD practice	Effect of designing it without strategy alignment
Potential appraisal	Potential is judged against yesterday's leadership model; the organisation grooms leaders for roles that will not exist and misses the competencies the future requires
Career planning	Career paths follow the old structure; when strategy changes the structure, plans become obsolete and employees feel betrayed
Succession planning	Successors are prepared for current positions, not for emerging critical roles; strategic initiatives stall for lack of ready leaders
Rewards	Reward what is easy to measure rather than what strategy needs; behaviour drifts away from strategic intent
Organisation development	Culture-building efforts promote values (for example stability) that contradict the strategy (for example innovation)

3. Systemic consequences

- Capability gaps at critical moments.** When the strategy demands new skills - a product launch, a technology shift, an acquisition - the people are not ready, and the strategy is delayed or fails.
- Wasted resources.** Training budgets produce programmes, certificates and attendance figures but no business results; return on investment is poor or unmeasurable.
- Contradictory signals.** Appraisal, rewards and training push employees in different directions from the strategy communicated by top management; employees become confused and cynical.
- Fragmentation of subsystems.** Strategy is the common reference point that integrates the subsystems; without it each subsystem optimises its own activity and coordination collapses.
- Loss of credibility and status of HRD.** Business leaders see no link between HRD activity and results, so HRD is treated as a cost centre, excluded from decisions and the first to be cut in a downturn - which is the opposite of the principle of ensuring respectability for the function.
- Talent leaves.** High-potential employees notice that development leads nowhere strategically and move to organisations where growth is connected to real opportunities.
- Inability to manage change.** Strategic change needs prepared, willing people; a misaligned HRD system has neither prepared them nor built the change-ready culture, so resistance is high.
- Measurement failure.** Without strategic goals, HRD cannot define meaningful KPIs; it measures inputs (training days) rather than outcomes, so it cannot learn or improve.

4. The vicious circle

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Practices designed without strategy --> No visible business impact --> HRD loses credibility
      ^                                     and budget
      |                                     |
      +----- HRD retreats to safe, generic activities <-----+
  
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5. Illustration

A manufacturing firm decided to compete on rapid customisation for customers. Its HRD department, working from an old plan, continued to run generic supervisory courses, appraised

operators on output volume alone, rewarded long production runs and promoted the most senior foremen. Set-up times did not fall, customer complaints rose, and the strategy was abandoned within two years. The HRD activities were well run - and completely irrelevant.

6. Conclusion

An HRD system designed without alignment to organisational strategy becomes ineffective because every practice - needs assessment, training, appraisal, potential appraisal, career and succession planning, rewards and OD - ends up building the wrong capabilities, sending contradictory signals and wasting resources. The system may function smoothly as a set of activities, yet it fails at its real purpose: enabling the organisation to achieve its goals. Alignment is not an optional refinement; it is what gives an HRD system its direction and its value.

Q37

State any two benefits of integrating career planning with potential appraisal.

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of integration

Potential appraisal assesses an employee's capability to perform higher or different roles in the future. **Career planning** maps the path by which the employee will move towards future roles in line with his or her aspirations and the organisation's needs. Integrating the two means that career plans are built on the objective evidence of potential appraisal, and potential appraisal results are always followed by concrete career actions. As the prescribed notes put it, "a meaningful career planning system should be based on potential appraisal." Two major benefits are explained below, followed by others.

2. Benefit 1 - Realistic and objective career plans (the right people on the right paths)

- Career planning based only on aspiration or seniority produces unrealistic plans: employees expect roles for which they lack the competencies, and the organisation promotes people who then fail.
- Potential appraisal - through assessment centres, tests and structured evaluation against role requirements - supplies **objective evidence** of strengths and development areas. When career plans are built on this evidence, the destination chosen for each employee matches capability: managerial tracks for those with leadership potential, specialist or expert tracks for strong technical performers with limited managerial potential.
- Development actions on the career path (training, rotation, projects) can be **targeted** to the specific gaps that the potential appraisal revealed, so time and money are not wasted.
- **Result:** fewer wrong promotions, higher success rate in new roles, and career plans that both the employee and the organisation believe in.

3. Benefit 2 - Better retention and motivation of talent, and a stronger succession pipeline

- Potential appraisal without career planning is frustrating: employees learn that they have potential but see nothing happen, and the most talented leave. Career planning without potential appraisal is unconvincing: employees suspect that paths are decided by favouritism.
- When the two are integrated, high-potential employees see a **visible, credible future** - a defined path, milestones and development support - which satisfies their growth needs and

increases commitment. Career advancement is the prime motivating factor for most managers; integration makes advancement transparent and earned.

- For the organisation, the integrated data produce a **ready talent pool** for succession planning: for each key position, the organisation knows who has the potential, where they are on their career path and when they will be ready. Key positions are filled internally, quickly and with prepared people.
- **Result:** lower attrition of high performers, higher morale, continuity of leadership and reduced recruitment cost.

4. Other benefits

Benefit	Explanation
Fairness and equity	Decisions are based on assessed potential rather than impressions, which strengthens the HRD climate
Early identification and longer development runway	Potential is spotted early, so the career path has time to build the competencies needed
Better use of human resources	People are placed where their capabilities are most valuable
Integration of individual and organisational needs	Aspirations (career planning) and capability (potential appraisal) are reconciled with the organisation's manpower plan
Improved training effectiveness	Training is planned as steps on a career path rather than as isolated events
Reduced conflict and politics	Transparent criteria reduce lobbying for promotions

5. Conclusion

Integrating career planning with potential appraisal yields, first, realistic and objective career plans that place the right people on the right paths, and second, higher motivation and retention of talent together with a dependable succession pipeline. The two subsystems are complementary: potential appraisal tells the organisation what an employee can become, and career planning ensures that he or she actually gets there.

Q38

Mention any two features of an effective HRD practice.

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of an effective HRD practice

An HRD practice is any planned mechanism - performance appraisal, training, counselling, career planning, potential appraisal, mentoring, rewards, OD interventions - used to develop people. It is **effective** when it actually improves competence, commitment and performance and contributes to organisational goals, rather than merely being conducted. From the principles of HRD system design (strategy alignment, needs-driven approach, integration, line involvement, monitoring, flexibility, technology, measurement) several features of an effective practice can be derived. Two are explained in detail below, followed by a list of others.

2. Feature 1 - It is need-based and aligned with organisational goals

- An effective practice starts from a **diagnosed need** - a gap between required and actual performance or competence (Standard performance - Actual performance = Gap) - identified

through organisation, task and person analysis, appraisal data or performance analysis.

- The need must in turn be connected to **organisational strategy and goals**, so that the practice builds capabilities the organisation actually requires, now or in the future.
- Because it is need-based and aligned, the practice has clear **objectives** stated in terms of what participants will be able to do and what business result is expected; this also makes evaluation possible.
- Practices that lack this feature - catalogue training, appraisal forms copied from another company, generic "motivation" workshops - consume resources without changing anything. Studies of Indian organisations found training treated as a fringe benefit precisely because needs were not analysed.
- **Example:** A retail chain that finds, through customer-complaint analysis and appraisal data, that billing staff lack knowledge of a new returns policy designs a short, focused programme with the objective "process a return correctly within three minutes," and measures complaint reduction afterwards.

3. Feature 2 - It is integrated with other HRD subsystems and supported by line managers (so that learning is applied)

- An effective practice does not stand alone. It **receives inputs** from other subsystems (training needs from appraisal and counselling; career moves from potential appraisal) and **delivers outputs** to them (improved performance to the next appraisal; evidence for career decisions; recognition through rewards).
- It is **owned by line managers**, who set expectations before the practice, coach during it and provide opportunities to apply new skills afterwards. HRD professionals design and facilitate, but action is the responsibility of line people.
- This integration and support ensure **transfer of learning** to the job - the point at which most training fails - and reinforce the behaviour through appraisal and rewards.
- **Example:** After a coaching-skills workshop, managers' appraisals include a KRA on developing subordinates, their bosses review coaching conversations quarterly, and the reward system recognises managers whose team members are promoted.

4. Other features of an effective HRD practice

Feature	Meaning
Clear, measurable objectives	States what will change and how it will be measured
Participative and developmental	Involves the employee (self-appraisal, joint goal setting, choice of learning); focuses on growth, not control
Appropriate method and design	Method fits the objective, the learners and the context (on-the-job, off-the-job, e-learning); follows adult-learning principles
Timely and continuous	Delivered when needed, followed up, not a one-off event
Top-management commitment	Visibly supported and resourced by leaders
Fair, transparent and trusted	Consistent criteria, confidentiality, equity - which sustain the HRD climate
Evaluated and improved	Assessed at reaction, learning, behaviour and results levels; revised on the basis of evidence

Feature	Meaning
Flexible and scalable	Adapts to changing needs and organisational size
Cost-effective and sustainable	Uses internal resources where possible and is budgeted for the long term

5. Conclusion

Two defining features of an effective HRD practice are that it is need-based and aligned with organisational goals, and that it is integrated with the other HRD subsystems and supported by line managers so that learning is applied on the job. When these features are present - along with clear objectives, sound design, fairness and evaluation - an HRD practice moves from being an activity to being a contributor to individual and organisational performance.

Q39

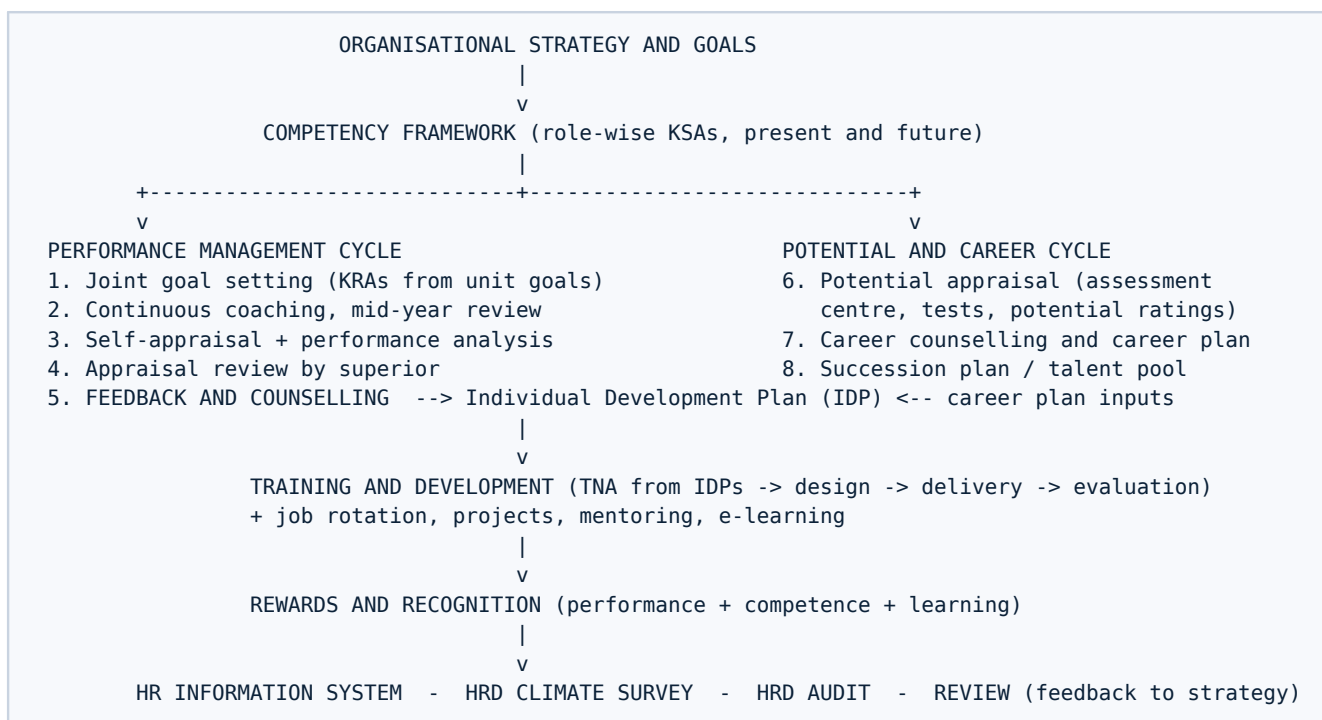
Design an integrated HRD system for an organization that wants to connect performance, potential, training, career planning, feedback, and counselling.

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Design objective and principles

The organisation wants its HRD subsystems to work as one connected system rather than as separate activities. The design therefore follows the principles of **integration and coherence**, **strategy alignment**, **needs-driven approach**, **line-manager involvement**, **monitoring and review** and **phased implementation**. The central design idea is a **common competency framework** and a **single annual HRD calendar** through which the output of each subsystem becomes the input of the next.

2. Architecture of the integrated system



3. How each subsystem is connected

Subsystem	Receives from	Gives to	Connecting tool
Performance appraisal	Strategy (goals), competency framework	Feedback and counselling, rewards, potential appraisal	KRA sheet linked to unit goals; competency ratings
Feedback and counselling	Appraisal data, self-appraisal	IDP, training, career planning	Structured counselling format; IDP template
Potential appraisal	Performance history, competency framework for higher roles	Career planning, succession planning, training	Separate potential form; assessment centre report
Career planning	Potential results, employee aspirations, manpower plan	IDP, job rotation, succession plan	Career path charts; career counselling record
Training and development	IDPs, TNA, career plans	Next appraisal (improved performance), potential evidence	Consolidated training plan; post-training action plan
Rewards	Appraisal and demonstrated competence	Motivation for all subsystems	Reward matrix linking performance and learning
HRIS and reviews	All subsystems	Management and strategy	Dashboard; annual HRD audit

4. Annual integrated calendar

Period	Activity
April	Goal setting for all employees; IDPs from previous cycle activated; training plan launched
April - September	Coaching, on-the-job development, training delivery, mentoring
October	Mid-year review and feedback; training plan adjusted
January - February	Self-appraisal, appraisal review, feedback and counselling, new IDP
February	Potential appraisal for identified levels; career counselling; succession review
March	Reward decisions; consolidated TNA from IDPs; HRD climate survey; HRD audit and plan for next year

5. Roles, structure and enablers

- **Top management:** approves HRD philosophy, reviews the talent pool and HRD dashboard quarterly.
- **Line managers:** own goal setting, coaching, feedback, counselling and application of learning; "development of subordinates" is one of their KRAs.
- **HRD department (headed by a senior manager):** designs and integrates the system, trains appraisers and counsellors, runs assessment centres, consolidates training and maintains the HRIS.

- **Employees:** participate through self-appraisal, career aspiration statements and ownership of their IDP.
- **Enablers:** trained appraisers and counsellors; one HRIS holding appraisal, potential, career, training and reward data; an OCTAPACE climate of openness and trust; protected budget and learning time.

6. Phased implementation

1. **Phase 1 (months 1-6):** competency framework for critical roles; redesign appraisal with goal setting, self-appraisal and counselling; train managers.
2. **Phase 2 (months 6-12):** IDP-based training plan; e-learning platform; mentoring programme.
3. **Phase 3 (year 2):** potential appraisal and career planning for managerial levels; succession plans for key positions; reward linkage.
4. **Phase 4 (year 2 onwards):** extend to all levels and locations (geographical and vertical phasing); annual HRD audit.

7. Evaluation of the system

Measures: percentage of employees with completed IDPs; training evaluated at behaviour and results levels; percentage of key positions with ready successors; internal promotion rate; retention of high potentials; HRD climate scores; business KPIs linked to HRD goals.

8. Conclusion

The proposed integrated HRD system connects performance, potential, training, career planning, feedback and counselling through a common competency framework, a single annual calendar, the individual development plan as the linking document, a shared information system and clearly assigned roles. Each subsystem feeds the next, so that assessment leads to insight, insight to learning, learning to performance and career growth, and the whole cycle to organisational effectiveness.

Q40

Evaluate a proposed HRD practice that has strong training content but weak linkage with organizational strategy, performance appraisal, and career planning.

Unit 2 | 8 Marks

1. Description of the proposal

The proposed practice is a training intervention - well-designed modules, expert trainers, good materials, sound learning methods - but it has been developed **without reference to organisational strategy, without input from or output to performance appraisal, and without connection to career planning**. In other words, it is a strong stand-alone product with weak linkages. The evaluation below examines its strengths, its weaknesses, the likely outcomes and the changes needed.

2. Strengths of the proposal

1. **Quality of content and delivery** - participants are likely to learn; reaction (Kirkpatrick Level 1) and learning (Level 2) scores will probably be high.
2. **Professional design** - clear modules and good trainers indicate instructional competence in the HRD team.

3. **Immediate morale benefit** - employees usually appreciate high-quality training and see it as a sign that the organisation cares.
4. **Reusable asset** - the content can become valuable once the linkages are built.

3. Weaknesses and their consequences

Missing linkage	Why it matters	Likely consequence
Organisational strategy	Strategy defines which capabilities matter; without it the training may build irrelevant skills	Content may be excellent but unnecessary; no visible business impact; management questions the spend; strategic skill gaps remain
Performance appraisal	Appraisal identifies who needs what (input) and measures whether behaviour changed (output)	Wrong participants; no expectation of new behaviour on the job; no transfer of learning; effectiveness cannot be shown beyond Level 2
Career planning	Career plans give learners a reason to apply and retain learning and tell the organisation how the skills will be used	Learning seen as an event, not a step in growth; no follow-up assignments; skills decay; high potentials still leave

Additional weaknesses follow from the design principles: it is not **needs-driven** (no diagnostic basis), not **integrated** (no coherence with other subsystems), lacks **line-manager ownership**, and has no basis for **accountability and measurement** at the behaviour and results levels.

4. Evaluation against the Kirkpatrick levels

Level 1 Reaction	: likely HIGH	(good content, good trainers)
Level 2 Learning	: likely HIGH	(sound methods)
Level 3 Behaviour	: likely LOW	(no appraisal expectation, no supervisor reinforcement, no career use)
Level 4 Results	: likely NIL / UNMEASURABLE	(no strategic objective to measure against)

This is the classic pattern of training that people enjoy but that does not change performance - the "fringe benefit" training criticised in studies of Indian organisations.

5. Overall judgement

The proposal is **strong as a product but weak as an HRD practice**. Effectiveness in HRD is judged not by the quality of the classroom experience but by improved performance and contribution to organisational goals. On that criterion the proposal, as it stands, is likely to give a poor return on investment and should not be approved in its present form. However, because the content is strong, it should be **modified rather than rejected**.

6. Recommendations to strengthen the linkages

1. **Link to strategy:** map each module to a strategic capability requirement; drop or redesign modules that do not serve one; define the business outcome each module is expected to influence.
2. **Link to performance appraisal (input):** select participants on the basis of appraisal-identified needs and IDPs; set pre-training objectives with the supervisor.
3. **Link to performance appraisal (output):** include the trained behaviours in the next appraisal's KRAs or competency ratings; require a post-training action plan reviewed by the manager.

4. **Link to career planning:** position the programme as a step on defined career paths; follow it with job assignments, projects or rotations that use the new skills; record completion in the career and succession database.
5. **Involve line managers:** pre-briefing and post-training review by supervisors; recognise managers who support application.
6. **Evaluate at all four levels:** reaction and learning in class; behaviour through appraisal and 360-degree feedback after three months; results through the business metrics identified in step 1.
7. **Phase and pilot:** run the linked version in one unit, measure, refine and then scale.

7. Conclusion

Strong training content is necessary but not sufficient. Without linkage to strategy the training may build the wrong skills; without linkage to appraisal the right people may not attend and new behaviour will not be expected or measured; without linkage to career planning the learning will not be used or retained. The proposal should be approved only after these linkages are built, converting a good training programme into an effective HRD practice.

UNIT 3

Training Needs Assessment, Training Design, Delivery, Methods and Evaluation

This unit follows the complete training cycle: identifying needs (TNA at organisation, task and person level), designing the programme (objectives, content, methods, trainers, budget), delivering it effectively through on-the-job, off-the-job and e-learning methods, and evaluating it with the Kirkpatrick model.

Key point: Formulas and models to remember: **Training need = Standard (expected) performance - Actual performance**; the **four-stage training cycle** (TNA - planning/design - implementation - evaluation); **Kirkpatrick's four levels** (Reaction - Learning - Behaviour - Results); **Noe's definition** of training as a planned effort by the company to facilitate learning of job-related competencies.

Questions 41 to 60 | 160 marks

Q41**Explain the concept of Training Needs Assessment (TNA) and state its importance in HRD.**

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of Training Needs Assessment

Training Needs Assessment (TNA) - also called training needs analysis - is the systematic process of identifying the gap between the performance or competence that an organisation requires and the performance or competence that its employees currently possess, and of deciding whether and how training can close that gap. It is the **first stage of the training cycle** and the foundation on which design, delivery and evaluation rest.

The basic formula is:

$$\text{Training need} = \text{Standard (expected) performance} - \text{Actual performance}$$

A need exists when something that should be happening is not happening, or something that should not be happening is happening. However, not every performance gap is a training need - gaps caused by poor tools, unclear goals, lack of motivation or faulty systems require non-training solutions. TNA therefore also separates training problems from non-training problems.

2. Levels of TNA

Level	Question asked	Sources of information
Organisation analysis	Where in the organisation is training needed, and does it fit the strategy, resources and climate?	Business goals and plans, performance indicators, quality and customer data, turnover, HRD climate, management support
Task (operational) analysis	What knowledge, skills and attitudes (KSAs) are required to perform each job well?	Job descriptions, task inventories, competency frameworks, observation, expert interviews, standards
Person (individual) analysis	Who needs training and in what? What is the gap between required and actual competence for each person?	Performance appraisal, tests, self-assessment, supervisor ratings, 360-degree feedback, critical incidents, interviews

3. Steps in conducting a TNA

1. Clarify the performance problem or opportunity and link it to organisational goals.
2. Define the required standard of performance and the competencies behind it (task analysis).
3. Measure actual performance and competence (person analysis).
4. Identify the gap and analyse its causes - skill, knowledge, attitude, motivation, resources or system.
5. Decide which gaps can be closed by training and which need other interventions.
6. Prioritise needs by business impact, urgency and number of people affected.
7. Convert priority needs into training objectives and pass them to the design stage.

4. Methods of collecting data

Questionnaires and surveys, interviews with employees and managers, observation of work, performance and quality records, appraisal and potential appraisal data, tests and assessment centres, focus groups, customer feedback, and analysis of accidents, errors and complaints.

5. Importance of TNA in HRD

1. **Ensures relevance** - training addresses real gaps that matter to the organisation, not popular topics.
2. **Links training to strategy** - organisation analysis connects programmes to business goals, which is the first principle of HRD system design.
3. **Prevents waste of resources** - money and time are spent only where training can make a difference; needs that are really system or motivation problems are handled correctly.
4. **Identifies the right participants** - people are selected on genuine need rather than as a reward or a routine, avoiding the "fringe benefit" problem found in many Indian organisations.
5. **Provides the basis for objectives and design** - clear needs produce clear learning objectives, appropriate content and suitable methods.
6. **Makes evaluation possible** - the baseline of actual performance measured in TNA is what training effectiveness is later compared against.
7. **Builds employee readiness and commitment** - involving employees in identifying needs increases motivation to learn.
8. **Strengthens the HRD system** - TNA draws on appraisal, counselling and potential appraisal and feeds career and succession planning, integrating training with the other subsystems.
9. **Supports change** - it reveals the capabilities the organisation must build before new technology, processes or strategies are introduced.

6. Consequences of skipping TNA

Irrelevant programmes, wrong participants, training for problems that training cannot solve, low transfer of learning, no baseline for evaluation and loss of credibility for the HRD function. TNA is often skipped because it is seen as time-consuming and costly or because managers do not want to face the real causes of problems - but the cost of skipping it is far higher.

7. Conclusion

Training Needs Assessment is the diagnostic stage of training: it identifies the gap between required and actual performance at organisation, task and person levels, determines whether training is the right remedy and sets priorities and objectives. Its importance lies in making training relevant, strategic, economical, targeted and measurable - in short, in ensuring that training develops people in ways that the organisation actually needs.

Q42**Describe the major steps involved in designing a training program.**

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

Designing a training programme is the second stage of the training cycle, after Training Needs Assessment and before delivery and evaluation. Design converts an identified need into a concrete plan: what participants will learn, how, from whom, where, when and at what cost. A training plan describes the key decisions, tasks and resources needed to carry out the training. The prescribed notes summarise the components of a training plan as **training goal, learning objectives, learning methods and activities, facilities and resource persons, and budget**. The major steps are described below.

2. Steps in designing a training programme

Step 1 - Confirm the needs and define the training goal

Review the TNA findings: who needs training, in what, and why it matters to the organisation. State the overall **training goal** - the result or capability to be achieved by implementing the plan (for example, "reduce billing errors in the accounts department by 50 per cent").

Step 2 - Write specific learning objectives

Convert the goal into **learning objectives** - statements of what participants will be able to do as a result of the training, under what conditions and to what standard. Objectives should be specific, measurable, achievable, relevant and time-bound. Example: "After training, the participant will be able to process a customer return correctly within three minutes without supervisor help." Objectives guide content, methods and evaluation.

Step 3 - Analyse the trainees

Consider the number of participants, their existing knowledge, education, experience, learning styles, language, motivation and readiness. Adult learners need relevance, participation, respect for experience and immediate applicability.

Step 4 - Decide the content and sequence

Select the knowledge, skills and attitudes to be covered, based on the task analysis. Organise content into modules in a logical sequence - simple to complex, known to unknown, theory followed by practice. Remove anything that does not serve an objective.

Step 5 - Choose the training methods and learning activities

Match methods to objectives: lectures and e-learning for knowledge; demonstration, practice, simulation and on-the-job coaching for skills; case studies, role plays, group discussion and games for attitudes and decision making. Decide the key questions raised in the notes: on the job or off the job? in-house or outsourced? on-site or off-site? which mix of methods?

Step 6 - Develop or procure learning materials

Prepare lesson plans, trainer guides, participant handouts, presentations, videos, exercises, cases, job aids and e-learning modules - or buy them from vendors if that is more economical.

Step 7 - Select the trainers and resource persons

Choose internal experts (cost-effective, know the context) or external trainers (specialised expertise) based on the subject, availability and credibility. Brief them on objectives and participants; prepare internal trainers through train-the-trainer sessions.

Step 8 - Arrange facilities, schedule and logistics

Decide venue (classroom, workplace, off-site, virtual), audio-visual equipment, seating, materials, meals, travel and accommodation. Schedule sessions considering shift patterns, workload, length of sessions and breaks, and spacing for practice between modules.

Step 9 - Prepare the budget

Itemise trainer fees, materials, venue, equipment, travel, participants' time and administrative costs so that the plan complies with the organisation's accounting procedures and can be compared with expected benefits.

Step 10 - Plan for transfer of learning and evaluation

Build in pre-training briefing by supervisors, post-training action plans, follow-up coaching and job aids. Decide in advance how the programme will be evaluated at the Kirkpatrick levels - reaction forms, tests, on-the-job observation, performance data - and pilot-test the design if possible.

3. The training plan at a glance

Component	Content of the plan
Training goal	Overall result or capability to be achieved
Learning objectives	What participants will be able to do after the training
Learning methods and activities	Lectures, workshops, case studies, simulations, on-the-job practice, e-learning
Facilities and resource persons	Venue, audio-visual aids, materials, meals, travel, choice of trainers
Budget	Specific costs, stated to comply with accounting procedures
Evaluation plan	Measures and timing for reaction, learning, behaviour and results

4. Conclusion

Designing a training programme moves systematically from the confirmed need to the goal, from the goal to measurable learning objectives, and from objectives to content, methods, materials, trainers, logistics, budget and an evaluation plan. A well-designed programme is one in which every element can be traced back to an objective and every objective can be traced back to a need.

Q43**Explain on-the-job and off-the-job training methods with suitable examples.**

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

Training methods are broadly classified according to **where** learning takes place. **On-the-job training (OJT)** happens at the actual workplace while the employee performs the job, usually under the guidance of a supervisor or experienced colleague. **Off-the-job training** takes place away from the normal work situation - in a classroom, training centre, vestibule or online - so that the learner can concentrate on learning without the pressure of production.

2. On-the-job training methods

Method	Description	Example
Job instruction training (JIT)	Step-by-step coaching: prepare the learner, present the task, let the learner try, follow up	A new machine operator is shown each step, performs it under observation and is corrected on the spot
Coaching	Regular guidance and feedback from the immediate superior on actual work	A sales manager accompanies a new salesperson on customer calls and reviews each call afterwards
Mentoring	A senior person guides a junior's overall development, career and organisational understanding	A general manager mentors a management trainee over two years
Job rotation	Planned movement through different jobs or departments to build broad skills	A bank probationer spends six months each in deposits, credit, foreign exchange and operations
Apprenticeship	Long-term structured training combining work and instruction for skilled trades	Electricians, fitters and machinists trained under the Apprentices Act
Understudy / assistant-to positions	The learner works as assistant to a senior and gradually takes over responsibilities	A deputy plant manager prepared to succeed the plant manager
Committee assignments and special projects	Participation in task forces or projects that require new skills	A young engineer leads a cost-reduction project team
Internship	Students or fresh recruits gain supervised practical experience	Management interns working on live business problems

Advantages: learning is realistic and directly relevant; no separate facilities are needed; transfer of learning is immediate; employees remain productive; it is economical; the learner receives instant feedback.

Limitations: quality depends on the skill and willingness of the supervisor; bad habits may be passed on; production pressure may cut short the training; errors during learning can damage equipment, materials or customer relations; it is unsuitable for teaching theory or for large groups at once.

3. Off-the-job training methods

Method	Description	Example
Lectures and classroom instruction	Oral presentation of information to a group, often with visual aids	An orientation lecture on company policies; a session on new tax rules
Conferences and seminars	Structured discussion and exchange of ideas among participants	A two-day seminar on industrial safety
Case study	Analysis of a real or hypothetical business situation to develop analytical and decision-making skills	Managers analyse a case of a failed product launch
Role playing	Participants act out roles in a simulated situation to practise interpersonal skills	A trainee practises handling an angry customer
Business games and simulations	Participants run a simulated company or operation and see the results of decisions	Teams compete in a marketing simulation
Vestibule training	Training on duplicate equipment in a separate area that reproduces the work environment	Cabin crew practise on a mock aircraft cabin; bank staff on a training branch
Programmed instruction and e-learning	Self-paced learning through structured modules with questions and feedback	An online module on information security completed by all staff
Sensitivity (T-group) training	Unstructured group interaction to increase self-awareness and interpersonal sensitivity	A laboratory programme for a leadership team
Outbound / experiential training	Outdoor activities designed to build teamwork and leadership	A team-building camp with problem-solving tasks
University and institute programmes	Formal courses and management development programmes	Executives attend a management programme at an IIM

Advantages: learners can concentrate without work pressure; experts and specialised methods can be used; theory and concepts are taught systematically; large groups can be trained uniformly; mistakes are made safely; participants gain wider perspective through interaction with others.

Limitations: costly (trainers, venue, time away from work); the learning situation is artificial, so transfer to the job may be low unless supported; may not suit the specific context of each participant; production is lost while employees are away.

4. Comparison

Basis	On-the-job	Off-the-job
Place	Actual workplace	Away from the workplace
Focus	Practical skills, "learning by doing"	Concepts, principles, attitudes, complex skills practised safely
Trainer	Supervisor or experienced worker	Professional trainers, experts

Basis	On-the-job	Off-the-job
Cost	Low	High
Transfer of learning	Immediate and direct	Requires deliberate follow-up
Suitable for	Operatives, new recruits, skill upgrading	Managers, behavioural training, large groups, theory

5. Conclusion

On-the-job methods such as coaching, job rotation, apprenticeship and job instruction training build practical skills in the real setting economically, while off-the-job methods such as lectures, case studies, role plays, simulations, vestibule training and e-learning develop knowledge, judgement and attitudes in a safe and focused environment. Most effective programmes blend the two - concepts learnt off the job are practised and reinforced on the job.

Q44

Explain e-learning as a training method and state its major advantages.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of e-learning

E-learning (electronic learning) is the delivery of training and education through digital technology - computers, the internet, intranets, learning management systems (LMS), mobile devices, virtual classrooms and multimedia - rather than solely through face-to-face instruction. It ranges from self-paced online modules and video lessons to live virtual classes, simulations, mobile micro-learning and blended programmes that combine online and classroom components. In the 21st century, employee training increasingly uses distance-learning alternatives such as web-based conferencing, web-based training and learning solutions deployed to mobile devices.

2. Forms of e-learning

Form	Description	Example
Self-paced online courses	Modules with text, video, quizzes and feedback that learners complete at their own speed	Compliance course on information security
Virtual instructor-led training (VILT)	Live classes conducted through video-conferencing tools with chat, polls and breakout rooms	A trainer in Mumbai teaches sales staff in twenty cities simultaneously
Learning management systems	Platforms that host courses, track completion, scores and certifications	Company LMS assigning role-based curricula
Simulations and virtual labs	Software that reproduces machines, processes or business situations for safe practice	Flight simulators; virtual chemistry labs; ERP sandbox training
Mobile and micro-learning	Short lessons (3-10 minutes) delivered on smartphones	Daily product-knowledge cards for field sales staff

Form	Description	Example
Massive open online courses (MOOCs) and external platforms	University and vendor courses accessed online	Employees sponsored on Coursera, NPTEL or vendor certifications
Blended learning	Combination of e-learning with classroom and on-the-job components	Online theory followed by a practical workshop and coached practice
Electronic performance support systems (EPSS)	Just-in-time help, job aids and information embedded in work systems	Context-sensitive help inside a banking application

3. How e-learning is used as a training method

The design process is the same as for any training - needs assessment, objectives, content, evaluation - but delivery is through technology. Good e-learning applies adult-learning principles: short, interactive modules; practice and immediate feedback; realistic scenarios; assessments that certify mastery; discussion forums and mentor support; and tracking through the LMS. It is most effective for knowledge and procedural content and, with simulations, for certain skills; it is usually blended with practice on the job for complex skills and with facilitated sessions for attitudes and interpersonal behaviour.

4. Major advantages of e-learning

- Accessibility - anytime, anywhere:** employees at remote locations, on different shifts or travelling can learn without coming to a training centre; interactive forums and tutorials reach even the most remote area.
- Cost-effectiveness:** once developed, a course can be delivered to thousands of employees without recurring costs of trainers, venues, travel and accommodation; time away from work is reduced.
- Consistency and standardisation:** every learner receives the same quality of content and message, which is important for compliance, safety and product knowledge.
- Self-paced and learner-centred:** learners proceed at their own speed, repeat difficult sections, skip what they already know and choose when to learn; this suits adult learners and different learning styles.
- Scalability and speed of deployment:** new content - a policy change, a product launch - can be rolled out to the whole organisation within days.
- Tracking and measurement:** the LMS records enrolment, completion, scores and time spent, providing data for evaluation, compliance reporting and learning analytics.
- Rich, engaging content:** multimedia, simulations, gamification and scenarios increase engagement and allow safe practice of risky or expensive tasks.
- Personalisation and just-in-time support:** adaptive paths, recommended courses and performance-support tools deliver the right content at the moment of need.
- Knowledge sharing and collaboration:** discussion boards, wikis, virtual communities and real-time conferencing allow sharing of knowledge, exchange of resources and learning across the organisation.
- Environmental and continuity benefits:** less travel and paper; learning continues during disruptions such as the pandemic.

5. Limitations to keep in mind

E-learning requires reliable technology and digital literacy; self-paced learning demands motivation and discipline, and drop-out rates can be high; it is less effective for hands-on skills and interpersonal behaviour unless blended; social interaction and immediate human feedback are reduced; and initial development costs for high-quality content can be significant.

6. Conclusion

E-learning is a technology-enabled training method that delivers learning through online modules, virtual classrooms, simulations, mobile content and learning platforms. Its major advantages - accessibility, cost-effectiveness, consistency, self-pacing, scalability, measurability and rich content - make it an essential part of modern HRD, especially when blended with on-the-job practice and facilitated sessions to overcome its limitations.

Q45

Explain the Kirkpatrick model for evaluating training effectiveness.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

Training does not end when the programme is over; its effectiveness must be judged against its objectives. The most widely used framework for this is the **Kirkpatrick model**, proposed by Donald L. Kirkpatrick in 1959 and refined over later decades. It evaluates training at **four successive levels** - Reaction, Learning, Behaviour and Results - each level asking a deeper question about the value of the training. The prescribed notes describe the same idea: trainees' reactions (affective outcomes) plus learning that occurred, behaviour changes and impact on corporate objectives.

2. The four levels

Level 4	RESULTS	- What happened to the organisation?	(impact on business objectives)
Level 3	BEHAVIOUR	- Are participants applying the learning?	(change in on-the-job performance)
Level 2	LEARNING	- What did participants learn?	(knowledge, skills, attitudes gained)
Level 1	REACTION	- How did participants feel about it?	(satisfaction, relevance, engagement)

Level 1 - Reaction

- **Question:** Were participants satisfied? Did they find the programme relevant, engaging and well delivered?
- **Measures:** end-of-programme feedback forms ("happy sheets"), ratings of content, trainer, methods, facilities; verbal feedback; in the updated model, also engagement and perceived relevance.
- **Timing:** immediately after the programme.
- **Use:** improve programme design and delivery; a positive reaction is necessary for learning but does not prove that learning occurred.

Level 2 - Learning

- **Question:** To what extent did participants acquire the intended knowledge, skills and attitudes (and, in the updated model, confidence and commitment to apply them)?
- **Measures:** pre- and post-tests, skill demonstrations, simulations, role-play assessments, case analyses, certifications.

- **Timing:** at the end of the programme, ideally compared with a pre-training baseline or a control group.
- **Use:** verifies that the learning objectives were achieved.

Level 3 - Behaviour

- **Question:** Are participants applying what they learnt on the job? Has their behaviour or performance changed?
- **Measures:** observation by supervisors, performance appraisal data, 360-degree feedback, work samples, checklists, interviews with participants and their managers, self-reports of application.
- **Timing:** three to six months after training, to allow opportunity for application.
- **Use:** reveals whether transfer of learning has occurred; failure here usually indicates lack of opportunity, supervisor support, rewards or a supportive climate rather than poor training.

Level 4 - Results

- **Question:** What measurable organisational outcomes resulted from the training?
- **Measures:** productivity, quality and defect rates, sales, costs, customer satisfaction, accident rates, turnover, absenteeism, time to competence; compared against pre-training baselines and, where possible, control groups; sometimes extended to return on investment (Phillips' Level 5).
- **Timing:** six to twelve months after training.
- **Use:** demonstrates the business value of training to management and justifies the investment.

3. Summary table

Level	Focus	Typical tools	When	Main purpose
1 Reaction	Satisfaction and relevance	Feedback forms, discussions	Immediately	Improve delivery
2 Learning	KSAs acquired	Tests, demonstrations, simulations	End of programme	Confirm objectives met
3 Behaviour	Application on the job	Observation, appraisal, 360-degree feedback	3-6 months later	Check transfer of learning
4 Results	Organisational impact	Business metrics, ROI	6-12 months later	Prove value, guide investment

4. Key principles of the model

- The levels form a **chain of evidence**: each higher level gives more valuable but harder-to-collect information.
- Evaluation should be **planned during design**, starting with the results desired (the updated model recommends working backwards from Level 4).
- Positive results at a lower level do not guarantee results at a higher level; a programme may be enjoyed (Level 1) and learnt (Level 2) but never applied (Level 3).
- Levels 3 and 4 depend not only on the training but on the **work environment** - supervisor support, opportunity to apply, rewards and organisational climate.

5. Example

A customer-service programme is evaluated as follows: participants rate it 4.6/5 (Reaction); average test scores rise from 55 to 85 per cent (Learning); mystery-shopper audits three months later show 40 per cent more compliant service behaviours (Behaviour); customer-satisfaction scores rise from 72 to 81 and complaints fall by 30 per cent over the next year (Results).

6. Conclusion

The Kirkpatrick model evaluates training at four levels - Reaction, Learning, Behaviour and Results - moving from how participants felt to what they learnt, what they now do differently and what the organisation gained. It provides a simple, systematic and widely accepted way of judging whether a training programme was merely enjoyable or genuinely effective.

Q46

Describe the importance of delivering a training program effectively after it has been designed.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of training delivery

Training delivery (implementation) is the stage of the training cycle in which the designed programme is actually put into effect according to the plan. It has two segments: **practical administrative arrangements** (venue, materials, equipment, schedules, participants, trainers) and **carrying out the training** (facilitating the sessions so that learning happens). A design exists on paper; delivery is where trainees meet the content, the trainer and one another. However good the design, it is the quality of delivery that decides whether learning objectives are achieved.

2. Why effective delivery is important

1. **Design produces learning only through delivery.** Objectives, content and methods are potential value; delivery converts them into actual knowledge, skills and attitudes. A weak delivery wastes all the effort and cost of TNA and design.
2. **Learner engagement and motivation.** Adults learn when they are involved, respected and see relevance. A skilled trainer creates interest, links content to participants' real problems, uses participative methods and maintains energy; a poor trainer loses the group in the first hour.
3. **Creating a learning environment.** Effective delivery provides psychological safety to ask questions and make mistakes, appropriate pace, practice opportunities and immediate feedback - conditions identified in the notes as essential for learning.
4. **Adaptation to the group.** No design fits every group perfectly. During delivery the trainer reads the participants' level and adjusts examples, depth, speed and activities in real time.
5. **Transfer of learning begins in the classroom.** Delivery that uses realistic practice, action planning and discussion of workplace barriers prepares participants to apply the learning on the job; delivery that stays theoretical does not.
6. **Credibility of the HRD function.** Participants judge the entire HRD system by their experience in the room. Well-run programmes build trust in HRD and willingness to attend future programmes; badly run ones create cynicism ("training is a waste of time").
7. **Efficient use of resources.** Smooth administration - materials ready, equipment working, sessions on time, participants informed in advance - avoids loss of costly trainer and

participant time.

8. **Valid evaluation.** Evaluation at reaction, learning, behaviour and results levels assumes that the programme was delivered as designed. Poor delivery makes it impossible to know whether the design or the execution failed.
9. **Consistency across batches and locations.** Effective delivery systems (trainer guides, train-the-trainer, quality checks) ensure that every batch receives the same quality, which is essential for compliance, safety and customer-facing skills.
10. **Return on investment.** Training is an investment; effective delivery is what makes the return possible.

3. Elements of effective delivery

Element	Good practice
Administrative readiness	Venue and equipment checked; materials printed or uploaded; participants and their managers informed of objectives; schedule fits work shifts
Trainer competence	Subject expertise plus facilitation skills - communication, questioning, handling group dynamics, giving feedback
Opening	Set objectives and expectations, establish relevance, create a safe climate, agree ground rules
Methods in action	Mix of explanation, demonstration, practice, discussion, cases, role plays; short segments; frequent interaction
Learning principles	Build on experience, move from known to unknown, provide practice and reinforcement, give immediate feedback, respect individual pace
Managing time and energy	Breaks, variety, energisers, keeping to the plan while allowing useful discussion
Closing	Summary, action plans for application, evaluation forms, information about follow-up support
Follow-up	Reminders, job aids, coaching by supervisors, review of action plans after a few weeks

4. Common delivery failures

Lecturing for hours, reading slides, ignoring participants' experience, no practice, technology failures, wrong participants, overloaded content, no link to the job, and no follow-up. Each of these can undo a good design.

5. Conclusion

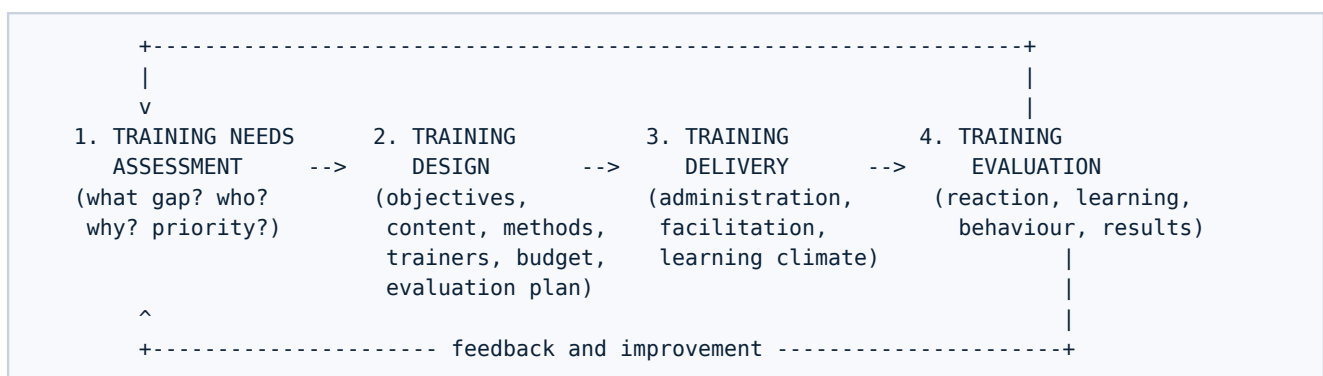
Delivery is the moment of truth for a training programme. Effective delivery - careful administration, a competent facilitator, an engaging and safe learning environment, appropriate methods and preparation for transfer - turns a sound design into real learning, protects the investment made in TNA and design, builds the credibility of HRD and makes meaningful evaluation possible. Design decides what could be learnt; delivery decides what is learnt.

Q47**Explain the relationship among Training Needs Assessment, training design, training delivery, and training evaluation.**

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

Training is best understood as a **cycle of four stages** - Training Needs Assessment (TNA), design, delivery (implementation) and evaluation - rather than as a set of separate activities. Each stage depends on the one before it and provides the basis for the one after it, and the last stage feeds back into the first. This systems view is common to the four-stage training cycle in the prescribed notes and the HRD process model of Werner and DeSimone (assessment - design - implementation - evaluation).

2. The training cycle**3. How each stage depends on the others****TNA -> Design**

TNA identifies the performance gap, its causes, the people affected and the priority. Design converts these into a training goal, learning objectives, content, methods and participant selection. Without TNA, design has no valid basis - objectives become guesses and content becomes generic. TNA also provides the **baseline** (actual performance) against which evaluation will later measure improvement.

Design -> Delivery

Design produces the plan - lesson plans, materials, methods, trainers, schedule, budget - that delivery executes. A clear design allows consistent delivery across batches and gives the trainer a road map, while still leaving room to adapt to the group. Poor design (unclear objectives, overloaded content, wrong methods) makes even skilled delivery ineffective.

Delivery -> Evaluation

Evaluation measures what delivery achieved: participants' reactions, learning gained, behaviour changed and results produced. Delivery must therefore be faithful to the design so that evaluation results are interpretable, and the trainer collects Level 1 and Level 2 data during delivery itself.

Design -> Evaluation (planned together)

Evaluation criteria and methods are decided during design, derived from the learning objectives. Objectives written in measurable terms ("will be able to ... to a standard of ...") are what make

Level 2 and Level 3 evaluation possible. The Kirkpatrick approach recommends designing backwards from the desired results.

Evaluation -> TNA and design (the feedback loop)

Evaluation findings show whether the need was correctly identified, whether the design was appropriate, whether delivery was effective and whether the organisation supported transfer. Gaps found at Level 3 or 4 become inputs to the next TNA; weaknesses at Level 1 or 2 lead to redesign or changes in delivery. Evaluation thus closes the loop and starts the next cycle.

4. Relationship shown as inputs and outputs

Stage	Main inputs (from)	Main outputs (to)
TNA	Organisational goals, appraisal data, performance records, previous evaluations	Training needs, priorities, target group, baseline data -> design and evaluation
Design	Needs and objectives from TNA	Training plan: objectives, content, methods, materials, trainers, schedule, budget, evaluation plan -> delivery and evaluation
Delivery	Training plan and materials	Learning experience, Level 1 and 2 data, action plans -> evaluation and the workplace
Evaluation	Objectives and baseline from TNA and design; data from delivery and the job	Judgement of effectiveness, lessons for improvement -> next TNA and design

5. Consequences of breaking the chain

Skipping TNA produces irrelevant training; designing without measurable objectives makes evaluation impossible; delivering without following the design makes results uninterpretable; and not evaluating means the same mistakes are repeated and the value of training cannot be shown. Rao and Abraham's finding that many organisations sponsor employees without genuine need analysis and give little opportunity to apply learning is an example of a broken cycle.

6. Conclusion

TNA, design, delivery and evaluation are four interdependent stages of a single cycle. TNA defines the need and baseline; design converts the need into a plan and evaluation criteria; delivery executes the plan and generates learning; evaluation measures the outcome against the objectives and feeds lessons back into the next cycle. Training is effective only when all four are connected.

Q48

Discuss the importance of evaluating training effectiveness for employees and organizations.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of training evaluation

Training evaluation is the systematic collection and analysis of information to judge whether a training programme achieved its objectives and produced value. The training process does not end when the programme is completed; its effectiveness must be evaluated against outcomes related to the programme's objectives - typically the four Kirkpatrick levels of Reaction,

Learning, Behaviour and Results, and sometimes return on investment. Evaluation matters to two parties: the employees who were trained and the organisation that paid for the training.

2. Importance for employees

1. **Confirmation of learning and competence** - tests, demonstrations and certifications tell employees that they have actually acquired the skill, which builds confidence and self-efficacy.
2. **Feedback for further improvement** - evaluation identifies what each participant still needs to master, guiding coaching and further development.
3. **Recognition and career progress** - documented learning and improved performance become evidence for appraisal, potential assessment, promotion and career planning.
4. **Relevance of future training** - participants' reactions and behaviour data improve subsequent programmes, so employees receive better, more useful training.
5. **Support for application** - Level 3 evaluation reveals barriers to using new skills (lack of tools, unsupportive supervisors), which the organisation can then remove; this helps employees succeed with their new learning.
6. **Motivation** - knowing that learning will be measured and its application noticed encourages employees to take training seriously and to apply it.
7. **Voice** - reaction evaluation gives employees a say in the design and quality of their development.

3. Importance for the organisation

1. **Accountability and justification of investment** - training costs money and time; evaluation shows management what it received in return and supports future budgets.
2. **Decision making** - evaluation results guide decisions on whether to continue, repeat, modify or discontinue a programme, whether to retain a trainer or vendor, whether to reuse methods and how to budget.
3. **Improvement of design and delivery** - Level 1 and 2 data pinpoint weaknesses in content, methods, trainers or logistics.
4. **Verification of transfer** - Level 3 data show whether learning is being applied; if not, the organisation can address supervisory support, opportunity and rewards - the real determinants of transfer.
5. **Link to business results** - Level 4 data connect training to productivity, quality, sales, safety, customer satisfaction and turnover, demonstrating HRD's strategic contribution and building the credibility and respectability of the function.
6. **Validation of the needs assessment** - if results do not improve despite good learning, the need may have been wrongly diagnosed or non-training causes may exist; evaluation corrects the next TNA.
7. **Organisational learning and knowledge** - evaluation builds a database of what works for whom, improving the whole HRD system over time.
8. **Risk management and compliance** - documented evidence that employees were trained and assessed is essential for safety, quality and regulatory requirements.
9. **Motivation of trainers and line managers** - measurement creates accountability for results rather than for activity.

4. Different stakeholders value different measures

Senior and line managers tend to judge HRD by quantitative measures such as better utilisation of people, productivity and flexibility; HRD specialists look at programme quality and participation; individual learners care about employability, certification and competencies gained. A good evaluation therefore reports at multiple levels to satisfy all three groups.

5. Consequences of not evaluating

Training becomes an act of faith; ineffective programmes continue and effective ones are cut in downturns; transfer problems remain hidden; employees receive no feedback; and HRD cannot demonstrate its value or improve. D'Souza's observation that the return on training investment in many Indian industries is poor is partly a result of the absence of evaluation.

6. Conclusion

Evaluating training effectiveness is important for employees because it confirms their learning, guides their further development, supports their careers and removes barriers to applying new skills; and for the organisation because it justifies investment, improves programmes, verifies transfer, links training to business results and strengthens the entire HRD system. Without evaluation, training remains an expense of unknown value; with it, training becomes a managed investment.

Q49

A department is experiencing repeated performance errors. Apply the concept of TNA to identify what information should be collected before designing training.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Applying the TNA concept to the case

Repeated performance errors are a **symptom**, not a diagnosis. The purpose of Training Needs Assessment here is to establish (a) exactly what the errors are and what standard is being missed, (b) why they occur, (c) whether the causes are training-related (knowledge, skill, attitude) or non-training-related (systems, tools, workload, motivation, unclear standards), and (d) if training is required, who needs what. The cause-and-effect analysis should be done before deciding whether or not training is the answer - a caution emphasised in the prescribed notes. The information to be collected is organised below by the three levels of TNA plus a cause analysis.

2. Information to collect at the organisation level

Information	Why it is needed	Source
Nature, frequency, cost and trend of the errors	Defines the size and priority of the problem and the baseline for later evaluation	Error logs, quality reports, customer complaints, rework and scrap data
Performance standards and goals of the department	Establishes the "standard performance" side of the gap formula	Job descriptions, SOPs, KPIs, service-level agreements
Recent changes	New systems, products, procedures, staff turnover or restructuring often trigger errors	Management interviews, change records

Information	Why it is needed	Source
Departmental climate and management support	Fear, overload or poor supervision may cause errors and will affect transfer of any training	HRD climate survey, employee interviews
Resources available for training	Budget, time, trainers, facilities constrain the solution	HRD department

3. Information to collect at the task level

Information	Why it is needed	Source
Detailed task inventory of the jobs where errors occur	Identifies which tasks and steps produce the errors	SOPs, job analysis, observation
Knowledge, skills and attitudes (KSAs) required for each critical task	Defines the competencies training would have to build	Task analysis, subject-matter experts
Points in the process where errors occur and their type	Distinguishes knowledge errors, skill errors, judgement errors and slips	Error classification, process mapping
Tools, equipment, information and job aids available	Reveals whether tasks are workable without error	Observation, equipment records
Interdependencies with other departments	Errors may originate upstream	Process mapping, interviews

4. Information to collect at the person level

Information	Why it is needed	Source
Who makes the errors - all employees, new ones, specific shifts or individuals?	Decides whether the need is group-wide or individual	Error data by employee, supervisor input
Current knowledge and skill levels of the employees	Measures the "actual performance" side of the gap	Tests, skill demonstrations, appraisal data, certifications
Previous training received and its evaluation	Avoids repeating what has already been taught and reveals transfer failure	Training records
Employees' own explanation of the errors	Often the most accurate source on real causes	Interviews, focus groups, anonymous surveys

Information	Why it is needed	Source
Attitudes, motivation, workload, fatigue and stress	Errors may be motivational or overload-related rather than skill-related	Interviews, attendance and overtime data
Learning readiness - education, language, digital literacy, experience	Shapes the design of any training	HR records, self-assessment

5. Cause analysis - is training the answer?

Can the employee do the task correctly if his or her life depended on it?

NO -> knowledge / skill deficiency -> TRAINING (and practice, job aids, coaching)

YES -> performance problem has other causes:

- unclear standards or feedback -> clarify expectations, give feedback
- inadequate tools, systems, information -> fix the system
- overload, fatigue, poor scheduling -> redesign work
- no consequences / wrong incentives -> align rewards and accountability
- motivation or attitude -> counselling, involvement, supervision

Information must therefore also be collected on feedback practices, consequences of errors, incentives and supervision quality.

6. Output of the TNA

The analysis should end with a clear statement of: the performance gap in measurable terms; the root causes; the proportion of the problem that training can solve; the target group; the specific KSAs to be developed (training objectives); non-training actions required; priorities; and the baseline against which the training will later be evaluated.

7. Conclusion

Before designing training for a department with repeated errors, TNA requires information at three levels - the organisational context, standards and error data; the tasks and competencies involved; and the individuals, their current capability, their explanations and their working conditions - together with a cause analysis that separates training from non-training problems. Collecting this information ensures that the training, if needed, targets the real gap, reaches the right people and can be evaluated against a known baseline.

Q50

Apply suitable training methods to design a development program for employees who need both practical job skills and conceptual knowledge.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Understanding the requirement

The employees need two different kinds of learning. **Conceptual knowledge** - principles, theories, procedures, "why" - is best learnt through methods that explain, illustrate and allow discussion, typically off the job or through e-learning. **Practical job skills** - the "how" - are learnt through demonstration, practice, feedback and repetition, typically on the job or in simulated settings. Neither method type alone will do: pure classroom training produces people

who know but cannot do, while pure on-the-job training produces people who can do but do not understand, and therefore cannot adapt when situations change. The design must therefore be a **blended programme** in which concepts and skills reinforce each other.

2. Design principles applied

- Sequence **concept -> demonstration -> practice -> application -> review** for each module.
- Use the **70-20-10 idea** as a guide: most learning through on-the-job experience, a substantial part through coaching and social learning, and a focused part through formal instruction.
- Keep formal sessions short and spaced so that practice happens between them.
- Involve supervisors as coaches to ensure transfer.
- Evaluate at all four Kirkpatrick levels.

3. Methods selected and their purpose

Learning need	Method	Why it suits
Foundational concepts and principles	E-learning modules and short classroom lectures with visuals	Efficient, consistent, self-paced delivery of knowledge; can be revisited
Understanding application of concepts	Case studies and group discussion	Develop analysis and judgement; connect theory to realistic situations
Procedures and standards	Demonstration by expert and job aids / checklists	Shows the correct way; job aids support recall on the job
Basic skill practice in a safe setting	Vestibule / simulation training, role plays	Practice without risk to production, customers or safety; immediate feedback
Skill building on real work	Job instruction training and coaching by supervisor	Real conditions, real feedback, immediate transfer
Breadth and system understanding	Job rotation and cross-functional project	Shows how tasks connect; builds conceptual understanding through experience
Reflection and deeper learning	Action learning sets, learning journals, peer review	Convert experience into insight; reinforce concepts
Guidance and motivation	Mentoring	Sustains development and links learning to career

4. Structure of the development programme (illustrative 12-week design)

WEEK 1	Orientation: objectives, assessment of current knowledge and skills (baseline) E-learning Module 1 (core concepts) + half-day classroom session with case discussion
WEEKS 2-3	Demonstration of key procedures by expert; vestibule / simulation practice Job aids issued; supervisor briefed on coaching plan
WEEKS 4-6	On-the-job practice under job instruction training; daily coaching feedback E-learning Module 2 (advanced concepts) completed during the period Weekly one-hour review session: problems faced, concepts revisited
WEEKS 7-9	Job rotation to a related section (2 weeks) to see the whole process Case study workshop applying concepts to real departmental problems Skill assessment 1 (checklist-based observation)
WEEKS 10-11	Small improvement project in own area applying both concepts and skills Mentor meeting; action learning set presentation
WEEK 12	Final knowledge test and skill certification; action plan for continued application Level 1 and Level 2 evaluation; schedule Level 3 review at 3 months and Level 4 at 6-12 months

5. Roles

- **HRD department:** designs modules, e-learning and cases; trains supervisors as coaches; runs assessments.
- **Subject experts / internal trainers:** demonstrate procedures and lead workshops.
- **Supervisors:** coach daily, sign off skill checklists, provide opportunities to apply.
- **Mentors:** guide development and career linkage.
- **Participants:** complete e-learning, practise, keep learning journals, deliver the project.

6. Evaluation plan

Reaction forms after each formal session; pre/post knowledge tests and skill certification (Learning); supervisor observation checklists and error/quality data three months later (Behaviour); departmental productivity, quality, customer or safety indicators after six to twelve months (Results).

7. Conclusion

A development programme for employees who need both conceptual knowledge and practical skills must blend methods: e-learning, lectures and case studies for concepts; demonstration, simulation, job instruction training and coaching for skills; and job rotation, projects and mentoring to integrate the two. Sequenced as concept, demonstration, practice, application and review, supported by supervisors and evaluated at all levels, such a blended design produces employees who both understand their work and can perform it well.

Q51

State any two purposes of Training Needs Assessment.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Meaning of Training Needs Assessment

Training Needs Assessment (TNA) is the systematic process of identifying the gap between the performance and competence an organisation requires and what its employees currently possess (Training need = Standard performance - Actual performance), analysing the causes of the gap, and deciding whether and how training should address it. It is conducted at three levels - organisation, task and person - and is the first stage of the training cycle. TNA serves several

purposes; two of the most important are explained in detail below, followed by the others.

2. Purpose 1 - To identify the real performance gap and determine whether training is the right solution

- Organisations often assume that every performance problem needs training. TNA tests this assumption by measuring the gap between expected and actual performance and analysing its **causes**: lack of knowledge or skill (training problems) versus poor tools, unclear standards, weak feedback, overload, wrong incentives or low motivation (non-training problems).
- By separating the two, TNA ensures that training is prescribed only where it will work, and that other problems are referred to the right remedy - system redesign, better supervision, clearer goals or counselling.
- This purpose protects the organisation from the common error of buying "off-the-shelf" programmes without considering their relevance or applicability, and from the frustration of employees who are trained for problems that training cannot solve.
- Example:** A TNA of billing errors finds that half the errors arise from a confusing software screen (system problem) and half from new staff not knowing the returns policy (training need). Training is designed only for the second, while IT redesigns the screen for the first.

3. Purpose 2 - To define who needs what training and to provide the basis for objectives, design and evaluation

- Once a genuine training need is confirmed, TNA specifies the **target group** (person analysis), the **content** in terms of knowledge, skills and attitudes required (task analysis) and the **priority and business linkage** (organisation analysis).
- These findings become the **learning objectives** of the programme and guide decisions on methods, trainers, duration and budget - the design stage cannot begin properly without them.
- TNA also records the **baseline** of actual performance, against which the programme is later evaluated at the Kirkpatrick levels of learning, behaviour and results. Without a baseline, effectiveness cannot be demonstrated.
- Selecting participants on the basis of assessed need - rather than as a reward, a routine or a "fringe benefit" - was identified by Rao and Abraham as one of the weakest links in Indian training practice; this purpose of TNA corrects it.
- Example:** A TNA shows that only supervisors on the night shift lack knowledge of the new safety procedure; a targeted two-hour programme for those twelve people, with a pre/post test and an accident-rate baseline, replaces a company-wide seminar.

4. Other purposes of TNA

Purpose	Brief explanation
Link training to organisational strategy	Organisation analysis ties programmes to business goals and future capability requirements
Prioritise and allocate resources	Needs are ranked by impact, urgency and numbers so that limited budgets go where they matter most
Build readiness and commitment	Employees and managers involved in the assessment are more motivated to learn and to support application
Assess readiness of the environment	Reveals whether the climate, supervisors and resources will support transfer of training

Purpose	Brief explanation
Integrate training with other HRD subsystems	Draws on appraisal, counselling and potential appraisal; feeds career and succession planning
Prepare for change	Identifies the capabilities required before new technology, processes or structures are introduced

5. Conclusion

Two central purposes of Training Needs Assessment are, first, to identify the real performance gap and establish whether training - rather than some other intervention - is the right solution, and second, to define precisely who needs what training so that objectives, design and evaluation rest on a sound foundation. Together with its other purposes, TNA ensures that training is relevant, targeted, economical and measurable.

Q52
Name any two levels of the Kirkpatrick model.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. The Kirkpatrick model in brief

The Kirkpatrick model, developed by Donald L. Kirkpatrick in 1959, is the most widely used framework for evaluating training effectiveness. It assesses a programme at **four successive levels - Level 1 Reaction, Level 2 Learning, Level 3 Behaviour and Level 4 Results** - each answering a deeper question about the value of the training. Any two levels may be named; two are explained in detail below, and the other two are summarised so that the complete model is clear.

2. Level 1 - Reaction

- **What it measures:** how participants felt about the training - their satisfaction with the content, trainer, methods, materials, facilities and organisation, and (in the updated model) their engagement and the perceived relevance of the programme to their jobs.
- **How it is measured:** end-of-programme feedback questionnaires (often called "happy sheets") with rating scales and open comments; verbal feedback; observation of participation.
- **When:** immediately at the end of the programme or of each session.
- **Why it matters:** a favourable reaction creates the motivation to learn and indicates whether the delivery met participants' expectations; feedback is used to improve future programmes. However, a positive reaction does not prove that learning or performance improvement occurred - it is necessary but not sufficient.
- **Example:** Participants rate a negotiation-skills workshop 4.5 out of 5 for usefulness and 4.8 for trainer effectiveness, but suggest more practice time.

3. Level 2 - Learning

- **What it measures:** the extent to which participants acquired the intended knowledge, skills and attitudes - and, in the updated model, the confidence and commitment to apply them.
- **How it is measured:** pre-tests and post-tests, skill demonstrations, simulations, role-play assessments with checklists, case analyses, projects and certifications; where possible, comparison with a control group.
- **When:** at the end of the programme, compared with a pre-training baseline.

- **Why it matters:** it verifies that the learning objectives set during design were achieved. If learning has not occurred, behaviour change and results cannot follow; if it has occurred but behaviour does not change, the problem lies in the work environment rather than the training.
- **Example:** Average scores on a product-knowledge test rise from 52 per cent before training to 88 per cent after; 90 per cent of participants demonstrate the correct procedure in a simulated exercise.

4. The remaining two levels

Level	Question	Typical measures	Timing
Level 3 - Behaviour	Are participants applying the learning on the job?	Supervisor observation, appraisal data, 360-degree feedback, work samples	3-6 months after training
Level 4 - Results	What organisational outcomes resulted?	Productivity, quality, sales, costs, customer satisfaction, safety, turnover; return on investment	6-12 months after training

5. The logic of the levels

Reaction --> Learning --> Behaviour --> Results
 (felt) (know/can) (do) (organisation gains)
 easy and quick to measure -----> harder, slower, but more valuable evidence

Each higher level provides stronger evidence of effectiveness but is more difficult and costly to measure. Good evaluation plans decide the levels during the design stage and, ideally, work backwards from the results desired.

6. Conclusion

Two levels of the Kirkpatrick model are Level 1 Reaction, which measures participants' satisfaction and perceived relevance, and Level 2 Learning, which measures the knowledge, skills and attitudes actually acquired. Together with Level 3 Behaviour and Level 4 Results, they form a chain of evidence that tells an organisation whether a training programme was merely well received or truly effective.

Q53

Analyze why a training program may receive positive participant reactions but still fail to improve job performance.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. The issue

In Kirkpatrick's terms this is a programme that scores high at **Level 1 (Reaction)** but low at **Level 3 (Behaviour)** and **Level 4 (Results)**. It is a very common pattern: participants enjoy the programme, praise the trainer and rate it as useful, yet three months later nothing has changed on the job. The reasons lie partly in the programme itself and, more often, in the surrounding HRD system and work environment. The analysis below groups the causes into four areas.

2. Causes related to needs assessment and design

1. **Wrong diagnosis - training was not the solution.** If the performance problem was caused by poor tools, unclear standards, overload or lack of incentives, even excellent training cannot fix it. Participants may enjoy the programme, but the real cause remains.
2. **Generic or irrelevant content.** Programmes bought "off the shelf" are often entertaining and well presented but not tied to the specific tasks, systems and standards of the participants' jobs.
3. **Wrong participants.** People sent as a reward or to fill seats react positively (a pleasant break from work) but had no need and therefore nothing to change.
4. **Objectives set at the knowledge level only.** If the design aimed at awareness rather than at demonstrable skill, participants leave informed but not able.
5. **Insufficient practice.** Skills require repeated practice with feedback; a programme heavy on lectures, videos and discussion may be enjoyable yet build no capability.

3. Causes related to learning itself

6. **Enjoyment is not learning.** Positive reactions reflect entertainment value, trainer charisma, good food and a comfortable venue as much as learning. Level 2 tests may reveal that little was actually retained.
7. **No measurement of learning.** Without pre/post assessment, nobody knows whether the objectives were achieved.

4. Causes related to transfer of learning and the work environment

8. **Lack of opportunity to apply.** Rao and Abraham found that many employees had little chance to try out what they learnt; skills not used within weeks decay rapidly.
9. **Unsupportive supervisors.** If the boss did not brief the participant before training, does not expect new behaviour afterwards and does not coach, the old ways return.
10. **Peer and cultural pressure.** Colleagues may ridicule or resist new methods ("that is not how we do it here"); a weak HRD climate discourages experimentation.
11. **No reinforcement through appraisal and rewards.** When appraisal criteria and incentives still reward old behaviour, the new behaviour has no pay-off.
12. **Systems and resources unchanged.** New skills may need new tools, authority, information or time that the workplace does not provide.
13. **No follow-up.** Absence of action plans, refresher sessions, job aids or coaching after the programme leaves participants alone with the difficulty of changing habits.
14. **Time lag and workload.** Back at work, urgent tasks crowd out the effort needed to apply learning consciously.

5. Causes related to the HRD system

15. **Training isolated from other subsystems.** Without linkage to appraisal, counselling, career planning and rewards, training is an event rather than part of a development process.
16. **Evaluation stops at Level 1.** When organisations measure only reactions, trainers optimise for satisfaction rather than for performance change, and transfer problems are never detected or addressed.

6. Diagrammatic summary

High REACTION	--x--> LEARNING?	--x--> BEHAVIOUR?	--x--> RESULTS?
entertainment, not skill; no practice; wrong participants	no opportunity, no supervisor support, no rewards, no follow-up	wrong diagnosis, unchanged systems, incentives, culture	

7. What should be done

Conduct proper TNA and cause analysis; set behaviour-level objectives with practice; select participants by need; brief supervisors before and involve them after; require action plans and follow-up coaching; align appraisal and rewards with the trained behaviour; provide tools and opportunity; build an experimenting, supportive climate; and evaluate at Levels 2, 3 and 4, not only Level 1.

8. Conclusion

A training programme can be liked and still fail because reaction measures enjoyment, not capability or application. The failure usually lies in a wrong or generic diagnosis, insufficient practice, the wrong participants and, above all, a work environment that offers no opportunity, support, reinforcement or reward for the new behaviour. Positive reactions are the beginning of effectiveness, not the proof of it.

Q54

Analyze the consequences of designing a training program without conducting an adequate Training Needs Assessment.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

Training Needs Assessment (TNA) is the diagnostic first stage of the training cycle. It establishes the gap between required and actual performance, identifies its causes, decides whether training is the right remedy, specifies who needs what, and records the baseline for evaluation. Organisations skip or shorten it because it seems time-consuming, costly, requires skilled staff, or because managers do not want to confront the real reasons for poor performance. The consequences of this short cut affect every later stage of the training process and the HRD system as a whole, as analysed below.

2. Consequences for the design of the programme

- Vague or wrong objectives.** Without a defined gap, objectives are written in general terms ("improve communication") that cannot guide content or be measured.
- Irrelevant or generic content.** Content is chosen from what trainers offer rather than from what tasks require; "off-the-shelf" programmes are bought without checking their applicability.
- Inappropriate methods and level.** Not knowing participants' existing knowledge leads to programmes that are too basic for some and too advanced for others; skills that need practice are taught by lecture.
- Wrong duration and cost.** Programmes are longer or shorter than the need requires; budgets are spent without relation to impact.

3. Consequences for participants

5. **Wrong participants.** People are nominated by convenience, seniority or as a reward rather than by need; those who need training are left out while others attend unnecessarily.
6. **Low motivation and cynicism.** Employees who see no connection between the programme and their work disengage, and future programmes are treated as holidays.
7. **Frustration.** Employees trained for problems caused by systems, tools or policies return to the same obstacles and conclude that training changes nothing.

4. Consequences for performance and the organisation

8. **The real problem remains unsolved.** If the errors were caused by faulty equipment, unclear standards, overload or poor incentives, training cannot remove them; the performance gap persists and management concludes that "training does not work."
9. **Wasted resources.** Trainer fees, materials, venues and, above all, participants' productive time are spent without return - the "fringe benefit" training with poor return on investment noted by D'Souza.
10. **Strategic capability gaps continue.** Without organisation-level analysis, training is not aligned to business goals; skills the strategy needs are not built while budgets are consumed elsewhere.
11. **Low transfer of learning.** Since the environment was never assessed, barriers to application - unsupportive supervisors, lack of opportunity - are not addressed.
12. **Risk and compliance exposure.** Safety, quality or regulatory training needs may be missed altogether.

5. Consequences for evaluation and the HRD system

13. **Evaluation becomes impossible or meaningless.** Without a baseline and measurable objectives, effectiveness cannot be judged at the learning, behaviour or results levels; evaluation stops at reaction forms.
14. **No organisational learning.** Because causes were never analysed, the same programmes are repeated year after year with the same lack of effect.
15. **Loss of credibility of HRD.** Management sees activity without results; training budgets are cut in the next downturn; the HRD function loses status and influence.
16. **Broken linkages with other subsystems.** Training that does not draw on appraisal, counselling and potential data cannot feed career and succession planning; the HRD system fragments.

6. Chain of consequences

No / weak TNA

- > wrong diagnosis, vague objectives, generic content, wrong participants
- > little learning that matters, low motivation
- > no change in job performance; real causes untouched
- > no measurable results; wasted budget
- > "training does not work" -> reduced investment -> weaker HRD system

7. Illustration

A company facing customer complaints about delayed deliveries sent all warehouse staff to a customer-service programme. Participants enjoyed it. Complaints continued because the delays

were caused by an outdated stock-location system and unrealistic despatch targets - facts that a TNA would have revealed in a week. The training budget was spent, the problem remained, and staff lost faith in HRD.

8. Conclusion

Designing training without an adequate TNA produces programmes with unclear objectives, irrelevant content and the wrong participants; it leaves the real causes of poor performance untouched, wastes resources, makes evaluation meaningless and undermines the credibility of the entire HRD function. The time and cost of a proper TNA are small compared with the cost of training that solves nothing.

Q55

Evaluate the usefulness of the Kirkpatrick model for judging the effectiveness of an organizational training program.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. The model in brief

The Kirkpatrick model (1959, updated as the "New World Kirkpatrick Model") evaluates training at four levels: **Reaction** (satisfaction and relevance), **Learning** (knowledge, skills, attitudes, confidence and commitment acquired), **Behaviour** (application on the job) and **Results** (organisational outcomes). It is by far the most widely used evaluation framework in HRD practice. The question is how useful it actually is for judging the effectiveness of an organisational training programme. The evaluation below weighs its strengths against its limitations and reaches a balanced judgement.

2. Strengths - why the model is useful

1. **Simplicity and clarity.** Four levels with plain-language questions make the model easy to understand and communicate to trainers, line managers and top management alike.
2. **Comprehensive chain of evidence.** It moves systematically from participants' feelings to organisational impact, preventing the common error of judging training by reactions alone.
3. **Links training to business results.** Level 4 forces HRD to define and measure the organisational outcomes a programme is meant to influence, which supports strategy alignment and demonstrates HRD's value.
4. **Diagnostic power.** Comparing levels shows where a programme breaks down: high learning but low behaviour points to transfer problems in the work environment rather than to the training itself.
5. **Guides design.** Planning evaluation from Level 4 backwards produces clearer objectives, better methods and built-in transfer support.
6. **Flexibility.** The model can be applied to technical, behavioural, management and e-learning programmes, at any scale, with methods ranging from simple forms to controlled studies.
7. **Common language and benchmarking.** Its universal use allows comparison across programmes, vendors and organisations and supports HRD audits.
8. **Involves line managers.** Levels 3 and 4 require supervisors to observe behaviour and supply performance data, drawing them into responsibility for transfer.

3. Limitations - where the model falls short

Limitation	Explanation	How serious?
Assumes a causal chain	It implies that reaction leads to learning, learning to behaviour and behaviour to results; research shows the correlations between levels are weak	Moderate - the levels should be treated as different kinds of evidence, not as a guaranteed sequence
Ignores context and process	It evaluates outcomes but says little about why they occurred - needs assessment quality, design, delivery, climate, supervisor support	Significant - must be supplemented with process evaluation
Higher levels are difficult and costly	Isolating training's effect on business results from other factors (market, technology, other initiatives) requires baselines, control groups and time; most organisations stop at Level 1 or 2	Practical constraint rather than a flaw of the model
No cost dimension	It does not compare benefits with costs; Phillips added a fifth level, Return on Investment, for this	Easily remedied by adding ROI
Focus on individual training events	Less suited to continuous, informal, social and on-the-job learning or to broader HRD interventions such as OD and culture change	Moderate
Time lag and attribution	Results appear months later and may be attributed to other causes; managers may lose interest	Requires planning and communication
Possible over-simplification	Reduces complex learning and performance to four boxes; may neglect unintended outcomes, learner well-being or long-term career effects	Minor if used thoughtfully

4. Comparison with alternatives

Other frameworks - the CIRO model (Context, Input, Reaction, Outcome), Brinkerhoff's Success Case Method, Kaufman's five levels and Phillips' ROI methodology - address some gaps, especially context and cost. Yet most of them build on Kirkpatrick's levels rather than replace them, which is itself evidence of the model's usefulness.

5. Conditions for getting the most from the model

- Decide the desired results and leading indicators **before** design; write behaviour-level objectives.
- Measure Levels 1 and 2 for every programme, Level 3 for important programmes, Level 4 for strategic or expensive programmes.
- Use baselines from the TNA, comparison groups where feasible and multiple data sources.
- Evaluate process factors (design quality, delivery, supervisor support, climate) alongside outcomes.
- Add ROI or cost-benefit analysis for major investments.
- Report results to line managers and top management and act on them.

6. Judgement

For an organisational training programme, the Kirkpatrick model is **highly useful as an organising framework**: it defines what to measure, in what order and why, keeps attention on behaviour and business results, and provides a common language. It is **less useful as a complete explanation** of why a programme succeeded or failed and it does not by itself handle cost or context. Its practical weakness - that organisations rarely go beyond Level 2 - is a failure of application rather than of the model.

7. Conclusion

The Kirkpatrick model remains the most practical and widely accepted tool for judging training effectiveness because of its simplicity, comprehensiveness and business orientation. Its limitations - assumed causality, neglect of context, difficulty and cost of higher levels and absence of a cost dimension - are real but can be managed by planning evaluation during design, supplementing it with process evaluation and ROI, and applying it consistently. Used in this way, it turns training from an act of faith into a measured investment.

Q56

Analyze how the choice among on-the-job, off-the-job, and e-learning methods can affect training outcomes.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Introduction

Training outcomes - learning, transfer to the job, performance improvement, cost-effectiveness and participant satisfaction - depend not only on content but on the **method** through which learning is delivered. The three broad families of methods are **on-the-job training** (coaching, job instruction, job rotation, apprenticeship, mentoring), **off-the-job training** (lectures, case studies, role plays, simulations, vestibule training, seminars) and **e-learning** (online modules, virtual classrooms, simulations, mobile learning). Each has a distinct profile of strengths and weaknesses, and the match between method, learning objective, learners and context largely determines the result.

2. How each method family shapes outcomes

Outcome dimension	On-the-job	Off-the-job	E-learning
Type of learning best achieved	Practical, job-specific skills; tacit knowledge	Concepts, principles, analysis, attitudes, interpersonal skills, complex skills practised safely	Knowledge, procedures, compliance, product information; some skills through simulation
Transfer to the job	Very high - learning happens in the real context	Moderate to low unless followed up; artificial setting	Moderate; good for knowledge, weaker for behaviour unless blended
Consistency and quality	Variable - depends on the supervisor; bad habits may be transmitted	High - expert trainers, structured content	Very high - identical content for all
Speed and scale	Slow; one or few learners at a time	Medium; batches of 15-30	Very fast; thousands simultaneously

Outcome dimension	On-the-job	Off-the-job	E-learning
Cost per learner	Low direct cost, but hidden cost of errors and supervisor time	High - trainers, venue, travel, time away	High development cost, very low delivery cost
Learner engagement and interaction	High relevance; limited reflection; production pressure	High interaction with peers and experts; broad perspective	Self-paced but isolated; risk of low completion without motivation
Feedback	Immediate, from real results and supervisor	From trainer and peers during exercises	Automated, instant for tests; limited for judgement and behaviour
Risk during learning	Errors affect real output, customers or safety	Safe to fail	Safe to fail
Measurability	Observed performance	Tests, exercises	Detailed tracking through the LMS

3. Analysis of the effects of the choice

- Fit between method and objective is decisive.** Teaching machine operation by lecture (off-the-job) produces knowledge without skill; teaching strategic thinking by on-the-job repetition produces habit without understanding; teaching customer-handling behaviour by e-learning alone produces awareness without practice. A mismatched method lowers learning at Kirkpatrick Level 2 and, more sharply, behaviour at Level 3.
- Transfer depends on similarity to the job.** On-the-job methods have the highest transfer because there is no gap between the learning and the working context. Off-the-job and e-learning gain transfer only when they use realistic cases, simulations and action plans and when supervisors reinforce application.
- Quality depends on the trainer or the design.** On-the-job outcomes vary with the coaching skill and willingness of supervisors; off-the-job outcomes vary with the trainer's competence; e-learning outcomes vary with instructional design quality and learner motivation. The method choice therefore also decides where investment in quality is needed - train-the-trainer for OJT, expert selection for off-the-job, design and content for e-learning.
- Learner characteristics matter.** Experienced adults with clear needs benefit from OJT and case-based off-the-job work; geographically dispersed or shift-based staff benefit from e-learning; learners with low digital literacy or motivation may fail online.
- Cost and scale shape what is feasible.** For a compliance topic reaching 5,000 employees, e-learning gives acceptable outcomes at a fraction of the cost; for developing ten future plant heads, off-the-job programmes combined with job rotation and mentoring are worth the expense.
- Culture and climate influence effectiveness.** Where the HRD climate is weak and supervisors are not coaches, OJT fails; where openness is low, role plays and T-groups are resisted; where technology is unfamiliar, e-learning is ignored.
- Blending usually optimises outcomes.** Because each family covers different outcomes, a blended design - e-learning for concepts, off-the-job workshops for analysis and practice in a safe setting, on-the-job coaching and projects for application - typically produces higher learning, transfer and cost-effectiveness than any single method.

4. Illustration

A bank introducing a new loan-appraisal system compared three approaches. Branches trained only through an e-learning module knew the rules but made process errors; branches trained only in a classroom understood the concepts but struggled with the software; branches trained through e-learning plus a half-day vestibule practice session plus two weeks of on-the-job coaching by a trained officer achieved the lowest error rates and fastest processing times.

5. Conclusion

The choice among on-the-job, off-the-job and e-learning methods affects what is learnt, how well it transfers, how consistent and scalable the training is and what it costs. On-the-job methods maximise transfer of practical skills, off-the-job methods build concepts and complex or interpersonal skills safely, and e-learning delivers knowledge consistently and economically at scale. Outcomes are best when the method matches the objective, the learners and the context - and, in most cases, when the three are blended.

Q57

State any two reasons for evaluating training at more than one Kirkpatrick level.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Background

The Kirkpatrick model evaluates training at four levels - Reaction, Learning, Behaviour and Results. In practice many organisations stop at Level 1 (feedback forms) or, at best, Level 2 (tests). Evaluating at more than one level - ideally at all four for important programmes - is strongly recommended. Two principal reasons are explained below, followed by other supporting reasons.

2. Reason 1 - A single level gives incomplete and potentially misleading evidence of effectiveness

- Each level answers a **different question**: Did they like it? Did they learn it? Are they using it? Did it make a difference? A good score on one level does not guarantee a good score on the next. Participants may enjoy a programme (high Reaction) and learn nothing; they may learn a great deal (high Learning) yet never apply it on the job; behaviour may change without measurable business results if the wrong behaviours were targeted.
- Research shows only weak correlations between reactions and learning, and between learning and behaviour. Relying on Level 1 alone therefore rewards entertaining programmes rather than effective ones; relying on Level 2 alone certifies knowledge that may never be used.
- Only by measuring at multiple levels can the organisation say with confidence that the training achieved its **purpose - improved job performance and organisational outcomes**, which is what the investment was made for.
- **Example:** A safety programme received excellent ratings and high test scores, yet accident rates did not fall; only Level 3 observation revealed that supervisors were still tolerating short cuts under production pressure.

3. Reason 2 - Multiple levels diagnose where and why a programme succeeds or fails, so that the right correction can be made

- Comparing results across levels **locates the break in the chain**:
- Low Reaction and low Learning point to problems of design or delivery - content, methods, trainer, relevance.
- High Learning but low Behaviour points to **transfer problems** in the work environment - no opportunity to apply, unsupportive supervisors, no reinforcement through appraisal and rewards, contradictory systems.
- High Behaviour but weak Results suggests that the training targeted the wrong behaviours or that the performance problem had non-training causes - a needs-assessment failure.
- Each diagnosis calls for a different remedy: redesign the programme, work with line managers and the climate, or redo the TNA. Without multi-level data the organisation cannot tell which remedy is needed and typically blames the trainer or abandons training altogether.
- Multi-level evaluation therefore turns evaluation into a **learning process for the HRD system**, improving the next TNA, design and delivery.

4. Other reasons

Reason	Explanation
Accountability to different stakeholders	Participants care about relevance (Level 1), trainers about learning (Level 2), line managers about behaviour (Level 3) and top management about results and ROI (Level 4); each needs its own evidence
Justifying and protecting investment	Only Level 3 and 4 data demonstrate business value and protect training budgets in downturns
Strategy alignment	Level 4 measurement forces programmes to be tied to organisational goals
Involving line managers	Behaviour and results measurement requires supervisors to observe and support application, strengthening transfer
Building an evidence base	Multi-level data across programmes reveal which methods and vendors actually work
Compliance and risk	Regulators and auditors increasingly require proof of competence and application, not attendance

5. Conclusion

Training should be evaluated at more than one Kirkpatrick level, first because any single level gives incomplete and possibly misleading evidence - satisfaction is not learning, learning is not application and application is not results - and second because comparing levels diagnoses where a programme breaks down and therefore what must be corrected. Multi-level evaluation converts training from an activity that is merely conducted into an investment that is understood, improved and justified.

Q58**Mention any two factors that should be considered while selecting a training method.**

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. Why the choice of method matters

A training method is the means through which learning is delivered - lecture, case study, role play, simulation, e-learning, job instruction, coaching, job rotation and so on. The method determines how much is learnt, how well it transfers to the job and what the training costs. The prescribed notes raise the key planning questions - on the job or off the job? in-house or outsourced? on-site or off-site? which methods? Selecting a method is therefore a deliberate decision based on several factors. Two of the most important are explained below, followed by others.

2. Factor 1 - The learning objectives (type of learning required)

- The first question is **what participants must be able to do** after training - acquire knowledge, develop a skill or change an attitude - and to what level of proficiency.
- **Knowledge and understanding** (facts, procedures, principles) are efficiently delivered through lectures, reading, e-learning modules and discussions.
- **Motor and technical skills** require demonstration followed by repeated practice with feedback - job instruction training, vestibule training, simulations, coaching.
- **Analytical and decision-making skills** call for case studies, business games, projects and action learning.
- **Interpersonal skills and attitudes** need experiential methods - role plays, behaviour modelling, sensitivity training, group exercises - with feedback and reflection.
- Matching the method to the objective decides whether Level 2 (learning) and Level 3 (behaviour) results will be achieved; a mismatch (for example lecturing about a manual skill) produces knowledge without capability.
- **Example:** To teach nurses a new injection technique, a demonstration and supervised practice on a simulator are chosen rather than a lecture; to teach them the reasons behind the protocol, a short e-learning module is added.

3. Factor 2 - Characteristics of the trainees (number, level, experience and learning readiness)

- **Number of trainees:** large numbers spread over locations favour e-learning and lectures; small groups allow case discussion, role play and coaching; single individuals suit mentoring and job instruction.
- **Existing knowledge and experience:** experienced employees respond to problem-centred, participative methods that draw on their experience; beginners need structured, step-by-step instruction.
- **Education, language and digital literacy:** determine whether reading-based or online methods are feasible.
- **Learning styles and preferences:** some learn by doing, some by observing, some by analysing; variety of methods increases effectiveness.
- **Motivation and readiness:** self-paced e-learning requires disciplined, motivated learners; less motivated groups need facilitated, interactive sessions.

- **Level in the organisation:** operatives typically need skill-focused on-the-job methods; managers need conceptual and behavioural methods such as cases, simulations and development programmes.
- **Example:** For 3,000 dispersed field staff with smartphones and varying education, short mobile micro-learning videos with quizzes are chosen over a centralised classroom course.

4. Other factors to consider

Factor	Consideration
Cost and budget	Development and delivery costs per learner versus expected benefits; internal versus external resources
Time available	Urgency of the need and time trainees can be released from work
Trainer competence and availability	Some methods (T-groups, simulations, coaching) need specially skilled facilitators
Facilities and technology	Availability of classrooms, equipment, simulators, internet and learning platforms
Transfer of learning	How closely the method resembles the job and how easily learning can be applied
Content complexity and risk	Dangerous or costly tasks are first learnt in simulation or vestibule settings
Organisational culture and climate	Openness to participative and experiential methods; management support for time away from work
Learning principles	Opportunity for practice, feedback, active participation, reinforcement and relevance
Evaluation requirements	Ease of measuring learning and behaviour with the chosen method

5. Conclusion

Two essential factors in selecting a training method are the learning objectives - the kind and level of knowledge, skill or attitude to be developed - and the characteristics of the trainees - their number, experience, education, readiness and level. Together with cost, time, trainer competence, facilities, transfer requirements and organisational culture, these factors ensure that the method chosen produces real learning that is applied on the job.

Q59

Design a complete training program for a clearly identified employee skill gap, covering TNA, objectives, training method, delivery, and evaluation.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. The identified skill gap

Organisation: a mid-sized retail bank with 120 branches. **Employees:** 240 front-line customer service officers (CSOs). **Gap:** the bank has introduced a new digital account-opening and KYC (know-your-customer) process. Audit shows that 28 per cent of applications are returned for errors and average processing time is 35 minutes against a standard of 15 minutes. Customer complaints about account opening have doubled. The required competence is "open an account through the new digital process correctly, completely and within 15 minutes, while explaining

the process to the customer."

2. Stage 1 - Training Needs Assessment

Level	Findings
Organisation analysis	Digital onboarding is a strategic priority; top management supports training; error and complaint data provide a baseline (28 per cent errors, 35 minutes, complaint index 100)
Task analysis	Twelve steps in the process; critical KSAs - navigating the new software, document verification rules under KYC, data-entry accuracy, handling exceptions, explaining the process and benefits to customers
Person analysis	Tests and observation of a sample of 60 CSOs: 70 per cent unsure of KYC rules for specific document types; 55 per cent make navigation errors; 30 per cent lack confidence in explaining the process; experienced staff perform worse than recent recruits, indicating habit interference
Cause analysis	Two non-training causes found - a confusing error message in the software (referred to IT) and no quick-reference guide (to be created as a job aid). The remaining gap is a genuine knowledge and skill deficiency - training is justified

3. Stage 2 - Training goal and learning objectives

Training goal: reduce application errors from 28 per cent to below 8 per cent and processing time from 35 to 15 minutes within three months of training, and halve related customer complaints within six months.

Learning objectives - by the end of the programme each CSO will be able to:

1. State the KYC documentation rules for all eight customer categories without reference (knowledge - 90 per cent test score).
2. Complete a digital account-opening for a standard customer in the training environment within 15 minutes with zero errors (skill).
3. Correctly resolve the five most common exception cases using the job aid (skill).
4. Explain the process, benefits and timelines to a customer clearly and courteously, as assessed by a role-play checklist (attitude and communication).

4. Stage 3 - Training methods (blended design)

Component	Method	Duration
Pre-work	E-learning module on KYC rules and process overview with quiz (must score 80 per cent to attend the workshop)	2 hours, self-paced, on the LMS
Workshop	Vestibule training in the bank's training environment: demonstration by an expert, guided practice on ten sample cases, exception handling, role plays on customer explanation with peer feedback	1 day, batches of 16, at regional training centres

Component	Method	Duration
On-the-job follow-through	Job instruction and coaching by a trained branch "digital champion" for the first 20 live applications; job aid at every desk	2 weeks
Reinforcement	Weekly five-minute micro-learning tips on the mobile app; a virtual clinic (one hour) after three weeks to resolve issues	4 weeks

Methods were chosen to match objectives (e-learning for knowledge, vestibule practice and coaching for skills, role play for customer interaction), the number and dispersion of trainees, the need for safe practice before live customer work and cost-effectiveness.

5. Stage 4 - Delivery plan

- **Trainers:** two internal operations experts per region trained through a two-day train-the-trainer programme; 120 branch digital champions (one per branch) prepared through a one-day coaching-skills session.
- **Schedule:** 15 workshops over six weeks, sequenced region-wise; participants released on low-footfall days; branch managers briefed in advance on objectives and their role in supporting application.
- **Logistics:** training environment with sample customer data, one terminal per participant, printed job aids, role-play scripts, feedback checklists; LMS enrolment and reminders.
- **Learning climate:** objectives shared at the start; errors during practice treated as learning; individual feedback; action plan completed by each participant at the close.
- **Budget:** trainer time, venue, travel, e-learning development, job aids and participant time itemised and approved.

6. Stage 5 - Evaluation plan (Kirkpatrick)

Level	Measure	Timing	Target
1 Reaction	Feedback form on relevance, trainer, practice time, confidence to apply	End of workshop	Average 4.2/5 or above
2 Learning	E-learning quiz; post-workshop knowledge test; timed practical assessment; role-play checklist	Pre-work and end of workshop	90 per cent knowledge; 100 per cent complete practical within 15 minutes with zero errors
3 Behaviour	Audit of live applications per CSO; champion observation checklist; mystery-customer visits	4 and 12 weeks after training	Error rate below 8 per cent; processing time 15 minutes; 90 per cent compliance on customer explanation

Level	Measure	Timing	Target
4 Results	Application error rate, processing time, account-opening complaints, digital onboarding volume, cost per account	3 and 6 months	Errors below 8 per cent; complaints halved; volume up

Results are compared with the TNA baseline and with a small group of branches trained later (comparison group). Findings are reviewed by HRD and operations; the programme becomes part of induction for new CSOs and is revised as the software changes.

7. Conclusion

This programme follows the complete training cycle: a TNA that quantified the gap, separated training from non-training causes and set a baseline; measurable objectives; a blended design of e-learning, vestibule practice, role play and on-the-job coaching; a delivery plan with prepared trainers, involved branch managers and job aids; and an evaluation plan at all four Kirkpatrick levels. Each stage is linked to the previous one, which is what makes the programme complete and its effectiveness demonstrable.

Q60

Evaluate two alternative training programs for the same organizational need using the Kirkpatrick model and recommend the more effective program.

Unit 3 | 8 Marks

1. The organisational need

A manufacturing company has a high rate of quality defects in its assembly section - 6 per cent against a target of 2 per cent - traced by a Training Needs Assessment to operators' inadequate knowledge of the new quality standard and weak skills in using measuring instruments and completing inspection records. Two training programmes have been proposed for the same 150 operators. The Kirkpatrick model - Reaction, Learning, Behaviour, Results - is used to evaluate the two alternatives and to recommend one.

2. The two alternatives

Feature	Programme A - "Quality Awareness Seminar"	Programme B - "Quality Skills Blended Programme"
Design	Two-day off-site seminar by an external consultant; lectures, videos, motivational session, group discussion; certificate of participation	E-learning module on the standard (2 hours); one-day workshop with demonstration and hands-on practice on instruments and records in a vestibule area; two weeks of on-the-job coaching by trained line leaders; job aids at each station; weekly quality huddles
Participants	All 150 operators in three batches of 50	150 operators in batches of 15 for the workshop; coaching in own shift

Feature	Programme A - "Quality Awareness Seminar"	Programme B - "Quality Skills Blended Programme"
Involvement of supervisors	None	Line leaders trained as coaches; supervisors set quality goals and review records
Evaluation planned	Feedback form	Feedback form, pre/post test, practical assessment, on-job observation, defect data
Cost	Higher (consultant fees, venue, travel, two days' production loss for all)	Moderate (internal design, shorter time away, coaching within shifts)

3. Evaluation at each Kirkpatrick level

Level 1 - Reaction

- **Programme A:** likely very positive - professional speaker, off-site venue, break from routine, motivational content. Ratings may reach 4.5/5.
- **Programme B:** positive but perhaps slightly lower - hands-on practice is demanding, and coaching on the job is less "special." Ratings around 4.2/5, with high scores for relevance.
- **Assessment:** A wins on satisfaction; B wins on perceived relevance. Reaction alone cannot decide effectiveness.

Level 2 - Learning

- **Programme A:** builds awareness and general knowledge of the standard; large batches and lecture format limit skill practice; without testing, retention is uncertain. Expected knowledge gain moderate; skill gain minimal.
- **Programme B:** e-learning with quiz ensures knowledge; workshop provides demonstration and repeated practice with feedback; practical assessment certifies the skill. Expected knowledge gain high; skill gain high.
- **Assessment:** B clearly superior, especially for the skill component that the TNA identified as critical.

Level 3 - Behaviour

- **Programme A:** no supervisor involvement, no practice on real instruments, no job aids, no follow-up. Operators return to the same environment; transfer is likely to be low. Behaviour change may be visible for a few days and then fade.
- **Programme B:** coaching on the job, job aids, quality goals set by supervisors and weekly huddles create opportunity, support and reinforcement - the conditions for transfer. Behaviour change is likely to be sustained.
- **Assessment:** B decisively superior; A suffers from the classic "positive reaction, no performance change" pattern.

Level 4 - Results

- **Programme A:** defect rate likely to improve marginally or not at all, because instrument skills and record-keeping habits are unchanged; the cost of two days' production loss and consultant fees yields little return.
- **Programme B:** with correct knowledge, practised skills and reinforced behaviour, the defect rate can realistically move towards the 2 per cent target, reducing rework, scrap and customer complaints; the moderate cost gives a strong return on investment.

- **Assessment:** B superior on results and on cost-effectiveness.

4. Summary scorecard

Kirkpatrick level	Programme A	Programme B
1 Reaction	High	Moderately high, high relevance
2 Learning	Moderate knowledge, little skill	High knowledge and skill (assessed)
3 Behaviour	Low - no transfer support	High - coaching, job aids, supervisor reinforcement
4 Results	Minimal, uncertain	Substantial, measurable against baseline
Cost and ROI	High cost, low return	Moderate cost, high return

5. Recommendation

Programme B - the Quality Skills Blended Programme - is recommended. It matches methods to the objectives identified in the TNA (e-learning for knowledge, hands-on practice for skills, coaching for transfer), involves line supervisors, provides job aids and reinforcement, builds in evaluation at all four levels and costs less. Programme A may be enjoyable and create awareness, but it addresses only the knowledge component, provides no skill practice and no transfer support, and is therefore unlikely to reduce defects.

Suggested improvements to Programme B: add a short motivational element on the importance of quality (borrowing A's strength), recognise operators and line leaders who achieve zero-defect weeks, and schedule a refresher e-learning module after six months.

6. Conclusion

Applying the Kirkpatrick model shows that a programme's value cannot be judged by how well it is received. Programme A scores well on reaction but weakly on learning, behaviour and results; Programme B scores well on all four levels because it builds skills, supports transfer and measures outcomes. For the organisational need of reducing assembly defects, Programme B is the more effective choice.